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Coforge denies any discord in Board

COFORGE has denied there was any discord between non-executive chairman OP Bhatt, non-executive independent director DK Singh and the executive directors before gaps in the internal audit process were flagged by KPMG. **■ PAGE 3**

Saudis shut down oil pipeline after attack

SAUDI Arabia has shut down its East-West pipeline after the vital oil conduit came under aerial attack in the widening Middle East war, threatening to send energy prices even higher. **■ PAGE 16**

Trump: Would love to see united Ireland

US President Donald Trump said on Saturday he would 'love' to see Ireland unify with British-run Northern Ireland. He made the remarks made during a visit to Dublin. **■ PAGE 16**

RBI rejects Tata Sons' bid to remain private

Directs company to go public, comply with NBFC rules

URVI MALYANIA
Mumbai, September 12

THE RESERVE BANK of India (RBI) has rejected Tata Sons' application to surrender its certificate of registration (CoR), as a core investment company (CIC), sources close to the development told FE. The regulator's decision brings



clarity to the status of Tata Sons and closes a key route that the Tata Group's holding company had pursued to avoid a

stock market listing. The RBI is believed to have directed Tata Sons to take steps to fully comply with regula-

tions governing non-banking financial companies (NBFC) classified in the Upper Layer (NBFC-UL). Queries sent to the

RBI elicited no response till the time of going to press. Tata Sons had applied to the RBI in March 2024 to surrender

its CIC registration after pre-paying ₹21,813 crore of debt and turning net cash positive in FY24. The development brings

the long-running question over Tata Sons' listing back into focus at a time when the group holding company is also preparing for a leadership transition. Chairman N Chandrasekaran wrote to the Tata Sons board in August, conveying his decision not to seek reappointment after his current term ends on February 20 next year. The Tata Sons board is scheduled to meet on September 17, when the RBI's latest communication is expected to be discussed.

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BORDER PEACE MUST, PM STRESSES DURING MEETING

Modi, Xi vow to address widening trade imbalance

Ties to be guided by mutual respect, interest, sensitivity

MUKESH JAGOTA
New Delhi, September 12

PRIME MINISTER NARENDRA Modi and Chinese President Xi Jinping on Saturday underlined the need to address each other's concerns on trade and economic relations, including New Delhi's widening trade deficit with Beijing, market-access barriers and supply-chain vulnerabilities.

At their meeting on the sidelines of the BRICS Summit in New Delhi, both leaders specifically referred to the "structural trade imbalance and supply chain issues" and facilitation of "meaningful and predictable market access." They agreed that differences should not become disputes and said bilateral ties should be guided by "mutual respect, mutual sensitivity and mutual interest," a statement by the Ministry of External Affairs said. However, the statement made no specific reference to India's policy on foreign direct investment from China, which has seen some relaxation in recent months. Beijing's volatile policies regarding export of critical inputs to India also did not find any explicit mention.

"They (the two leaders) reaffirmed that both countries should take a strategic and long-term perspective of their ties," the MEA statement said. Both leaders also agreed to promote business linkages and greater mobility, while seeking to expand common ground on regional and global



Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Chinese President Xi Jinping before the 18th BRICS Summit at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi, on Saturday

PM presses for major reforms at IMF, UN

PRASANTA SAHU & MUKESH JAGOTA
New Delhi, September 12

PM NARENDRA MODI on Saturday called for a restructuring of global institutions and proposed a 10-point action plan for international governance reforms, including in the framing of rules. Addressing the 18th BRICS leaders' Summit here, he said the discussions within the grouping made it clear that the changing global order could not be managed through institutions

issues, it added. Modi stressed that peace and tranquility in the border areas remained essential for

NARENDRA MODI, PM
Pyramid of privilege must give way to partnership

designed for an earlier era. "It is clear from today's discussions that the world's transition cannot be carried out through old institutions," he said in his concluding remarks as the BRICS chair.

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the continued development of bilateral relations.

Continued on Page 2

Bring peace to West Asia, Xi urges BRICS members

MUKESH JAGOTA
New Delhi, September 12

IN HIS ADDRESS at the summit, Chinese President Xi Jinping urged the BRICS bloc to be a peacemaker in the West Asia conflict.

China will work with other BRICS members in that role, as the war "does not serve the common interests of the international community," he said.

The Chinese leader called the BRICs a "leading group" in the Global South and a model of self-reliance among emerging and developing countries that should promote innovation-driven development.



PM Narendra Modi with Chinese President Xi Jinping, Russian President Vladimir Putin and other world leaders during the BRICS Summit at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi, on Saturday

NEW DELHI DECLARATION ADOPTED

BRICS Bank to expand with new members, resources

PRASANTA SAHU
New Delhi, September 12

LEADERS OF BRICS countries on Saturday resolved to expand the membership of the New Development Bank (NDB), also known as BRICS Bank, and create new financing mechanisms to support infrastructure and development across the Global South.

As per the New Delhi Declaration adopted by the grouping on Saturday, apart from reforming existing institutions for infrastructure and development financing, the NDB should be strengthened further with a facility for expedited consideration of applications from interested BRICS countries.

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DECLARATION HIGHLIGHTS

Greater use of national currencies for cross-border trade, investment

Reform IMF & World Bank with greater voice, representation for Global South

Condemn unilateral tariff & non-tariff measures

Commit to AI cooperation, covering access to AI resources



Advance contingent reserve arrangement reforms to make financial safety net more flexible and responsive

Encourage pilots under BRICS multilateral guarantees

BRICS task force on growth and development established by Indian Chair

Call for restraint and diplomacy in West Asia, stressing uninterrupted trade and energy flows

Establish logistics supply-chain cooperation framework to strengthen connectivity

BRICS pushes local currency trade to cut costs

BRICS countries are pushing for greater use of national currencies in trade and investment and interopera-

bility of their cross-border payment systems to reduce transaction costs, reports

Mukesh Jagota **■ PAGE 6**

HDFC Bank submits 2 names for CEO post

FE BUREAU
Mumbai, September 12

HDFC BANK'S BOARD has submitted names of two candidates to the Reserve Bank of India for appointment as the bank's next managing director and chief executive officer, it said in an exchange notification on Saturday, formally starting the succession process for Sashidhar Jagdishan, who is due to retire later this year. The bank did not disclose the names of the candidates.

Jagdishan, who has led the bank since 2020, is set to step down at the end of his second term in October. The bank will submit the names along with the proposed remuneration for the

SUCCESSION PLAN



Bank did not disclose names of candidates

Deputy MD Kaizad Bharucha rumoured to be top runner for post
Sashidhar Jagdishan due to retire in October this year

candidates to RBI for approval for a three-year term.

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Maruti emerges EV export giant

Ships more PVs in Q1 than 16 other carmakers together

VIKRAM CHAUDHARY
New Delhi, September 12

WHILE MARUTI SUZUKI'S domestic market share continues to hover around 40% despite new launches, the carmaker — driven by its all-electric flagship, the eVitara — has quietly emerged as an electric vehicle (EV) export powerhouse, operating as a global production hub for its parent company, Suzuki Motor Corporation (SMC).

Sales data sourced from the industry for Q1FY27 (April-June 2026) reveals that Maruti

GOING GLOBAL

	Units		Q1FY27 share (%)
	FY26	Q1FY27	
Maruti Suzuki	25,549	15,210	97.2
Tata Motors	2,518	401	2.6
Hyundai India	298	24	0.2
Kia India	12	6	0.0
Mahindra	275	NA	---

Suzuki commanded an astonishing 97% market share in EV exports from India, shipping 15,210 units of the eVitara overseas. This builds on the FY26 performance, during which Maruti Suzuki captured nearly 90% of all Indian EV

exports with 25,549 units.

Since the time overseas dispatches of the eVitara began in August 2025 — six months before its Indian launch in February — Maruti Suzuki has cumulatively exported over 46,000 units to

more than 49 countries. These shipments are heading to mature, highly regulated markets such as Japan and Western European nations, where quality benchmarks are stringent but the Suzuki brand value is strong.

The performance is in stark contrast to domestic EV leaders Tata Motors and Mahindra, whose electric offerings have struggled to find traction abroad. In FY26, Tata Motors exported just 2,518 EVs — primarily to developing markets like South Africa, Nepal, Bhutan, and Mauritius — and Mahindra exported merely 275 electric units.

This EV export surge is part of a broader passenger vehicle (PV) export footprint.

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Sebi proposes CAS framework changes

KUSHAN SHAH
Mumbai, September 12

THE SECURITIES AND Exchange Board of India (Sebi) on Saturday proposed sweeping changes to the closing auction session (CAS) framework, including two alternative methods for determining the settlement prices of index and single-stock derivative contracts on expiry days. The proposals are part of a consultation paper issued after the regulator said last week that it would review the CAS mechanism and seeks views on expiry-day settlement prices, market timings, order handling and information dissemination.

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INTERIM PERIOD BEFORE TRANSITION

Option 1: Final settlement price based on blended VWAP of trades in last 30 minutes of CTS & 10-minute CAS

Option 2: Retains existing method of using VWAP in last 30 minutes of CTS

Comments sought on proposals till October 3

Modi, Xi vow to address widening trade imbalance

THE BILATERAL STATEMENT on trade and economic ties comes amid India's ever-increasing trade deficit with China, which went up to \$112.1 billion in 2025-26 from \$99.1 billion in the previous financial year. In 2021-22 it was \$73.3 billion. China in 2025-26 accounted for 33.5% of India's total merchandise trade deficit. Much of the deficit is driven by India's heavy dependence on China for industrial inputs, machinery, electronics components, chemicals, pharmaceutical intermediates and critical minerals. The emerging sectors of exports like electronics and automobiles are heavily dependent on inputs and components from China. Other than deficit, the dependence has also created vulnerabilities which were exposed in 2025 when China tightened controls on exports of rare-earth elements and permanent magnets. Indian automobile and component manufacturers, heavily dependent on Chinese supplies, faced difficulties obtaining the magnets needed for electric vehicles, hybrid vehicles and other automotive applications. China's April 2025 controls required exporters to obtain licences for specified rare-earth products and magnets. China controls more than 90% of global rare-earth magnet processing capacity, making alternative supplies difficult to secure quickly. Indian companies have also faced difficulties in obtaining market access in China. New



PM Modi with Chinese President Xi Jinping and Russian President Vladimir Putin during the Bharat Innovates Exposition at the 18th BRICS Summit, on Saturday

Delhi has repeatedly sought greater access for pharmaceuticals, agricultural products, food items and other goods, while Indian businesses have complained of regulatory, sanitary and other non-tariff barriers. Investment was another part of the economic relationship that has remained constrained since the Covid-19 pandemic. India amended its Foreign Direct Investment policy in April 2020 to require government approval for investments from countries sharing a land border with

India. The move brought Chinese investments under the government route amid heightened concerns over opportunistic acquisitions and national security as valuations of the companies fell during COVID outbreak. New Delhi has since begun a calibrated relaxation of these restrictions. The government in March 2026 introduced changes permitting certain non-controlling investments of up to 10% by investors from land-bordering countries through the

automatic route, while also creating a time-bound approval mechanism for specified manufacturing investments, including in capital goods, electronic components and solar-cell inputs. The easing reflects the competing economic priorities facing India: reducing excessive dependence on China while allowing access to Chinese capital, technology and manufacturing capabilities where they can strengthen domestic production.

Sebi proposes blended method for derivatives expiry pricing

UNDER THE FIRST option, the final settlement price would be based on a blended volume-weighted average price (VWAP) of trades executed during the last 30 minutes of the continuous trading session (CTS) and the 10-minute CAS. The weights assigned to the two sessions would not be predetermined but would depend on the actual traded value during each period. The second option would retain the existing methodology of using the VWAP during the last 30 minutes of continuous trading to determine settlement prices. Trades executed during CAS would not be included in the calculation, making the methodology similar to the one followed before CAS was introduced in August. Sebi proposed that the second methodology could continue for at least one year, after which it could transition to the blended VWAP framework based on the liquidity and participation seen in CAS and the familiarity of market participants with the auction mechanism. The regulator said retaining the existing settlement methodology during the interim period would provide continuity and give market participants sufficient time to become familiar with CAS. However, it clarified that the arrangement would only be temporary, with blended VWAP being the intended long-term framework. Sebi also sought to address sharp movements in the indicative index value during CAS. It noted that market participants had at times misconstrued the index value (IIV) as an actual level reached by the index, even though it was only an evolving indication derived from the indicative equilibrium prices (IEP) of constituent stocks. Citing international practices, Sebi proposed discontinuing the dissemination of indicative index values during CAS. Instead, exchanges would disseminate actual index values, indicative prices of constituent securities and expected settlement prices during the relevant settlement-price determination window. The regulator also noted that the closing price and settlement price of stocks in the futures and options segment could differ



because of the different methodologies used to determine them. **Two alternatives for CAS timings** Sebi further proposed reducing the transition period between continuous trading and CAS to one minute from five minutes, based on feedback from stock exchanges. Under the first timing option, continuous trading in all stocks would continue until 3:30 pm, restoring the schedule followed before CAS was introduced. A 10-minute CAS, including the one-minute transition period, would then be conducted after 3:30 pm, while derivatives trading would remain open for five minutes after the auction and close at 3:45 pm. Under the second, CAS would take place between 3:15 pm and 3:25 pm, including the one-minute transition period, while derivatives trading would continue until 3:30 pm. Under both alternatives, reference prices for CAS would be based on trades executed during the last 15 minutes of continuous trading. Sebi said the proposal to reduce the post-CAS derivatives trading window to five minutes from 10 minutes followed feedback that there was limited rationale for allowing trading in expiring contracts to continue once price discovery in the underlying security or index had been completed. However, the regulator proposed retaining a smaller window to allow market participants to manage or reverse positions, particularly in single-stock derivatives, where they may not have been able to complete all desired transactions earlier. **Changes proposed for order modification** Sebi also reviewed the existing 3% price band with-

in which orders can be placed during CAS. While proposing to retain the band to give investors sufficient flexibility to express their views on the appropriate closing price, it suggested changes to the cancellation and modification of orders. Limit orders placed within 1% of the reference price would be allowed to be cancelled or modified during CAS. Orders placed at or beyond 1% and up to the 3% limit would not be allowed to be cancelled, although they could be modified to improve their price within the prescribed band. The regulator said the change is aimed at reducing significant withdrawals of trading interest at prices far from the reference price while allowing participants to improve their orders in response to evolving demand and supply. Sebi also proposed allowing unexecuted iceberg orders from the continuous trading session to transition into CAS to improve auction liquidity and ensure that existing trading interest is included in the closing-price discovery process. Iceberg orders are large orders divided into smaller portions, with only part of the total quantity disclosed to the market at a time. Currently, unexecuted iceberg orders do not transition into CAS because of the auction's disclosure-based framework. Under the proposal, such orders would enter CAS as normal limit orders, with their entire unexecuted quantity disclosed and made available for execution under the auction's order-matching mechanism. Sebi has sought comments from market participants on the proposals until October 3, 2026.

HDFC Bank submits two names for CEO post

KAIZAD BHARUCHA, THE bank's deputy managing director, is rumoured to be the most likely internal candidate to succeed Jagdishan. Other contenders include Anup Bagchi, CEO of ICICI Prudential Life Insurance; Paresh Sukthankar, former deputy MD at HDFC Bank; Vibha Padalkar, CEO of HDFC Life Insurance; Rajiv Sabharwal, CEO of Tata Capital; and Amitabh Chaudhry, CEO of Axis Bank. The board also approved the reappointment of V Srinivasa Rangan as whole-time director, designated as executive director, for the period of November 23 to November 22, 2027. He currently oversees human resources, corporate legal, group oversight and secretarial functions, investment banking, information security, ethics, and fraud and vigilance. It also approved the appointment of Jimmy Tata as whole-time director, designated as executive director, for three years, subject to RBI approval, and an additional whole-time director position. The bank said the position is "in order to have sharper synergy and oversight, including on the subsidiaries of the bank as well as to have larger pipeline for succession planning" and will be filled in consultation with the incoming MD & CEO.

Maruti Suzuki emerges as electric vehicle export giant

IN Q1FY27, MARUTI Suzuki exported 123,330 PVs, holding 55.5% market share of total Indian PV exports — the carmaker shipped more PVs abroad than all 16 other domestic carmakers combined. In addition, six of the top eight exported PV models from India in Q1FY27 belonged to Maruti Suzuki, led by the Fronx (23,803 units), the Jimny (21,840 units), and the eVitara (15,210 units), which ranked as India's third highest-exported car model overall. "What we are seeing is a strategic division of labour," noted a senior auto analyst tracking global supply chains. "While the domestic market has become a cut-throat com-

Pyramid of privilege must give way to partnership, says PM

"REPRESENTATION, RESPONSIVENESS, AND rule-making are all necessary reforms," he added. Earlier, in his opening statement, Modi displayed New Delhi's impatience with the fact that the International Monetary Fund's (IMF) decision-making process had not been reformed to reflect the changed global economic realities and the growing heft of India and other emerging market economies. International financial institutions must better reflect today's economic realities, he said, adding that voting power, leadership positions and policy priorities should give greater weight to countries driving global economic growth. India has repeatedly pushed for reforms in the Bretton Woods institutions, including the IMF and World Bank, to give developing countries a greater voice in global economic decision-making. "Countries experiencing global economic growth should play an important role in global economic governance," Modi said. India currently holds 2.64% of the

total voting power in the IMF. Modi also made a strong case for reforming the United Nations Security Council, stressing that the issue could no longer be avoided. He called for negotiations to be tied to a definite timeline and clear outcomes. Modi said AI, cyberspace, outer space, biotechnology and critical technologies will shape future global rules. He stressed that developing countries must have the expertise to help frame these rules, calling for efforts to make the Global South both a "rule-taker and a rule-shaper." Modi said the existing 'pyramid of privilege' structure in global governance must give way to a platform of partnership. The Prime Minister said the BRICS New Delhi summit showed that despite differences in perspectives, member countries remained committed to strengthening mutual cooperation. "Along with the diversity of our thoughts, our commitment

to BRICS cooperation has also been clearly evident," Modi said. Modi also underlined the need for the Global South to have a meaningful role in shaping emerging technologies and the rules governing them. He said the gap between decisions taken at the global level and their impact on people on the ground needed to be addressed through greater cooperation. "We have also emphasised that the Global South should be equally involved in the development of future technologies and their rules," he said. The resolution assumes importance amidst rapid adoption of Agentic AI, tokenisation and quantum computing. The adoption of the New Delhi Declaration provided a clear direction for the group's shared commitments, Modi said, stressing that the real challenge would be turning those commitments into action. "The New Delhi

Declaration adopted today gives a clear direction to our shared commitment. Now it is our responsibility to transform these commitments into strong results," he said. Outlining a 10-point action plan for global governance reforms, he said BRICS must work towards preparing a reform roadmap by the next summit. He proposed creating a Seafarers Emergency Support Network that would bring together maritime authorities and diplomatic missions of the countries concerned. The network could assist in distress situations, including medical aid, communication with families and evacuation. Modi proposed a BRICS Continuity and Implementation Mechanism. Under the proposal, BRICS could create a secure digital repository to track decisions and initiatives, with each decision linked to a nodal point, a deadline and its implementation status. Looking ahead to the next 20 years of BRICS, Modi called for a new and ambitious agenda that would turn the grouping's growing cooperation into tangible outcomes.

BRICS Bank to expand with new members

"WE ENCOURAGE FURTHER efforts by the Bank (NDB) to expand steadily its capacity to mobilise resources, foster innovation, expand local currency financing, diversify funding sources, and support impactful projects that advance sustainable development, reduce inequality, and promote infrastructure investments and economic integration," the declaration said. The NDB, which operates under a mandate set in the BRICS Summit in 2014, currently focuses its financing on six primary sectors, including clean energy, transport infrastructure, water and sanitation, social infrastructure and bridging the digital divide. It is designed to support both public and private sector projects through customised financial tools. One objective of the bank is also to scale up local currency lending. Apart from India, China, Brazil, Russia and South Africa, the UAE, Colombia, Uzbekistan, Egypt, Algeria and Bangladesh are its members. Another set of

countries — Uruguay, Ethiopia, Angola, and Zimbabwe — are listed as prospective members. The grouping welcomed the launch of the BRICS-NDB knowledge portal to share development experiences, policy innovations and lessons from NDB-financed projects. The declaration stated that any new quota formula at International Monetary Fund should reflect countries' relative positions in the global economy and increase the quota and voting shares of emerging market and developing economies without reducing the shares of developing countries. It also stressed that the interests of the poorest members should be protected and that voluntary financial contributions should not determine quota allocation, governance representation or voting power. "We reiterate the urgent need to reform the Bretton Woods Institutions (BWI) to make them more agile, effective, credible, inclusive, fit for pur-

pose, unbiased, accountable, and representative, to enhance their legitimacy," according to the Declaration. On the IMF, BRICS reiterated its support for quota and governance reforms, calling for the implementation of quota increases agreed under the 16th general review of quotas without further delay and for meaningful quota realignment under the 17th review at the earliest. The declaration stated that any new quota formula should reflect countries' relative positions in the global economy and increase the quota and voting shares of EMDEs without reducing the shares of developing countries. It also stressed that the interests of the poorest members should be protected and that voluntary financial contributions should not determine quota allocation, governance representation or voting power. The World Bank's shareholding review was similarly identified as a key instrument to strengthen multilat-

eralism and make the institution "better, bigger, and more effective". The declaration welcomed progress on the BRICS Multilateral Guarantees (BMG) initiative, which intends to improve the creditworthiness of development projects, lower financing costs and mobilise private investment. Members called for continued technical work and pilot transactions. The bloc's Contingent Reserve Arrangement, meanwhile, is being strengthened as a financial safety net, with amendments aimed at making it more flexible and responsive during crises. As per GTRI, the most critical section of the declaration is a paragraph on West Asia where a fine balance is struck by urging both the US-Israel and Iran to desist from attacks and retaliatory strikes. "Given BRICS' conflicting interests and internal constraints, securing consensus on such a clear position represents a major diplomatic win for India," it said.

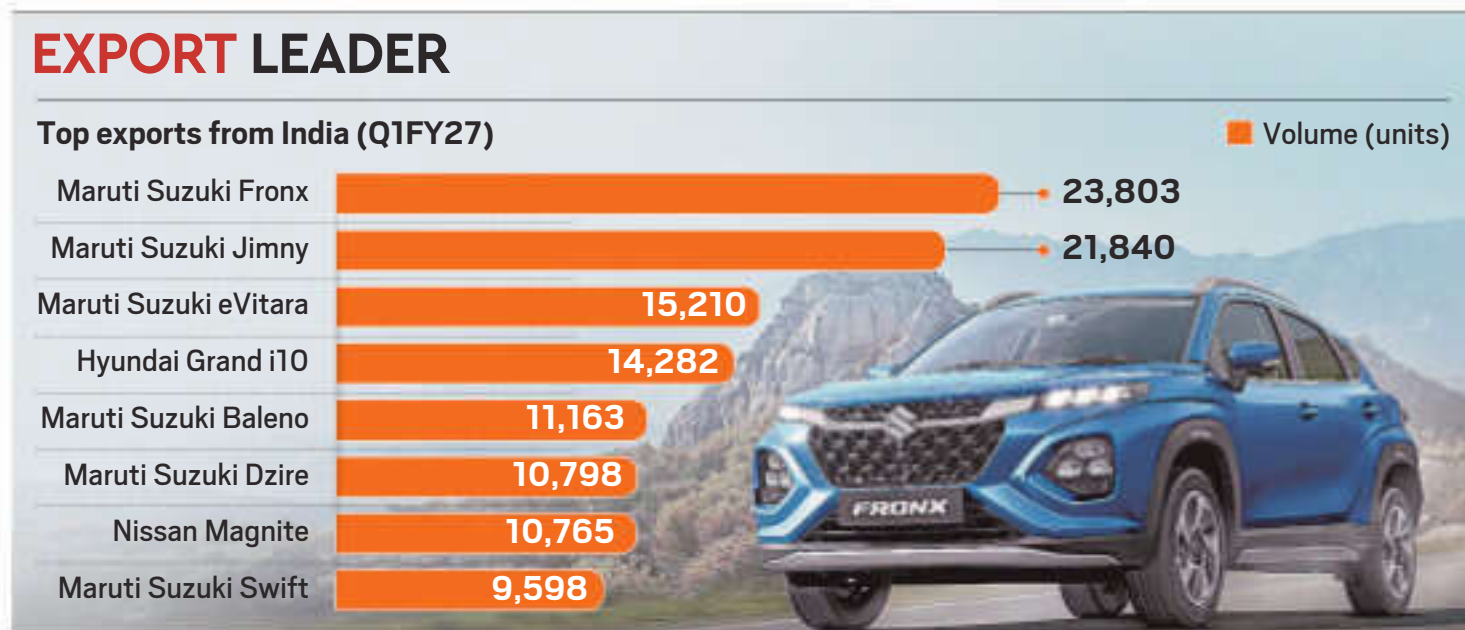
RBI rejects Tata Sons' plea to remain private

IT IS NOT immediately clear whether the meeting will be advanced or an emergency meeting will be called early next week. Tata Sons did not respond to FE's queries until press time. Tata Sons has been classified as an Upper Layer NBFC since September 2022. Under the RBI's scale-based regulatory framework, entities in this category are subject to enhanced regulatory requirements, including a mandate to list within three years of being classified in the Upper Layer. That deadline expired in September 2025, but Tata Sons has remained unlisted. The company had sought to exit the regulatory framework after becoming debt-free in 2024, repaying its outstanding borrowings and applying to surrender its

registration as a core investment company (CIC). When the RBI included Tata Sons in its latest list of Upper Layer NBFCs in August 2026, it said the company's application for deregistration as a CIC remained under examination. Its inclusion in the list, the regulator said, was 'without prejudice' to the final outcome of the application. The RBI's revised scale-based regulatory framework, updated in June 2026, sets an asset threshold of ₹1 lakh crore for classification in the Upper Layer. Tata Sons reported total assets of ₹2.01 lakh crore as of March 31, 2026, according to its FY26 annual report. Under RBI guidelines, an NBFC seeking exemption from registration must meet prescribed conditions, including not access-

ing public funds, having no customer interface and having assets of less than ₹1,000 crore. The guidelines allow existing NBFCs that do not access public funds or have a customer interface, including those holding a CoR as Type-I NBFCs, to apply for deregistration by December 31, 2026, provided they meet the prescribed exemption criteria. The RBI guidelines also specify that an NBFC classified in the Upper Layer will continue to be subject to the enhanced regulatory framework for at least five years even if it subsequently ceases to meet the qualifying criteria. The September 11 communication appears to have brought Tata Sons' deregistration effort to a close, potentially intensifying the debate

among its shareholders over whether the closely held holding company should remain private. Tata Trusts, which controls around 66% of Tata Sons through the Sir Ratan Tata Trust and Sir Dorabji Tata Trust, passed a resolution in July 2025 favouring retention of Tata Sons as a private company. The Shapoorji Pallonji (SP) Group, Tata Sons' largest minority shareholder with an 18.37% stake, has taken a different position, viewing a listing as the most practical way to unlock the value of its holding. The SP Group is seeking to monetise part of its Tata Sons stake to repay a portion of its estimated ₹60,000-crore debt. Some of its Tata Sons shares have also been pledged to raise funds. (With inputs from Kshipra Petkar)



petitive arena, SMC is leveraging India's cost structure to build a high-margin export factory, and today India is the sole global manufacturing hub for models like the

eVitara and the 5-door Jimny." Maruti Suzuki's export performance also drew praise from the government at the 66th SIAM Annual Convention where the

Union Minister for Commerce and Industry Piyush Goyal lauded the carmaker for driving India's automotive exports. "The only statistic that I

can recognise and appreciate is the million cars that you exported last year," Goyal told industry leaders at the convention. "Maruti is today exporting probably half of those, and is now exporting electric cars, even supplying to Japan. If we do what Maruti has started doing, I would urge all of you to look at export markets more actively and aim to double exports every two years." With the India-UK Free Trade Agreement in effect and an EU trade deal on the horizon, Maruti Suzuki's early-mover advantage in high-standard EV exports positions it to lead India's next phase of global automotive manufacturing.

EXPORTERS EXPLOITED SUBSIDIES, CLAIMS US

US finalises steep duties on solar imports from India

● Anti-dumping margins to hit 123%; countervailing duties to reach 126%

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Washington, September 12

THE US HAS finalised high anti-dumping and countervailing duties on the import of solar cells and panels from India and two other countries, contending that producers and exporters benefited from unfair government subsidies and harmed American industry.

The US Department of Commerce, on Friday, announced its final affirmative determinations in the anti-dumping duty (AD) and countervailing duty (CVD) investigations of crystalline silicon photovoltaic cells from India, Indonesia, and Laos.

The Department of Commerce has affixed anti-dumping margins of 123.04% for Indian producers, 94.36% for Indonesian producers and 65.43% for producers from Laos.

It also set countervailing duty rates of 126.09% for

TARIFF SHOCK

■ Solar panels and cells from Indonesia & Laos also on the list

■ Anti-dumping margins have been affixed at **94.36%** for Indonesian producers, **65.43%** for producers from Laos

■ Countervailing duty rates for Indonesian producers is between **73.2% and 173.7%**

■ For Laos producers, it is between **82.03% and 153.67%**

Indian producers, between 73.2% and 173.7% for Indonesian producers and between 82.03% and 153.67% for Laos producers.

The action was taken on a petition filed by The Alliance for American Solar Manufacturing and Trade seeking investigations into allegedly illegal trade practices by largely Chinese-owned manufacturers operating in Laos and Indonesia, as well as companies headquartered in India.

The US International Trade



■ USITC will examine whether the subsidised imports harmed industries

■ The final vote is expected on October 14

■ US commerce department will issue anti-dumping & countervailing duty orders by November 2

Commission (USITC) will now examine whether the subsidised imports harmed the US industry and make a final injury determination in the next 45 days.

The final injury vote is expected on October 14.

If the USITC's final determination is affirmative, the Department of Commerce will issue anti-dumping and countervailing duty orders by November 2 on the basis of the rates mentioned in Friday's findings.

If the USITC's determination is negative, the investigation will be terminated.

"These determinations confirm that producers and exporters from these countries have been dumping solar products into the US market at unfairly low prices and have benefited from countervailable subsidies, causing material injury to the domestic solar manufacturing industry,"

The Alliance for American Solar Manufacturing and Trade said in a statement.

Zomato to charge extra ₹5 for COD

FE BUREAU
Bengaluru, September 12

ETERNAL-OWNED FOOD DELIVERY platform Zomato has begun levying an additional charge on orders paid for in cash, adding another line item to a bill that already includes a platform fee, packaging charges and taxes.

The charge appears in the app's bill summary as a "pay on delivery fee" and is levied only when customers choose to pay in cash at the time of delivery. It is typically ₹5, although some users have been charged ₹7 and, in some cases, as much as ₹20. Customers paying online are not charged the fee.

The charge is separate from Zomato's ₹14.99 platform fee per order, restaurant packaging charges and GST. Zomato did not respond to queries on the new charge. Rival Swiggy has not introduced a similar fee.

Food delivery platforms began introducing per-order consumer charges in 2023, when Swiggy started testing a ₹2 platform fee, followed by Zomato. Zomato has raised the fee in stages since then, most recently to ₹14.99 from ₹12.50 earlier this year.

At Zomato's scale, even a small charge can translate into significant revenue. The platform processes an estimated 2.3-2.5 million food orders a day. A ₹5 charge on every order would amount to ₹1.15-1.25 crore a day, or roughly ₹420-456 crore annually. The actual contribution, however, would be a fraction of this, as cash orders account for only a portion of total volumes.

The move comes at a time when competition in food delivery is intensifying. Rapido's Ownly has been gaining traction, Flipkart is piloting its Eat In offering.

Coforge denies tensions, differences within Board

POULOMI CHATTERJEE
Bengaluru, September 12

COFORGE HAS DENIED any discord between non-executive Chairman OP Bhatt, non-executive independent director DK Singh and the company's executive directors before gaps in the internal audit process were flagged by KPMG.

The mid-tier IT services firm said this was evident from the fact that Bhatt and Singh had accepted successive five-year terms on the board earlier this year — in July and February, respectively — before KPMG's findings came to light in August.

More importantly, Coforge said CEO and executive director Sudhir Singh had received a perfect performance rating of 5 out of 5 in the board evaluation process before the discrepancies were raised. The peer review showed that he had received the highest rating from all four independent directors, including Bhatt and DK Singh, as well as another executive director on the board.

DAY AFTER RESIGNATIONS

■ Bhatt, Singh had accepted 5-year terms on board earlier this year

■ Coforge said CEO & executive director Sudhir Singh had received a perfect performance rating in the board evaluation process



■ Bhatt resigned on September 8, followed by Singh on September 11

"These facts demonstrate that, prior to the internal audit observations and the subsequent matters arising from them, the Board Evaluation process reflected a high degree of alignment and confidence between the independent directors and executive directors," the company said in a statement.

The annual audit had found that Bhatt, who received the lowest performance rating in the

board evaluation process, did not share the document containing the Board Evaluation Report (BER) with the other directors, except with Nomination and Remuneration Committee (NRC) Chairman DK Singh.

After the board sought explanations from both directors over the withholding of the details, Bhatt resigned on September 8, followed by Singh on September 11.

Zudio crosses 1,000-store mark in 10 years

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 12

TATA GROUP RETAIL firm Trent on Saturday said its value-fashion retail chain Zudio has crossed the 1,000-store milestone in the country.

Zudio offers affordable propositions and has expanded rapidly since its launch in 2016, according to a regulatory filing by Trent.

The brand's network now spans over 300 cities and has served more than 100 million

customers over the past decade, the company said.

Besides Zudio, Trent operates Westside, which is a large-format fashion store.

It also has grocery business Star.

As of June 30, 2026, Trent's

store portfolio included 301 Westside and 29 stores across other lifestyle concepts, operated with a footprint of over 1.8 million sq ft across its fashion brands.

In FY26, Trent's revenue was at ₹19,701.41 crore.

Food regulator directs Nilgiri Oil, Aquagri to recall products

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 12

FOOD REGULATOR FSSAI has asked two companies, Nilgiri Oil and Allied Industries and Aquagri Processing, to immediately recall two products from the market due to high pesticide residues and safety concerns.

In a social media post on Saturday, the Food Safety and Standards

Authority of India (FSSAI) said it has issued recall orders to two Food Business Operators (FBOs) under the FSS Act, 2006, following lab testing and evaluations.

The regulator has asked Nilgiri Oil and Allied Industries to recall its coriander powder, Shalimar's Chef — Coriander Powder, due to high pesticide residues. In the case of Aquagri Processing, the FSSAI has directed immediate recall of Carraegenan product from market due to safety concern.

A regulatory sample of "Carraegenan", drawn by the FSSAI Southern Region, was found not satisfactory with respect to Cadmium and did not conform to the specifica-

tions prescribed under the Regulations.

The food analyst accordingly opined that the submitted food sample was "Unsafe". The result was the same in retesting.

"Based on the findings of the Referral Food Laboratory, the product 'Carraegenan' has been found to be unsafe, and its manufacture is in contravention of the applicable provisions of the FSS Act, 2006 and the Rules/Regulations made thereunder," the regulator said while passing the recall order.

In the matter of Nilgiri Oil and Allied Industries, the FSSAI has ordered immediate recall of "Shalimar's Chef — Coriander Powder".

A regulatory sample of "Shalimar's Chef — Coriander Powder" was drawn from the company's premises.

The sample was found not satisfactory with respect to pesticide residues and did not conform to the prescribed standards. The product sample was "Unsafe". On retesting, the sample was found not satisfactory with respect to pesticide residues.

The sample was found not satisfactory with respect to pesticide residues and did not conform to the prescribed standards. The product sample was "Unsafe". On retesting, the sample was found not satisfactory with respect to pesticide residues.

AstraZeneca's breast cancer pill fails in late-stage trial

BIOPHARMACEUTICAL MAJOR ASTRAZENECA has said its Phase III SERENA-4 trial evaluating Etcamah (camizetrant) in combination with palbociclib did not meet its objective of statistically significant improvement in progression-free survival in patients with advanced breast cancer.

However, a numerical improvement was observed in the first-line treatment of patients with estrogen receptor (ER)-positive, HER2-negative advanced breast cancer who had not received any systemic treatment for advanced disease, the company said in a statement.

The SERENA-4 trial evaluated the Etcamah and palbociclib combination versus an aromatase inhibitor (anastrozole)

combined with palbociclib. Palbociclib is a cyclin-dependent kinase (CDK) 4/6 inhibitor.

Regarding the drug's safety, the company noted that the safety profile of Etcamah in combination with palbociclib was consistent with the known profiles of each medicine, with no new safety concerns identified.

"Whilst we are disappointed by the SERENA-4 outcome, it sharpens our focus on maximising the number of patients who can benefit from Etcamah today based on SERENA-6 and reinforces the importance of ESRI testing for patients on first-line therapy," said Susan Galbraith, Executive Vice President, Oncology Haematology R&D, AstraZeneca.

PTI

GO AIRLINES (INDIA) LIMITED (IN LIQUIDATION)
C/o BRITANNIA INDUSTRIES LIMITED, A-33, LAWRENCE ROAD INDUSTRIAL AREA, NEW DELHI DL 110035
IN CIN: U63013DL2004PLC217305
(A company under liquidation vide an order of the Hon'ble NCLT dated 20th January 2025)

PUBLIC ANNOUNCEMENT FOR E-AUCTION
Notice under Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016

Notice is hereby given by the undersigned, to the public at large, inviting bids for the sale of assets (described in the table below) owned by Go Airlines (India) Limited (in Liquidation) which forms a part of the liquidation estate of Go Airlines (India) Limited (in Liquidation), in accordance with the provisions of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016 ("IBC") read with the rules and regulations framed thereunder, on an 'as is where is', 'as is what is', 'as is how is', 'whatever there is', without any recourse basis', without any representation, warranty, or indemnity.

The sale will be undertaken by the undersigned through the e-auction platform BAANKNET (formerly eBKray) <https://ibbi.baanknet.com/> ("E-Auction Platform")

Schedule of important dates for the e-auction

Last date to submit eligibility documents and section 29A undertaking as specified in the Asset Sale Process Memorandum ("ASPM")

September 28, 2026

Last date and time to deposit the earnest money deposit ("EMD")

September 28, 2026

Date and time of the e-auction

September 30, 2026 from 11:00 Hours till 17:00 Hours

Last date for payment of final sale consideration

As per the ASPM available on the auction platform

Sr. No.	Asset Description	Auction Time	Auction ID on E-Auction Platform	Asset ID on E-Auction Platform	Reserve Price* (in INR)	Earnest Money Deposit (in INR)	Incremental Value (in INR)
1	Silver Coins-Maharashtra	11:00 AM to 5:00 PM	4826	3886	96% of Spot Price on Sep 29, 2026	50,497	1,000
2	Push Back Tractors and Tow bars-Delhi	11:00 AM to 5:00 PM	4827	4414	91,57,964	9,15,796	5,00,000
3	Aircraft Cabin Catering Trolleys-Maharashtra	11:00 AM to 5:00 PM	4828	3310	91,06,679	9,10,668	5,00,000
4	Coach (Buses)-Delhi	11:00 AM to 5:00 PM	4830	3874	59,55,755	5,95,576	3,00,000
5	Push Back Tractors and Tow bars-Maharashtra	11:00 AM to 5:00 PM	4831	4415	48,93,569	4,89,357	2,00,000
6	Tugs-Delhi	11:00 AM to 5:00 PM	4832	4416	40,07,435	4,00,743	2,00,000
7	Ground Power Unit-Maharashtra	11:00 AM to 5:00 PM	4834	3875	26,46,356	2,64,636	1,00,000
8	Tractors-Maharashtra	11:00 AM to 5:00 PM	4835	4417	23,64,627	2,36,463	1,00,000
9	Step Ladders, Trestles, Baggage trolleys-Maharashtra	11:00 AM to 5:00 PM	4845	3878	17,70,399	1,77,040	1,00,000
10	GPU and Trestles-Bangalore	11:00 AM to 5:00 PM	4578	4610	11,51,079	1,15,108	50,000
11	Tractor-Bangalore	11:00 AM to 5:00 PM	4582	4529	11,24,393	1,12,439	50,000
12	GSE (GPU, passenger ramp, etc.)-Jammu & Kashmir	11:00 AM to 5:00 PM	4846	4125	8,11,220	81,122	50,000
13	GPU, Ladders and Trestles-Hyderabad	11:00 AM to 5:00 PM	4870	4615	5,96,998	59,700	25,000
14	Cars Bangalore (Mahindra pickup and Maruti Eeco)-Bangalore	11:00 AM to 5:00 PM	4580	4527	5,58,169	55,817	25,000
15	Baggage Ladders-Delhi	11:00 AM to 5:00 PM	4847	4422	4,79,462	47,946	25,000
16	Erligas Bangalore-Bangalore	11:00 AM to 5:00 PM	4579	4526	4,23,291	42,329	25,000
17	GPU and other items-Nagpur	11:00 AM to 5:00 PM	4869	4616	3,43,905	34,390	10,000
18	GPU, Tractor, Tow bar and Other Items-Leh	11:00 AM to 5:00 PM	4865	4617	3,26,655	32,665	10,000
19	Air compressor and Tyres-Maharashtra	11:00 AM to 5:00 PM	4848	3884	3,26,064	32,606	10,000
20	Baggage Ladders and Step Ladder-Leh	11:00 AM to 5:00 PM	4867	4618	3,23,704	32,370	10,000
21	Trolleys-Bangalore	11:00 AM to 5:00 PM	4577	4609	93,022	9,302	5,000
22	Mahindra Imperio-Hyderabad	11:00 AM to 5:00 PM	4871	4608	77,889	7,789	5,000

*Excluding inter alia taxes, levies, charges, duties, transfer fees, stamp duty, registration fees, premiums, and all applicable essential expenses for consummating the sale. No representation, warranties and indemnities shall be provided by the undersigned.

Important Notes:

1. The e-auctions will be held individually for the 22 assets listed above.

2. This sale notice shall be read with the respective Asset Sale Process Documents (ASPDs) containing details of the assets, declarations, affidavits and undertakings for the eligibility under Section 29A of IBC, and 'General and Technical Terms and Conditions of the E-Auction Sale', available on [BAANKNET](https://ibbi.baanknet.com/) at this link

3. The prospective bidders shall submit the requisite eligibility documents and the EMD through the E-Auction Platform within the stipulated timelines.

4. The prospective bidders shall submit an undertaking that they do not suffer from any ineligibility under Section 29A of IBC to the extent applicable and that if found ineligible at any stage, the EMD shall be forfeited.

5. For any query regarding the e-auction please contact at (+91-8422884758) and gofirstauction@gmail.com with Subject "Go Airlines (India) Limited: Asset Sale".

6. It is clarified that this notice does not create any kind of binding obligation on the part of the undersigned or Go Airlines (India) Limited (in Liquidation) to effectuate the sale. Any decision taken by the undersigned shall be final and binding on all the prospective bidders.

Sd/-
Dinkar T. Venkatasubramanian
Liquidator of Go Airlines (India) Limited
IP Registration No: IBBI/IPA-001/IP-P00003/2016-17/10011
Address for Correspondence: Yesss/Works Spaces Private Limited
S13-S14, 2nd Floor Pinnacle Business Park
Shanti Nagar, Mahakali Caves Road,
Andheri East, Mumbai - 400 093
Auction Process Email - gofirstauction@gmail.com

Place: New Delhi
Date: September 13, 2026

Persistent

CIN: L72300PN1990PLC056696
Regd. Office : 'Bhageerath', 402 Senapati Bapat Road, Pune 411 016
Tel.: +91 (20) 6703 5555 Fax: +91 (20) 6703 6003
E-mail: investors@persistent.com; Website: www.persistent.com

NOTICE OF THE EXTRA ORDINARY GENERAL MEETING AND REMOTE E-VOTING INFORMATION

NOTICE is hereby given that the Extra Ordinary General Meeting ("EGM") of the Members of Persistent Systems Limited ("Company") will be held on **Monday, October 5, 2026, at 1600 Hrs. (IST)** at Persistent Systems Limited, Dewang Mehta Auditorium, 'Bhageerath', 402 Senapati Bapat Road, Pune 411 016, India, in person and through Video Conferencing ('VC')/Other Audio-Visual Means ('OAVM'), at the Members' convenience, to transact the businesses set out in the Notice of the EGM. The EGM will be held in accordance with the applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 and the Rules made thereunder, read with the General Circulars issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs ('MCA'), including the latest Circular No. 03/2025 dated September 22, 2025 (collectively, 'MCA Circulars'), and the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, read with the applicable circulars issued by the Securities and Exchange Board of India ('SEBI').

Participation by Members
Members may attend and participate in the EGM either in person or through the VC/OAVM facility. Detailed instructions for attending, voting and viewing the proceedings of the EGM are provided in the EGM Notice. Members attending the EGM in person or through VC/OAVM will be counted for the purpose of reckoning the quorum under Section 103 of the Companies Act, 2013

Electronic Dissemination and Availability of Documents
The EGM Notice along with the Explanatory Statement was sent on Saturday, September 12, 2026, through electronic mode to Members whose e-mail addresses were registered with the Company/Depositories as on Friday, September 4, 2026. A letter providing the web-link for accessing EGM Notice along with the Explanatory Statement will be sent to shareholders who have not registered their e-mail address with the Company/Depositories/RTA.

The EGM Notice is available at <https://www.persistent.com/wp-content/uploads/2026/09/Notice-of-the-Extra-Ordinary-General-Meeting-2026.pdf>.

The EGM Notice along with explanatory statement is also available on the websites of BSE Limited at www.bseindia.com, National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.nseindia.com, and NSDL at www.evoting.nsdl.com.

The documents referred to in the EGM Notice and Explanatory Statement are open for inspection at the Registered Office of the Company on all working days, except Saturdays, during business hours up to the date of the EGM. Electronic copies may be requested by e-mail at investors@persistent.com

Voting by Members
Pursuant to Section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013, Rule 20 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014 ("Rules"), as amended from time to time, and Regulation 44 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, the Company has provided its Members with the facility to cast their votes on the business items set out in the EGM Notice through remote e-voting / e-voting during the EGM / voting through ballot paper.

For the purpose of enabling Members to participate in the voting process through remote e-voting / e-voting during the EGM / voting through ballot paper and for determining their eligibility, Friday, September 25, 2026 has been fixed as the Cut-off Date. Members whose names appear in the Register of Members or in the Register of Beneficial Owners maintained by the Depositories as on the Cut-off Date, i.e., Friday, September 25, 2026 (IST), shall only be entitled to avail the facility of remote e-voting / e-voting during the EGM / voting through ballot paper and to cast their votes within thirty minutes after the conclusion of the EGM.

The voting rights of Members shall be in proportion to their share in the paid-up equity share capital of the Company as on Friday, September 25, 2026 (IST).

The Board of Directors has appointed SVD & Associates, Practicing Company Secretaries, Pune (represented by Mr. Sridhar Mudaliar (FCS 6156, COP 2664) or failing him Ms. Sheetal Joshi (FCS 10480, COP 11635) as the Scrutiniser to scrutinise the remote e-voting process in a fair and transparent manner.

The details pursuant to the provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 and the applicable Rules are given hereunder:

Date of completion of dispatch of the EGM Notice along with the Explanatory Statement through email:	Saturday, September 12, 2026
Date and time of commencement of remote e-Voting:	Monday, September 28, 2026, from 0900 Hrs. (IST)
Date and time of the end of remote e-Voting:	Sunday, October 4, 2026, till 1700 Hrs. (IST).

1. Please note that the remote e-Voting module shall be disabled after this date and time, and the Members will not be able to vote beyond Sunday, October 4, 2026, till 1700 Hrs. (IST).

2. The facility for casting the vote through e-Voting or Ballot Paper will be made available at the EGM and the Members attending the EGM who have not cast their vote by means of remote e-Voting may cast their vote at the time of the EGM.

3. The Members who have cast their vote by remote e-Voting may also attend the EGM but shall not be entitled to cast their vote again.

4. Electronic Voting Event Number (EVEN) of the Company is: 143086

5. The Notice of the EGM is available on the website of the Company at <https://www.persistent.com/wp-content/uploads/2026/07/agm-notice-2026.pdf> and also on the website of NSDL at www.evoting.nsdl.com.

6. Any person who acquires shares of the Company and becomes a Member of the Company after dispatch of the Notice and holding shares as of the cut-off date i.e. Friday, September 25, 2026, may obtain the login ID and password by sending a request at evoting@nsdl.com or to the Company / MUFG Intime India Private Limited, Registrar and Share Transfer Agent ("MUFG Intime" / "RTA").

7. For electronic voting instructions, the Members may go through the instructions in the Notice of the EGM, and in case of any queries, may refer to the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) for Members and e-Voting user manual for Members available in the downloads section of www.evoting.nsdl.com or call free telephone no. 022-4886 7000 or send a request at evoting@nsdl.com.

8. In case of any queries / grievances relating to the e-Voting, please contact Mr. Amit Vishal, Deputy Vice President or Ms. Pallavi Mhatre, Sr. Manager-NSDL, 301, 3rd Floor, Naman Chambers, Plot C-32, G-Block, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra East, Mumbai, Maharashtra 400 051 at evoting@nsdl.com or at toll free telephone no. 022-4886 7000.

9. Helpline details for Individual Shareholders holding securities in Demat mode for any technical issues related to logging in through Depository i.e. NSDL and CDSL are as follows.

Login type	Helpdesk details
Individual Shareholders holding securities in Demat mode with NSDL	Members facing any technical issue in login can contact the NSDL helpdesk by sending a request at evoting@nsdl.com or call at 022-4886 7000
Individual Shareholders holding securities in Demat mode with CDSL	Members facing any technical issue in login can contact the CDSL helpdesk by sending a request at helpdesk.evoting@cdslindia.com or contact at toll free no. 1800-21-09911

You can also access EGM-related information by scanning this QR code.

By the order of the Board of Directors
For Persistent Systems Limited
Amit Atre
Company Secretary
ICSI Membership No.: ACS 20507

Date: September 12, 2026
Place: Pune

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Message from the Chargé d’Affaires



YUDHO SASONGKO

Chargé d’Affaires of Indonesia to India and Bhutan

As Indonesia celebrated the 81st anniversary of its Independence and India rejoiced at its 80th Independence, both in August, it is a fitting moment to reflect upon the enduring bonds of friendship that unite Indonesia and India. This occasion reminds us of the sacrifices and perseverance of the founders of our nations, and of a partnership grounded not only in geographical proximity but in shared history, values, and aspirations.

Indonesia and India are maritime neighbours, cultural cousins, and partners in the quest for freedom and dignity. Our peoples drew strength from each other’s struggles for independence, inspired by leaders such as Sukarno, Nehru, Sjahrir, and Biju Patnaik, who envisioned a world where sovereignty, solidarity, and justice would guide international relations. That spirit found expression in the 1955 Bandung Conference, which laid the foundation for the Non-Aligned Movement and continues to resonate today as a pillar of cooperation across the Global South.

The past two years have raised the Indonesia-India partnership to a new level. In January 2025, President Prabowo Subianto paid a visit to India as Chief Guest at the 76th Republic Day celebrations, and Prime Minister Narendra Modi returned the favour by undertaking a visit to Indonesia in July 2026. Exchanged within eighteen months, these visits produced a substantive cooperation agenda spanning defence and maritime security, critical minerals, digital transformation, health, agriculture, and education, which further provides our relationship with a strategic depth commensurate with the weight our two nations carry in Asia and beyond.

Culture and heritage remain the soul of this partnership. The joint restoration of the Prambanan Temple Compounds, the designation of 2026–2027 as the Tagore–Dewantara Year of Cultural and Educational Diplomacy, joint tourism promotions, expanding air connectivity, and growing academic collaboration have brought our peoples closer than ever, sustaining a dialogue between our artistic and spiritual traditions that is far older than our republics. Above all, our vibrant and forward-looking young generations hold the key to ensuring this partnership continues to flourish.

Looking ahead, our two countries stand as partners in shaping inclusive cooperation in this multipolar world through ASEAN - India frameworks, the G20, and BRICS. Indonesia’s accession to BRICS as a full member in January 2025 opens a further avenue for a common purpose. Within BRICS, Indonesia seeks a fairer international architecture in which the voice of the Global South is properly represented. We therefore look forward with anticipation to the fruitful results of the BRICS Summit in New Delhi on 12 - 13 September 2026.

I express my appreciation to The Indian Express for providing a platform to showcase the richness of our bilateral ties, and my gratitude to all friends of Indonesia and India who continue to nurture this friendship. Our two nations have always walked side by side as partners in dialogue, diversity, and dignity, and will keep doing so.

Terima kasih. Dhanyavaad. Thank you.

“India – Indonesia: Shared Civilizational Heritage”



India and Indonesia share a deep cultural bond shaped by centuries of exchange. From the enduring stories of the Ramayana and Mahabharata to art, architecture, and spiritual traditions, the shared heritage continues to connect the two nations.

India is also an important tourism market for Indonesia, with growing interest among Indian travellers. This reflects the strong cultural affinity between the two countries and offers significant opportunities to further strengthen tourism exchanges and people-to-people connections.

The recent visit of Prime Minister Modi to the iconic UNESCO World Heritage listed Prambanan Temple Complex in Yogyakarta, alongside President Prabowo Subianto, further highlighted these enduring ties. The leaders unveiled a plaque marking the commencement of the Archaeological Survey of India’s (ASI) conservation and restoration project at the temple complex.

During the visit, Prime Minister Modi was also conferred with the Bintang Adipurna (Star of the Republic of Indonesia), Indonesia’s highest civilian honour, reflecting the deepening ties and close friendship between the two countries.

Built in the 9th century, Prambanan is Indonesia’s largest temple complex dedicated to the Trimurti—Lord Brahma, Lord Vishnu, and Lord Shiva. Its magnificent architecture and spiritual legacy stand as an enduring symbol of the shared civilizational heritage between India and Indonesia.

Further strengthening these cultural links, the two countries have designated 2026–2027 as the Tagore-Dewantara Year, aimed at promoting closer cultural and educational exchanges. The initiative commemorates the historic meeting in Yogyakarta in 1927 between Indonesian education pioneer Ki Hajar Dewantara and Indian poet, philosopher, and Nobel laureate Rabindranath Tagore.

Rooted in Indonesia. Growing with the world

Indonesia has always been more than our country of origin. It is the ground beneath everything we have built.

For over four decades, APP Group has grown from an Indonesian enterprise into one of the world’s leading pulp and paper companies with manufacturing, distribution, and partnership networks spanning more than 150 countries. Yet through every stage of that journey, Indonesia has remained our anchor, the source of our raw materials, the home of our largest operations, and the wellspring of the values that define how we do business.

Today, as President Prabowo Subianto visits New Delhi for the BRICS Summit, APP Group joins in extending a warm and respectful

welcome. His Excellency’s presence at this forum is a testament to Indonesia’s growing stature as a global economic force and a moment of pride for every Indonesian enterprise operating on the world stage.

The BRICS nations are not abstract geopolitical designations to us, they are markets where our products reach end-consumers, countries where our partnerships have helped build supply chains, and nations whose sustainable development aspirations align with our own.

At the same time, we recognise that economic ambition must be matched by environmental responsibility. APP Group has spent years building operations that respect the natural systems

underpinning Indonesia’s long-term prosperity, from responsible land management to investments in cleaner production across our mills. As we continue to supply packaging, tissue, and printing products to BRICS nations and beyond, sustainable stewardship remains inseparable from how we grow.

The BRICS Summit in New Delhi is an opportunity for dialogue, for partnership, and for the kind of durable multilateral cooperation that creates shared prosperity. APP Group is proud to support Indonesia’s voice in that conversation.

Selamat datang, Bapak Presiden. The world is watching—and Indonesia is ready.

refined petroleum products, meat, and pharmaceuticals. Overall, the trade relationship remains significantly tilted in Indonesia’s favour.

Indian companies have invested more than US\$1.5 billion in Indonesia across nearly 7,300 projects since 2000, with significant contributions from Tata Power and Adani in the energy and mining sectors, TCS, HCL, and Tech Mahindra in information technology, as well as pharmaceutical majors such as Dr. Reddy’s and Aurobindo, alongside financial institutions including SBI and Bank of India. In contrast, Indonesian investments in India total around US\$668 million since 2000 and are concentrated in palm oil and agribusiness, infrastructure, and consumer goods through approximately 100 companies.

With BRICS providing an expanded platform for economic collaboration, the India-Indonesia partnership, underpinned by strong linkages in energy, pharmaceuticals, technology, and agricultural trade, is well positioned to serve as a key example of South-South economic cooperation.



Sohrab Bararia, Partner and Leader - Global Trade & Incentives Advisory, Grant Thornton Bharat

India-Indonesia Expand Cooperation

Health is emerging as a key pillar of the India-Indonesia Comprehensive Strategic Partnership, with the two countries expanding cooperation across healthcare delivery, affordable medicines, medical education, hospital investments and traditional medicine.

Through an Implementation Arrangement on Professional Health Workforce Development, India and Indonesia are creating opportunities for fellowships, specialised clinical training, skills enhancement and the exchange of medical expertise—strengthening healthcare capabilities while deepening professional and people-to-people ties between the two countries.

India’s Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO) and Indonesia’s Food and Drug Authority (BPOM) are working together on the regulation of medical products. This cooperation will simplify approval processes and facilitate the movement of quality Indian pharmaceutical products into the Indonesian market.

India’s globally recognised strength in generic medicines also offers significant opportunities for Indonesia. Greater trade in medicines and pharmaceutical components can help diversify and strengthen supply chains, while supporting access to quality and affordable treatments.

Indian Private-sector healthcare providers are expanding their footprint in Indonesia, with Apollo Hospitals partnering with the Mayapada Group on the Mayapada Apollo Batam International Hospital.

Indian Private-Sector healthcare providers are expanding their footprint in Indonesia, with Apollo Hospitals partnering with the Mayapada Group on the Mayapada Apollo Batam International Hospital. The venture is expected to enhance specialised healthcare services while supporting Indonesia’s ambitions in medical tourism.

Cooperation between India’s Ministry of AYUSH and Indonesia’s BPOM on traditional medicine quality assurance aims to promote the safe and regulated development of Ayurveda and Indonesia’s traditional wellness practices.

Together, these initiatives show that India-Indonesia health cooperation is moving beyond conventional diplomacy. By connecting medicines, medical professionals, hospitals, technology and traditional knowledge, the partnership is creating new pathways towards more accessible, affordable and capable healthcare systems.

Indonesia's SEZs: A Gateway for Indian Investment

As India hosts the 18th BRICS Summit, the grouping’s growing economic weight offers an opportunity to translate diplomatic ties into greater trade, investment and business linkages. For Indian companies, Indonesia, which joined BRICS in 2025, with its strategic location, large market and access to ASEAN, can serve as an important gateway to Southeast Asia.

Indonesia manages over 25 active Special Economic Zones (SEZs), which offer sector specific infrastructure and investment incentives. For Indian healthcare companies, Batam’s Health SEZ presents opportunities in medical research, advanced diagnostics, pharmaceuticals and international healthcare services.

Kendal and Sei Mangkei can attract manufacturers in areas such as electronics, EV components and agro-processing, while East Java’s Singhasari SEZ offers prospects in digital services, tourism and high-technology education.

The attraction is not merely geographical, SEZs provide Indian investors with a range of fiscal, customs and administrative incentives, including:

● **Tax holidays:** Corporate income tax reductions of up to 0% for periods of 10–20 years, depending on the scale of qualifying capital investment, including investments above IDR 100 billion.

● **Import and VAT exemptions:** Exemptions or relief from import duties and VAT on qualifying raw materials, factory equipment and capital machinery.

● **Greater foreign ownership flexibility:** Relaxation of certain restrictions under Indonesia’s national Positive Investment List, enabling 100% foreign ownership in eligible activities within designated SEZs, subject to applicable regulations.

● **Regional market access:** Indian enterprises can use Indonesian SEZs as a gateway to the 680-million-strong ASEAN market and wider RCEP markets, benefiting from preferential tariff access subject to applicable trade agreements and rules of origin.

The BRICS Summit can serve as a platform to deepen India-Indonesia business ties. A focused SEZ investment dialogue could translate strategic cooperation into factories, technology partnerships, healthcare ventures and jobs.



IIM Bangalore Campus Deepens India–Indonesia Ties

Indian Institute of Management Bangalore (IIMB) is establishing its first international campus at the Singhasari Special Economic Zone (SEZ) in Malang, Indonesia, marking a major step in the global expansion of Indian higher education and India–Indonesia cooperation.

The campus serves Indonesian students and professionals while also attracting learners from across the ASEAN region. It follows a two-phase model, beginning with Executive Education Programmes for senior executives, business leaders and public-sector professionals, followed by degree-granting management programmes.

Its curriculum focuses on emerging areas such as artificial intelligence, digital transformation, global supply chains, climate and sustainability, and healthcare management. The initiative also promotes research, faculty development, consulting and industry collaboration.

The campus has significance beyond education. By connecting students, academics and business leaders, it strengthens people-to-people and business ties and gives India a stronger knowledge presence in ASEAN. It complements growing cooperation in trade, technology, critical minerals, maritime security and defence.

The initiative supports the internationalisation objectives of National Education Policy 2020 and has the potential to position Singhasari as a

regional hub for management education and leadership development.

IIMB's Indonesia campus thus represents a new chapter in India's educational outreach and an important instrument of knowledge diplomacy and long-term India–Indonesia engagement.



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Indonesia is stepping up efforts to tap India's vast wedding industry, estimated at \$60–75 billion and considered the world's second-largest wedding market after the US. With destination weddings gaining traction among affluent Indian travellers, Bali is emerging as a key focus of Indonesia's outreach. Wedding tourism has been identified as a priority segment alongside honeymoons, family travel and MICE.

Bali's deep-rooted Hindu heritage gives the island a natural cultural affinity with Indian couples. Its temples, traditions and ceremonies offer families the opportunity to incorporate familiar customs into their celebrations. Luxury resorts in Nusa Dua, Jimbaran and Ubud add to the appeal, offering event spaces, accommodation and wellness facilities, along with an expanding range of Indian, vegetarian and Jain culinary options.

Indonesia is also deepening its engagement with Indian wedding planners and the travel trade through familiarisation trips, B2B meetings, sales missions and destination showcases.

With outreach expanding across major Indian cities, the country is presenting Bali and other destinations as a combination of cultural familiarity, tropical settings and international hospitality. The growing focus on weddings also offers a new avenue to deepen tourism and people-to-people ties between India and Indonesia.

Strengthening Defence Ties

India–Indonesia defence ties are entering a new phase. What began with military exchanges and maritime cooperation is increasingly expanding into defence trade, technology and industrial partnerships, reflecting growing strategic convergence between the two countries in the Indo-Pacific.

The 2018 Defence Cooperation Agreement strengthened institution-

alised military engagement, including regular Army-to-Army Staff Talks. Exercises such as Garuda Shakti and the multilateral KOMODO have further enhanced interoperability and operational cooperation.

Maritime security remains central to the relationship. Since 2002, the Indian and Indonesian navies have conducted coordinated patrols in the Indian Ocean, contributing to the security of vital sea lanes and reflecting their shared interest in a stable and secure Indo-Pacific.

The relationship has gained further momentum through defence-industrial cooperation. The recent BrahMos contract with Indonesia's Ministry of Defence marks a significant milestone for India's defence exports and its growing presence in Southeast Asia. BrahMos, one of the world's fastest cruise missiles, can travel at Mach 2.8–3.0 and has an export range of up to 290km.

An agreement between Bharat Dynamics Limited and Indonesia's defence holding company Republikorp for the Astra beyond-visual-range air-to-air missile further expands this cooperation. With the Astra Mk-1 being integrated onto Indonesian fighter aircraft, the partnership is increasingly moving towards defence technology and equipment collaboration.

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APP Group welcomes BRICS Summit India 2026 and reaffirms its commitment to sustainable growth, trade, and cooperation across BRICS Economies.

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BRICS INDIA 2026

SUNDAY, SEPTEMBER 13, 2026



Prime Minister Narendra Modi welcomes (from left) Brazil's Foreign Minister Mauro Vieira; South African President Cyril Ramaphosa; Ethiopian Prime Minister Abiy Ahmed; and Indonesian President Prabowo Subianto at the BRICS summit on Saturday

DEEPENING INVESTMENT TIES

India seeks bigger role for UAE's new \$300-bn fund

New sovereign fund to expand in emerging sectors

MUKESH JAGOTA
New Delhi, September 12

PRIME MINISTER NARENDRA Modi and Abu Dhabi Crown Prince Sheikh Khaled bin Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan on Saturday discussed a bigger role for L'IMAD, the UAE's newest sovereign investment fund, in India, as the two countries look to deepen investment ties in strategic and emerging sectors.

At their meeting on the sidelines of the 18th BRICS Summit, the leaders welcomed UAE-based International Holding Company's (IHC) proposed \$11.5-billion integrated greenfield aluminium project in Odisha, described as India's largest integrated aluminium investment. The project is expected

GROWING FOOTPRINT

■ International Holding Company proposes \$11.5-bn integrated aluminium project in Odisha

■ The project is expected to strengthen Odisha's position as a global aluminium manufacturing centre

■ L'IMAD, the newest sovereign investment fund, was created by consolidating ADQ's assets & investments

■ ADIA and Mubadala already have major India exposure, including investments in Jio, Reliance Retail & Tata Power



PM Narendra Modi with Abu Dhabi Crown Prince Sheikh Khaled bin Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan, on Saturday

to strengthen Odisha's position as a global aluminium manufacturing hub and underscores the UAE's growing interest in large-scale Indian industrial projects. The two leaders specifically noted the potential of L'IMAD to deepen the India-UAE partnership, while also discussing

cooperation in defence, space, nuclear energy, technology and innovation, according to a statement by the Ministry of External Affairs. L'IMAD is a new Abu Dhabi sovereign investment platform created after the consolidation of ADQ's assets and investments. With an estimated

asset base of around \$300 billion, it has inherited ADQ's investments and is focused on sectors including energy, infrastructure, logistics, ports, aviation and industry.

Its India-linked portfolio includes ADQ's earlier investment in Tata Motors' electric-vehicle business.

India is now seeking to attract more UAE sovereign capital into infrastructure, strategic industries and emerging technologies.

The UAE already has substantial sovereign investment exposure to India through Abu Dhabi Investment Authority (ADIA) and Mubadala. Abu Dhabi Investment Authority is an anchor investor in the National Investment and Infrastructure Fund, while Mubadala has invested in Jio Platforms, Reliance Retail and Tata Power Renewable Energy.

The meeting followed high-level exchanges this year, including UAE President Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan's visit to India in January and Modi's visit to the UAE in May.

The two leaders also welcomed the UAE's active participation in BRICS under India's chairmanship and reaffirmed the Comprehensive Strategic Partnership spanning political, commercial, energy and people-to-people ties.

TO REDUCE TRANSACTION COSTS

BRICS nations push for local currency in trade

MUKESH JAGOTA
New Delhi, September 12

BRICS COUNTRIES ARE pushing for greater use of national currencies in trade and investment and interoperability of cross-border payment systems to cut transaction costs, even as the grouping stepped up criticism of unilateral tariffs and protectionist measures. "There is no proposal in the BRICS for a BRICS currency. The focus is how we can do more intra-BRICS trade and how we can engage with the global business community more actively and reduce transaction costs through trade in national currencies," Secretary (Economic Relations) and India's BRICS Sherpa Sudhakar Delela said.

The New Delhi Declaration adopted at the 18th BRICS Summit said members were working towards interoperability of payment and messaging channels and exploring practical mechanisms for cross-border payments. It also backed discussions on trade settlements and investments using BRICS local currencies, while stressing there would be no "one-size-fits-all" approach.

The push comes amid growing fragmentation in global trade and rising tariff barriers. The declaration expressed "serious concerns" over unilateral tariff and non-tariff measures that distort trade and are inconsistent with World Trade Organization (WTO) rules. It warned that rising tariffs, non-tariff barriers and protectionism in the guise of environmental objectives could reduce global trade, disrupt supply chains and increase uncertainty in international economic activity. BRICS opposed unilateral, punitive and discriminatory measures imposed in the name of climate policy, including CBAM, saying such measures could place additional burdens on developing countries. The group has reaffirmed support for a non-discriminatory, open, equitable, transparent and rules-based multilateral trading system with the WTO at its core.

The declaration said the multilateral trading system had "long been at a crossroads" and called for the WTO to become more responsive to trade disruptions and the needs of emerging markets and developing economies.

COST FOCUS



NO BRICS CURRENCY
Focus is on using national currencies for intra-BRICS trade and investment

CROSS-BORDER PAYMENTS
Members seek interoperable payment systems to lower transaction costs

TARIFF PUSHBACK
BRICS criticised unilateral tariffs, non-tariff barriers and protectionism

WTO AT THE CORE
Called for a fully functioning two-tier dispute settlement system and a stronger WTO

STRONGER VALUE CHAINS
Global Value Chains Action Plan 2026-30 aims to help developing economies move up the value chain

A key demand is the immediate restoration of a fully functioning, two-tier, binding WTO dispute settlement mechanism and the appointment of new Appellate Body members. The dispute settlement system has remained effectively paralysed since December 2019 after the US blocked appointments to the Appellate Body.

BRICS also reiterated support for the WTO's foundational principles, including most-favoured-nation treatment and special and differential treatment for developing countries, particularly least developed countries.

The grouping endorsed further work on the Global Value Chains Action Plan 2026-2030, with a focus on helping emerging and developing economies move up the value chain. It also called for greater trade facilitation, connectivity, critical infrastructure, technology access and digitisation of global value chains.

The declaration also sought to ease financing constraints faced by export-oriented micro, small and medium enterprises. It backed digital and platform-based trade-finance mechanisms and the study of an invoice-discounting mechanism under the Jaipur Consensus to help MSMEs unlock working capital.

Special Economic Zones (SEZs) are also being positioned as hubs for trade, investment, industrial cooperation and integration into resilient global value chains, while BRICS members plan greater cooperation on digitising trade documentation.

At the broader level, leaders endorsed continued progress on the Strategy for BRICS Economic Partnership 2030 as the overarching framework for closer economic cooperation and commended India for steering its development during its 2026 chairship.

FM, AIIB chief discuss ways to further ties

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 12

FINANCE MINISTER NIRMALA Sitharaman on Saturday met Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB) President Zou Jiyang, on the sidelines of the BRICS Summit, and discussed opportunities to further deepen the India-AIIB partnership.

"They discussed opportunities to further deepen the India-AIIB partnership, support India's infrastructure and transport connectivity priorities, enhance local-currency financing, increase private sector participation and global presence of AIIB," the finance ministry said in a post on X.

Iran, UAE find consensus at BRICS

SHUBHAJIT ROY
New Delhi, September 12

AS THE SIX-month-long West Asia war flares up with US and Iran exchanging strikes, India achieved the much-anticipated – and the much-fraught – consensus at the BRICS summit between UAE and Iran after hectic negotiations paving the way for the joint declaration adopted Saturday.

Against this backdrop, UAE's crown prince Sheikh Khaled bin Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan, who is the Crown Prince of Abu Dhabi, met Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian on the margins of the BRICS summit.

In paragraph 28 of the joint declaration, the BRICS leaders said, "We express deep concern



Iran President Pezeshkian with UAE Crown Prince Khaled bin Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan

over the continued escalation of tensions in Middle East/West Asia and, recalling our respective national positions, call for exercising maxi-

mum restraint, as well as avoiding actions that could further aggravate the situation."

The declaration acknowledged the sensibilities of both

sides by flagging territorial sovereignty and the need to secure civilians and infrastructure. UAE has been at the receiving end of a series of Iranian strikes on its cities with Tehran calling it a proxy of the United States. In addition, the declaration underscored dialogue and diplomacy and smooth flow of energy – all important issues and challenges faced by all the countries from the developing countries.

"We encourage increasing efforts, through dialogue and diplomacy, towards a long-term understanding that will contribute to lasting peace, security and stability in the region. We stress the need to work together to maintain smooth flow of global trade, supply chains and energy, in accordance with applicable international law."

Delegates get to enjoy shahtoot phirni, cultural performances at gala dinner

ANI
New Delhi, September 12

PRIME MINISTER NARENDRA Modi hosted a gala dinner for BRICS leaders and delegates at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi on Saturday, with Russian President Vladimir Putin, Kazakhstan President Kassym-Jomart Tokayev, Indonesian President Prabowo Subianto and World Health Organization Director-General Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus among those attending the event.

The dinner was held for global leaders and delegates attending the 18th BRICS Summit, under India's chairship. Union Ministers Nirmala Sitharaman, Kiren Rijiju, Sarbananda Sonowal and Arjun Ram Meghwal, along with Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath and other chief ministers, travelled together by bus for the dinner. Union Home Minister Amit



PM Narendra Modi with BRICS leaders applaud as they watch artists perform at the dinner

Shah, Union Health Minister JP Nadda and Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla also left for the venue along with other ministers.

The vegetarian menu for the BRICS Leaders' Dinner brought together a curated selection of regional Indian delicacies, offering world leaders a taste of the country's diverse culinary traditions. The meal began with *Khandvi Mille-Feuille*, a steamed gram-

flour roll tempered with mustard, coconut and curry leaves, and *Khumb Galouti*, tender pan-grilled mushroom kebabs served with mint pearls and sheermal. The main course featured *Paneer Lababdar*, *Gucchi Marmik* made with Himalayan morel mushrooms and asparagus, Carrot Bean *Poriyal* prepared with South Indian spices and coconut, *Thakkali Belle Saaru*, millet *pulao*, beetroot

raita and assorted Indian breads. Desserts included Old Delhi's Fruit Cream with *alebi* and *Shahtoot Phirni*, a slow-cooked milk-and-rice pudding topped with mulberries and gold leaf. The menu brought together flavours from the Himalayas, South India and Old Delhi, highlighting the breadth of India's regional culinary heritage.

A special cultural performance, *Navarasa – The Universe of Shared Emotions*, was presented during the gala dinner. The programme also featured the BRICS Symphony, *One Rhythm, Many Cultures*, bringing together musicians from BRICS member and partner countries in a collaborative musical performance.

Drawing on diverse musical traditions, the symphony sought to showcase a shared artistic expression reflecting the cultural richness, diversity and spirit of togetherness of the BRICS family.

Cultural detour at BRICS Bazaar

ANI
New Delhi, September 12

DAUGHTER OF IRANIAN President Masoud Pezeshkian, Zahra Pezeshkian, and her husband, Hassan Majidi, visited the BRICS Bazaar at the National Crafts Museum on Saturday, exploring textiles, handicrafts and cultural displays representing BRICS member and partner countries. The visit, shared by the official Iranian Embassy in India account, added a cultural dimension to the ongoing BRICS engagements in the capital.

Videos from the bazaar show Zahra in a black abaya viewing textile and craft displays, including the Iranian showcase, and posing for photographs with Indian representatives in front of a BRICS India 2026 backdrop.

Union Minister for Women and Child Development and Kodarma Lok Sabha MP Annapurna Devi also shared a carousel of



Zahra Pezeshkian (right), daughter of Iranian president, with artisans at the bazaar on Saturday

photographs from the visit. Welcoming Zahra to the bazaar, she wrote, "It was a pleasure to welcome Ms Zahra Pezeshkian, daughter of Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian, to the BRICS Bazaar at the National Crafts Museum, New Delhi".

The BRICS Bazaar, being held at the National Crafts Museum and Hastkala Academy from September 10 to 15, places traditional

craftsmanship at the centre of the wider BRICS programme in New Delhi.

The exhibition features textiles and crafts reflecting the distinct cultural traditions of participating countries, including woven stripes and ikat motifs, brocade and jacquard work, and printed and dyed cotton and silk textiles. Country panels represent Iran, India, China, Brazil, Bolivia, Egypt, Ethiopia,

Indonesia, Kazakhstan, Russia, Saudi Arabia, South Africa, Thailand, the United Arab Emirates, Uzbekistan, Cuba, Belarus, Malaysia, Nigeria, Uganda and Vietnam, alongside additional partner and member-country displays. The Iranian panel forms part of a broader textile installation bringing together regional weaving, printing and dyeing traditions in a single visual display.

Words Worth

SUNDAY, SEPTEMBER 13, 2026

SRINATH SRIDHARAN

LIAQUAT AHAMED'S GRIPPING history of the first global financial crisis shows how speculation, leverage and human folly can travel from markets into politics, society and the lives of ordinary people. Reading Liaquat Ahamed's *1873* gives one of those strange experiences in which history begins to look less like history and more like a film we have watched before. The railroad mania of the nineteenth century has an unmistakable echo in today's excitement around artificial intelligence. Markets are buoyant, capital is chasing a transformative technology, valuations can run ahead of underlying cash flows, and everyone has a convincing reason why this time is different.

In India, the backdrop is even more layered: demographic transition, the rapid formalisation of finance, high public and private investment, geopolitical fragmentation, supply-chain rewiring, energy transition, climate risk and the possibility that AI will alter jobs and productivity before institutions have understood its consequences. The worry is familiar enough to make the past feel uncomfortably close. *1873* is a story of how financial excess escapes the balance sheet and enters the bloodstream of society.

Ahamed's story begins when the world itself was becoming newly connected. By the end of the 1860s, railways were stitching countries together, capital was crossing borders and governments and entrepreneurs had discovered the bond market as a way of borrowing against the future. America was building railways across a continent. Germany was flush with funds from the French indemnity after the Franco-Prussian War. Vienna was awash with property speculation. British and French bankers were financing projects and sovereign borrowers far beyond their own shores. The world economy had enjoyed two extraordinary decades of growth, trade had expanded dramatically and capital investment had surged.

Then came May 1873. The Vienna Stock Exchange collapsed. In a single day the market lost nearly half its value. The panic travelled to Berlin and, across the Atlantic, to New York, where the failure of Jay Cooke & Co, one of America's most important investment houses, turned anxiety into a banking panic. Railway bonds unravelled, companies failed, investors lost fortunes and construction projects stopped. The new transatlantic cable meant financial fear could cross the ocean at unprecedented speed.

But the most revealing stories are not always in the trading rooms. Ahamed follows the shock into Egypt, where Khedive Ismail had borrowed heavily for canals, railways, palaces and the ambitions of a ruler determined to make Egypt look like a modern European power. Debt eventually became a route to foreign control, culminating in Britain's takeover of Egypt. In the Ottoman Empire, sovereign borrowing and financial weakness produced another kind of humiliation: default eroded fiscal sovereignty and opened the door to greater European influence. In



A file photo of the Vienna Stock Exchange, which crashed on May 9, 1873, setting off a devastating global economic downturn known as the 'Long Depression'

THE BOOK IS A REMINDER THAT FINANCIAL RESILIENCE BEGINS WITH STRONG CAPITAL AND DISCIPLINED LEVERAGE

the extraordinary reach of private finance. Politicians, monarchs, bankers and speculators repeatedly convince themselves that they can control forces that have already begun to outrun them. Ahamed has a gift for making these figures feel alive, with their vanity, intelligence, courage, greed and blind spots.

One description in the book is especially unsettling. Antonio Gallenga, *The Times'* correspondent in Constantinople, wrote in the 1870s of a man who seemed "destitute of all powers of reasoning", incapable of breaking through "the magic circle of his concentrated selfishness" to feel sympathy for another human being. It could have been written yesterday.

Across politics, business and public life, human society has acquired extraordinary material power without necessarily acquiring greater wisdom. Our machines are faster. Our markets are deeper. Our communication is instant. The human capacity for vanity, self-interest and wilful blindness remains stubbornly intact.

That is perhaps the hardest lesson of *1873*. The book is a further reminder that financial resilience begins with strong capital and disciplined leverage. History has delivered that warning repeatedly, across countries, markets, financial products and generations, and yet every boom persuades people that old restraints have become obsolete. Still, the temptation to borrow against an imagined future remains remarkably durable. In an interconnected world, who will save individuals and institutions from themselves?

Ahamed's achievement is to make that question difficult to dismiss. 1873 was not merely a year in which a stock exchange fell. It was the moment a new global financial system discovered how quickly confidence could travel, how painfully debt could settle, and how easily distress could become political resentment and social hatred. It left behind deflation, populism, protectionism, anti-semitism and a rearrangement of power that reached from Wall Street to Constantinople, Cairo and the American South. Every serious history of global finance eventually brings us back to prudence and human folly. Ahamed does so with a storyteller's instinct for character and consequence. By the end, the reader has almost been transported into that century: hearing the market panic, watching fortunes disappear, seeing governments improvise and societies search for someone to blame.

And then comes the question that refuses to remain in the nineteenth century. After so many crashes, so much regulation, so much financial sophistication and so much accumulated knowledge, have we really learnt from the past?

Srinath Sridharan is an author, corporate adviser & independent director on corporate boards

THE CRASH that looks familiar

A reminder how financial excess can escape the balance sheet to enter the bloodstream of society

America, economic distress and political fatigue helped weaken reconstruction.

The Rothschilds sit at the centre of this sprawling narrative. Their banking instinct was conservative enough to keep them from many of the excesses that damaged others. Yet when the system broke, their name became useful to people looking for someone to blame. Ahamed shows how financial confusion can acquire a political vocabulary: the complicated mechanics of debt, currencies and speculation become easier to explain through conspiracy. The anger directed at Jewish financiers was one of the darker afterlives of the crisis, showing how quickly economic grievance can mutate into social hatred.

And then there is money itself. This is



1873: The First Great Depression and the Making of the Modern World
Liaquat Ahamed
Penguin Random House
Pp 368, ₹1,499

where *1873* becomes more than a story of a market crash. As major economies moved away from silver and towards gold, the supply of money tightened just when economies were struggling under debt. Prices fell for years. Deflation made debts heavier in real terms, squeezed

farmers and producers, and strengthened the position of creditors. What looked like an arcane argument about gold and silver became a fight over who would carry the burden of adjustment. One reason the bond market matters so much in Ahamed's story is that bonds reveal the price at which the world is willing to finance an ambition. They bring together the borrower's credibility, the investor's risk appetite, the cost of money and the market's collective judgment about the future.

A lesson for Indian financial experts is that its corporate bond trading remains shallow and concentrated. A deeper debt market would give the economy something more valuable than another source of capital: a sharper market-based measure of how the world prices India's risk, growth and ambition.

Ahamed's history becomes particularly alive when it moves between finance and human behaviour. Mark Twain appears as an amused and sceptical observer of the speculative age. Karl Marx watches capitalism's convulsions from another vantage point. Jay Gould represents the ruthless opportunism of the period. The Rothschild family embodies

A question of roots

about the physical world, you still need something more," Vassanji says.

He was also drawn to the Mongols, the Nizari Ismailis, also known as the 'Assassins', and Alamut, the Persian mountain fortress destroyed by the Mongols in the 13th century. Alamut has a personal resonance for Vassanji, who comes from a Khoja Ismaili background and has written about tracing his community's spiritual and historical roots in Gujarat back through its pirs and teachers. From there, his reading led him to Alaudin's violent final years and the rise of his slave-turned general, Malik Kafur.

Another text fascinated him: the animal fables in the *Epistles of the Brethren of Purity*, in which animals make their case against humans before the King of the Jinn. The work sharpened his interest in creation, knowledge and humanity's treatment of animals. "I learned a lot," he says. Yet he is wary of pretending every historical thread must neatly connect. "When you've read enough, then some of the connections come," he says. "And some don't come."

The novel's deepest argument is about assimilation. "When the Mongols came here, the Sultan had started local culture to accommodate," Vassanji says, thinking aloud about how societies change when new people arrive. The British did the same in another form elsewhere. With every encounter comes resistance, adaptation, fear and exchange. "The same anxieties of losing your history, your identity, your culture," he says. "And at the same time assimilating, whether you want to or not."

In his latest novel, MG Vassanji speaks about his East African past, migration and assimilation

Born in Nairobi (Kenya) to Indian immigrants, raised in Tanzania and later settled in Canada after studying in the United States, Vassanji knows that unease intimately. Even Swahili, which he speaks with his wife, has absorbed so much English that the boundaries have

blurred; he regrets not passing more of it to his sons. "That feeling always remains. Basically, I put that into this novel. That loss." He traces this restlessness further back to his Lohana ancestors, generations who moved through western India and then to Kenya, Zanzibar, Colombo and elsewhere. "It's kind of a nomadic existence," he says. "That's my theory."

The pattern continues in his own family; his sons, too, have made lives across countries. "Somehow, for our community, rootedness is harder to accomplish." His 2024 essay collection *Nowhere, Exactly* asks whether home can ever be singular for people formed by several places. Vassanji no longer sounds troubled by not having one answer. "I'm always rooted in a place," he tells me. "But then I find that I feel comfortable in a place only because I know I can always travel." He calls himself "a creature of habit who travels."

Delhi entered that long journey through travel rather than ancestry. Whenever he came to India, Vassanji says, Delhi was usually the first stop. "I would first come here," he says. It became "the key" through which the rest of India's geography began to make sense to him. Gujarat, Shimla, Calcutta and other places branched out from it. That relationship has already produced *A Delhi Obsession*, but the Delhi of *The Apparition* demanded a different imagining an older city whose records can tell a novelist only so much.

Vassanji is working on another novel, now "almost finished". It looks at a generation slightly older than his own, formed by university life, decolonisation and the political idealism of the 1960s and early 1970s, when Tanzania was a frontline state in the struggles against white minority rule in Rhodesia and apartheid South Africa. "That

awareness was very much part of our growing up," he says.

Vassanji also returns to East African writers he feels have slipped from view, among them Peter Nazareth and Bahadur Tejani, particularly when compared with the attention given to West African writers. Tejani's *Day After Tomorrow* interests him because it tried to imagine a genuinely African-Indian future through an interracial relationship. "There was, of course, among the Indians, Asians, racial resistance," Vassanji says, adding that African communities had their own traditions and boundaries. "There's a relative ignorance, mutual ignorance, between Africans and Asians."

He remembers Tanzania Publishing House and Walter Bgoya, later founder of Mkuki na Nyota. The press is now run by Bgoya's son, Mkuki, and Vassanji has sent him a new collection of stories set entirely in the small part of Dar es Salaam where he grew up. When his regular publisher worried about too many books appearing close together, Vassanji replied, "But I'm not getting younger either." Sending the stories back to Tanzania felt right: "It was like going back... my homage to the place I grew up in."

That return to place loops back neatly to *The Apparition*. The novel is interested not only in conquest, but in what follows: what people surrender without noticing, what they acquire, and when something once foreign becomes ordinary. As Amir's Sufi master comes to understand, Vassanji says, "the world is bigger and, therefore, you have to accommodate what's in there."

"What do you gain and what do you lose when your world, whether you like it or not, opens up?" The question belongs as much to the present as to Vassanji's medieval Delhi. He sees the novel as a response to the anxieties around identity, migration, conquest, globalisation and cultural change. "If you don't travel, the world comes to you," he says. "In this case it is the Avians who come." And when they do, "you have to realise that the world was much bigger".

Toronto-based writer MG Vassanji

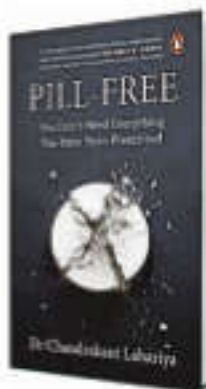
Nawaid Anjum is a freelancer

ON THE SHELF



IN THE REALM OF THE LAST MAN
Francis Fukuyama
Hachette
Pp 256, ₹699

In this memoir, encompassing his father's involvement in the civil rights movement and his own work on CIA contracts in the 1980s, Francis Fukuyama analyses his life alongside the seismic political shifts of the last 30 years — from Bush to Obama to Trump, from the War on Terror to Russia's Ukraine invasion. Profound and provocative, this is an intimate portrait of one of the 21st century's most important thinkers, an urgent study of contemporary politics — and a treatise on how the West can claw democracy back from the brink.



PILL-FREE
Dr Chandrakant Lahariya
Penguin
Random House
Pp 328, ₹499

Dr Chandrakant Lahariya takes on one of the under-discussed health challenges of our time: the culture of unnecessary medicines, supplements, tests and procedures. Packed with patient stories, myth-busting insights, checklists, nutrition guidance, kitchen wisdom and practical tools, this book empowers you to start a fulfilling journey to reduce your pills, reverse diseases and take charge of your metabolic health with confidence.



THE LIFT-OFF NATION
Rajan Anandan & Saurabh Juggernaut
Pp 384, ₹1,099

Once upon a time, India accounted for 25% of global GDP. Two start-up veterans, Saurabh Srivastava, co-founder of NASSCOM, TIE and IAN, and Rajan Anandan, former head of Google, Microsoft and Dell in India and now a managing director at Peak XV Partners, argue that it can do so again by harnessing India's start-ups. With case studies and data points, they give compelling reasons why the time for India's startup ecosystem is now.



WHY THE WORLD NEEDS ANGRY WOMEN
Nilanjana Bhownick
Aleph Book Company
Pp 176, ₹699

Women are angrier than men. This is a statistical finding in India as well as elsewhere in the world. Yet, in a system rigged against them, women have historically not been allowed to claim their anger openly. *Why the World Needs Angry Women* is a seething, blistering manifesto in favour of the modern woman's right to anger. Blending biting humour and philosophical depth, Bhownick shows how women's anger is different from male anger.



WANDERED THE TRAVELLER
Translated by Daisy Rockwell
HarperCollins
Pp 384, ₹699

First published in 1955, *Wandered the Traveller* is a lost classic of south Asian literature — now available in English for the first time in Daisy Rockwell's revelatory translation. Nisar Aziz Butt's semi-autobiographical novel follows Afgar, a brilliant young Pashtun woman, from a turbulent orphaned childhood, through the cloistered world of a mountain sanatorium, to the brink of departure in pursuit of a doctorate at Cambridge.

SUNDAY, SEPTEMBER 13, 2026

Fe Lines

STORIES AND TRENDS FROM INDIA AND AROUND THE WORLD THAT CAUGHT OUR FANCY



Performance artiste Zoe Ziegfeld with a snake during Met auditions in New York; Dunston played by Sam, a real orangutan from *Dunston Checks In* (below)

Sit, stay... ACTION

Boas recently auditioned for a Met production, showing animals on stage is serious business

VAISHALI DAR

THE ROAD TO stardom can be a slippery one, quite literally. At New York's Metropolitan Opera, even the snakes have to audition.

For its production of Mozart's *Cosi fan tutte*, relocated to a 1950s Coney Island carnival, the Met needed a snake for a memorable stage appearance. Several boas were put through the test by Zoe Ziegfeld, the production's snake handler and a former Coney Island carnival performer. The reptiles were observed slithering, wrapping around their handler and being lifted above her head under simulated stage conditions. But there was only one successful candidate — Princess, a large, striking sun-glow boa constrictor. Her size, colour and calm temperament won her the part. It may sound whimsical, but animal casting is serious business. An animal cannot read a script, hit a mark because a director shouts 'Action!', or be persuaded to repeat a brilliant performance simply because the first take went well. Trainers and filmmakers have to work around an animal's natural

behaviour, and establish whether that particular animal is comfortable enough to work at all.

"Animals have to perform as do human talent," animal supplier Nancy Novograd, who supplied the Met's snakes, explained in a news report. Sometimes an animal has to demonstrate a particular behaviour or its qualification is being able to remain calm around lights, cameras, music and people.

Hollywood has been conducting versions of these auditions for decades. Animal talent agencies match scripts with creatures that have the right breed, appearance, temperament and training. These days, casting may begin with photographs or videos. But animal auditions have sometimes been considerably more literal. In 1961, for instance, Hollywood held what became known as the 'Black Cat Cattle Call' for an Edgar Allan Poe adaptation. Some 152 black cats auditioned for *Tales of Terror*, released in 1962. Cats with white paws or noses were rejected, as were those deemed too friendly. The filmmakers selected animals whose faces looked suitably sinister.

The process becomes more complicated when the animal has to carry a film. The best example is *Dunston Checks In*, the 1996 comedy about an orangutan who causes chaos inside a luxury hotel. The central character, Dunston, was played by Sam, a real orangutan. Rather than teaching him to 'act', trainers built performances around cues, repetition and rewards. For complicated sequences, production teams relied on mats, specialised sets, stunt substitutes and mechanical effects to keep the animal safe and make scenes repeatable.

Babe, the 1995 film about a pig who wants to become a sheepdog, presented a bigger logistical challenge. The production required pigs, dogs, cats, ducks, horses, mice, a cow and hundreds of sheep. According to the *Los Angeles Times*, 58 trainers worked with more than 900 animals. The larger point is that an animal audition is rarely about asking, "Can this creature act?" But asking, "Can this creature safely and reliably do what the scene requires?"

As for the recent film *Sinners*, timber

rattlesnakes were selected through video auditions. Their work came with a level of safety planning, a trained handler, medical support and emergency extraction procedures were required on set.

Dogs have also become some of the most recognisable animal performers in cinema. Bing, the Great Dane in *The Friend*, was selected not merely for his appearance but for his ability to perform specific behaviours and emotional-looking cues. Max, the scruffy dog who played Milo alongside Jim Carrey in *The Mask*, became a memorable comic performer. Uggie, the Jack Russell Terrier from *The Artist*, became so celebrated that he won the Palm Dog Award at Cannes.

Then there is Crystal the Monkey, whose film and television career included *The Hangover Part II* and *Night at the Museum*. She became one of Hollywood's best-known animal performers, proof that an animal does not necessarily need dialogue to steal a scene.

Live theatre creates its own challenges. Opera companies have needed dogs for productions such as *La Bohème*, where the animals must remain composed despite powerful voices, orchestras, stage movement and bright lights. Cats have performed in specialised theatre and variety acts, including the Savitsky Cats, known for elaborate routines involving jumping, climbing and balancing. Even pigs have been trained for stage acts requiring agility, repetition and comic timing. The audition, therefore, is less about obedience than trust. Appearance can matter, too. Princess had the colour and visual presence required for the Met production. But her looks alone would never have secured the role. A beautiful animal that panics under stage lights is not a reliable performer.

There is something strangely democratic about the process. Human actors arrive at auditions with monologues, songs, dance routines and resumes. Animal performers arrive with none of that. They have no understanding of fame, reviews or opening night. But their greatest qualifications may be that they are calm, curious, trainable, and willing to cooperate. Perhaps that is why animal auditions remain so fascinating.

TECH-NOW-LOGY

Warning bells

Emergency alert systems on smartphones are becoming a crucial part of disaster preparedness across the world



SREYA DEB

A SHRILL, SHRIEKING sound emanating from your phone? You better be warned — a tornado, rainstorm or earthquake has probably been registered by the weather department. Emergency alert systems on smartphones are becoming a crucial part of disaster preparedness across the world — a way for governments and public welfare bodies, through mobile networks and phone manufacturers, to warn people about threats ranging from extreme weather incidents to earthquakes and public-safety emergencies.

At the heart of many government warning systems is 'Cell Broadcast', a technology that can send the same message simultaneously to phones in a defined geographic area. Unlike an ordinary SMS, cell-broadcast messages do not require authorities to know recipients' phone numbers and are designed to remain effective even when mobile networks are congested. In India, this technology took a major step forward this year in April. The Department of Telecommunications said its indigenous Cell Broadcast Solution, developed by the Centre for Development of Telematics (C-DOT) with the National Disaster Management Authority and the Ministry of Home Affairs, has been rolled out nationally. The system supports all kinds of networks — whether it's 2G, 3G, 4G or 5G — and is designed to deliver multi-lingual alerts to mobile users, including people who are roaming.

For Android phones, Google's operating system includes wireless emergency alerts, which can display disaster warnings, threat notifications and, in supported countries, AMBER (America's Missing: Broadcast Emergency Response) alerts. Android also includes emergency SOS, available on the Android 12 and following models. Depending on the device and configuration of it, pressing the power button five times can initiate an emergency call, notify emergency contacts, share location and begin other safety actions. Availability varies by country and handset.

Google's Pixel phones add several safety services through the 'personal safety system'. These include emergency SOS, safety check, crisis alerts, emergency

location service and, on supported models, car crash detection as well. Pixel 4a and later devices, including Fold models, support car crash detection in India and 19 other countries including the USA, UK, France, Belgium, Ireland and Canada, among others.

As for Samsung Galaxy devices, they also provide wireless emergency alerts. Depending on the carrier, users can receive national, extreme and severe threat warnings, AMBER alerts, public-safety messages and test alerts. However, the exact options can differ between carriers, as per Samsung.

Apple's iPhone uses a different but complementary system. Government alerts can provide warnings about imminent threats, extreme weather, public safety and other emergencies, and are generally enabled by default, although the categories and ability to disable them vary by country and network provider.

Apple has also expanded emergency capabilities beyond just the conventional broadcast warnings. Enhanced safety alerts, available in the United States

GOOGLE PIXEL ADDS SEVERAL SAFETY SERVICES LIKE EMERGENCY SOS, SAFETY CHECK, CRISIS ALERTS & CAR CRASH DETECTION

and Taiwan on iOS 26.2 or later models, can provide additional warnings for natural disasters like earthquake and flood information through mobile data or Wi-Fi. For supported iPhone 14 and newer models, Apple offers emergency SOS via satellite. When cellular and Wi-Fi connections

are unavailable, the phone can connect to satellites to communicate with emergency services, provided the user has a clear view of the sky. Availability remains country-specific — this satellite feature does not work on iPhones bought in Armenia, Belarus, mainland China, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, or Russia.

The expanding and evolving range of emergency alert systems means that the smartphone is increasingly becoming an emergency-information device and is not just restricted to a communications tool. However, users should not assume that every alert service works everywhere. Government infrastructure, carrier support, phone hardware, operating-system version and local regulations all impact availability of the facility. Emergency alerts work best when the technology is supported, enabled and understood before a crisis occurs.

A new narrative

How interactive storytelling is now allowing the reader to also be its author



SREYA DEB

IF YOU SPENT your childhood in the 1980s and 1990s, you'd surely recall Choose Your Own Adventure (CYOA), a series of books that turned reading into a game, allowing readers to assume the protagonist's role and make choices determining the plot. The stories (an example being *The Cave of Time* by Edward Packard) are formatted so that, after a few pages of reading, the protagonist faces two or three options, each of which leads to further pages and further options, and so on until they arrive at one of the many story endings. Fast forward to the present times, the same concept is witnessing a resurgence, albeit in an online format. These interactive storytelling platforms are not only letting readers become characters, but also shape relationships and sometimes completely change the ending of a story.

The stories work through branching pas-

sages. A reader reaches a decision, clicks an option and is taken to another part of the story. Some websites also offer further customisation of the story's trajectory, allowing the reader/writer to pick an outcome outside of the options provided.

For writers, CYOA offers something traditional fanfiction cannot: a chance to give readers partial ownership of the narrative. Instead of simply imagining what a character might do, the reader gets to make the decision themselves. This helps to create an intimate and personalised relationship between writer and audience. Fandoms popular in the CYOA world are The Marvel and DC universes, *Harry Potter*, *Worm*, and *Jujutsu Kaisen*, among several others.

One of the biggest spaces for this kind of storytelling is itch.io, an independent platform where writers can upload interactive fiction made with tools such as Twine (an open source online tool for interactive, non-linear storytelling). Twine is important because it is free and designed for creating nonlinear stories without requiring advanced programming knowledge. CYOA is well suited to fandom culture. Popular subjects include fantasy, supernatural fiction, romance, dating stories and established fictional universes where readers have strong emotional connections to characters.

On itch.io, highly rated interactive fiction includes fantasy romance and stories inspired by existing fan communities.

Choice of Games, a video game company which publishes interactive novels for digital platforms, takes a structured approach. Its stories are written using the programming language ChoiceScript and are presented as interactive novels in which readers make decisions that influence

characters, relationships and outcomes. The company's Hosted Games programme has allowed writers to publish their own choice-based stories, helping some titles develop dedicated fandoms of their own. Another option is the CYOA Archive, which is organised around community-created adventures. Readers can browse static, image-based CYOAs or play interactive versions directly in their browsers. CYOA has also



Choice of Games publishes interactive novels for digital platforms

entered established fandoms. Archive of Our Own, popularly known as AO3, is primarily a fanfiction archive rather than a dedicated interactive-fiction platform, but writers have found ways to create branching stories using hyperlinks between chapters or sections. Readers can effectively choose which version of events they want to follow.

Glimmer is a similar platform, allowing at least 100 free pages, or 'turns', with paid options for daily extensions on the limit, if the reader wants. Leaving a comment or a review on the story 'earns' the readers further turns in the story.

The tropes are familiar too: enemies to lovers, found family, reincarnation, self-insert protagonists, magical powers, love triangles and "what if?" alternate universes all work naturally with a format built around personal choice. A reader can decide what their character pursues — romance, friendship, revenge or adventure — and then replay the story to discover another possibility. Fan communities already thrive on discussing characters, relationships, theories and alternate endings.

Interactive stories turn those conversations into participation. Readers compare routes, debate choices, share favourite characters and return to discover outcomes they missed.

Spotlight

SUNDAY, SEPTEMBER 13, 2026



LEADING STATE IN CAR SCRAPPING

UP has emerged as India's leading state in vehicle scrapping, accounting for 48.5% of the more than 4.07 lakh vehicles scrapped across the country till July 31, as per reports. The state has 92 registered vehicle scrapping facilities, of which 51 are operational



SUGANDHA MUKHERJEE

INDIA IS ON the cusp of one of the world's largest vehicle retirement programmes. By 2030, the country is expected to have around 22 million end-of-life vehicles (ELVs), generating nearly 7 million tonne of automotive scrap every year, according to the Council on Energy, Environment and Water (CEEW). At the same time, India adds more than 20 million new vehicles annually, making it the world's third-largest automobile market. How those ageing vehicles leave the road will increasingly shape not only urban air quality but also the country's ambitions to build a circular economy.

The government has spent the past five years putting the pieces in place. Since announcing the Vehicle Scrappage Policy in 2021, it has licensed Registered Vehicle Scrapping Facilities (RVSFs), introduced digital certificates of deposit to encourage owners to scrap old vehicles, and, through the End-of-Life Vehicles Rules, 2025, brought automobile manufacturers under Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR), making them responsible for environmentally sound recycling.

Yet the system remains in its infancy. According to NITI Aayog, fewer than 3% of India's estimated end-of-life vehicles entered authorised scrapping facilities between August 2022 and July 2025. Many continue to be resold in states with less stringent enforcement, while others are dismantled by the country's extensive informal recycling sector.

Even so, the government says the policy is beginning to show results. Earlier this year, Union Road Transport and Highways Minister Nitin Gadkari said 394,000 vehicles had been scrapped by December 2025, including 165,000 government-owned and 239,000 private vehicles. The programme, he said, has attracted ₹27 billion in private investment, recovered 3.76 lakh tonne of scrap steel, raised India's reuse of raw materials to 33%, and reduced carbon dioxide emissions by an estimated 6,353 kilotonne, equivalent to planting about 260 million trees.

The environmental case appears straightforward. Older vehicles emit significantly more pollution than modern ones, while the steel, aluminium, copper and precious metals locked inside them can be recovered and reused instead of being mined again.

But researchers say there is another side to the equation. Every vehicle that enters a scrapyards has to be dismantled, processed and replaced. That consumes energy, creates emissions and requires a new vehicle to be manufactured. The environmental question, therefore, is not simply whether an old vehicle should be scrapped but whether replacing it leaves a smaller overall footprint than continuing to use it.

"The environmental impact should not be measured by comparing an old vehicle with a scrapped vehicle," says Professor Santosh Kumar Sahu of IIT Madras. "The appropriate comparison is between continuing to use the existing vehicle and retiring it while manufacturing a replacement. Only a full life-cycle assessment can determine which option is environmentally preferable."

A modern scrapyards is a long way from the image of a rusting car being crushed into a cube of metal. Before dismantling begins, fuel, engine oil, coolant, brake fluid and refrigerants are removed. Batteries, tyres, glass, airbags and electronic components are separated. The remaining shell is then shredded so that steel, aluminium and copper can be recovered and sent back into manufacturing.

That process has an environmental cost. According to Sahu, processing an end-of-life vehicle typically consumes 500-2,000 megajoules of energy and emits 50-200 kg of carbon dioxide equivalent,

India's car

SCRAPPAGE

roadblock



depending on the technology used and the electricity powering the recycling facility. Yet it also prevents emissions elsewhere.

According to Professor Sebastian Morris, Chair at the Centre for Public Policy and Governance, an average passenger vehicle contains 700-900 kg of steel, 50-120 kg of aluminium and 10-20 kg of copper. Recovering these materials instead of producing them from virgin ores can avoid roughly 1 tonne of carbon dioxide equivalent for every vehicle recycled.

No universal answer

A heavily used diesel truck that travels thousands of kilometres every month accumulates emissions quickly. Replacing it with a cleaner model can offset the carbon emitted during manufacturing within a relatively short period. A well-maintained hatchback driven only a few thousand kilometres a year presents a different calculation. The emissions saved during its remaining life may not always outweigh the environmental cost of building another vehicle.

"There is no universal answer," says Sahu of IIT Madras. "Replacing an older internal combustion engine vehicle with a newer model generally delivers environmental benefits once operational savings offset the emissions from manufacturing the replacement. That break-even period usually occurs within two to eight years, or roughly 30,000 to 100,000 km, depending on annual mileage, vehicle type and the local energy mix."

That distinction lies at the heart of an emerging debate over India's scrappage policy. The programme largely uses vehicle age as the trigger for retirement. Private vehicles are required to undergo fitness tests after 20 years and commercial vehicles after 15. In Delhi, separate judicial orders effectively remove diesel vehicles older than 10 years and petrol vehicles older than 15 years from the road.

"The underlying problem is that age is not always a reliable proxy for emissions," says Arunesh Karkun, research lead at Sustainable Futures Collaborative. "Remote sensing by ICCT in Delhi and Gurugram found light goods vehicles emitting up to 14 times their laboratory NOx limits and taxis four times, so how a vehicle is used and maintained can matter more than when it was registered. An age-based rule will scrap some clean vehicles and miss some dirty ones. For high-emitting vehicles, whether or not they cross the age threshold, the case for replacement is strong."

That view is echoed in the recent study, *Rethinking India's Vehicle Scrappage Policy*, by Gaurav Gupta of the Centre for Energy Regulation and Prof Anoop Singh of IIT Kanpur. Using an India-specific lifecycle analysis, the researchers argue that accelerating replacement purely because a vehicle has crossed an age threshold can, under certain conditions, increase cumulative energy demand and greenhouse gas emissions. Manufacturing a replacement vehicle requires new steel, aluminium, plastics and other materials whose environmental costs may not always be recovered if the vehicle was lightly used.

The authors argue that a more performance-based and lifecycle-aware approach would be more effective than relying predominantly on age, particularly because a relatively small proportion of poorly maintained vehicles account for a disproportionate share of emissions. That distinction also helps explain why experts separate air pollution from climate

change. For cities struggling with poor air quality, replacing older commercial vehicles is widely regarded as one of the fastest ways to reduce harmful pollutants.

"End-of-life vehicles are estimated, based on the latest emission factors, to emit particulate matter (PM) at levels many times higher than a BS-VI-compliant vehicle. They also present a resource recovery opportunity," says Dr Himani Jain, fellow at CEEW. "CEEW estimates scrap availability from the automotive sector is expected to reach nearly 7 million tonne per annum by 2030. Against this backdrop, the Government of India proposed a new scheme to replace old trucks and buses in Delhi-NCR, which could help retire over 200,000 highly polluting vehicles."

Cleaner air, however, does not automatically mean lower carbon emissions. "Not always, and it depends on which pollutant you mean," says Karkun. "For local air pollutants like NOx, PM and CO, the benefit of removing highly polluting vehicles is real and immediate. The manufacturing happens somewhere else, while the tailpipe benefit is felt on city streets."

"For carbon it is a real trade-off. Manufacturing emissions are recovered only through use, so payback depends on mileage. A lightly used car may not repay its replacement within its remaining life whereas a high-mileage commercial vehicle does so quickly. Where the replacement is electric, the grid and the battery make the picture more complex, even though the local air quality benefit is immediate."

That is perhaps the biggest misconception surrounding scrappage. The question is not whether scrapping produces emissions, it does. Nor is it whether older vehicles pollute more as many clearly do. The question is which vehicles produce the greatest environmental benefit when they are replaced.

That debate, however, often gives way to a far simpler consideration for vehicle owners, that is, money. And that may be the biggest reason India's formal scrappage ecosystem has struggled to attract vehicles.

The money factor

For most owners, the decision is driven less by emissions than by money. A functioning vehicle almost always commands a higher price in the resale market than an authorised scrapping facility.

That is one reason India's formal scrappage ecosystem remains small. "The reason is economics, as owners reported being offered double the value from informal buyers in comparison to formal scrapping centres," says Karkun of Sustainable Futures Collaborative. "Recovery isn't the



The environmental impact should not be measured by comparing an old vehicle with a scrapped one... Only a full life-cycle assessment can determine which option is preferable

— SANTOSH KUMAR SAHU, PROFESSOR, IIT MADRAS



India's formal scrappage ecosystem remains small. The reason is economics; some owners are offered double the value from informal buyers compared to formal scrapping centres

— ARUNESH KARKUN, SUSTAINABLE FUTURES COLLABORATIVE

POLICY TO PRACTICE

12 mn

No. of end-of-life vehicles on Indian roads

22 mn

No. of end-of-life vehicles that India is expected to have by 2030, generating 7 mn tonne of automotive scrap every year

20 mn

No. of new vehicles added annually, making India the world's third-largest automobile market

Only 3%

of India's end-of-life vehicles entered authorised scrapping facilities between Aug 2022 and July 2025

394,000

No. of vehicles scrapped by Dec 2025, including 165,000 govt-owned & 239,000 pvt

₹27 bn

Private investment attracted since announcement of Vehicle Scrappage Policy in 2021

6,353 kilotonne

Reduction of carbon dioxide emissions post Vehicle Scrappage Policy 2021, equivalent to planting about 260 mn trees

50-200 kg

Carbon dioxide equivalent released while processing an end-of-life vehicle

main case for scrappage in India. We already recover most of the metal through an informal sector that unfortunately does it without depollution, refrigerant capture or fluid containment. The formal sector can help make this both a cleaner and more efficient process."

The informal sector has long been India's de facto recycling industry. It recovers engines, gearboxes, steel, aluminium and spare parts with remarkable efficiency. What it often lacks are systems to safely remove hazardous materials before dismantling. Engine oil, brake fluid, coolant, refrigerants and batteries can contaminate soil and groundwater if not handled properly, while plastics, foams and automotive shredder residue often end up in landfills or are disposed of without treatment.

Recognising this, the government has encouraged investment in authorised Registered Vehicle Scrapping Facilities (RVSFs), where every vehicle is depolluted before dismantling and materials are recovered under controlled conditions.

Among the largest players is Tata Motors, which now operates 11 RE.WIRE (Recycle With Respect) facilities across the country with an annual capacity of around 190,000 vehicles. "The Vehicle Scrappage Policy has played a significant role in creating awareness about responsible end-of-life vehicle disposal and the benefits of transitioning to newer, safer and cleaner vehicles," a Tata Motors spokesperson says.

But even as formal infrastructure expands, consumer behaviour continues to favour resale. According to Cars24, owners are increasingly replacing vehicles earlier, not necessarily to scrap them but to preserve their resale value.

"Consumers are increasingly planning their replacement decisions earlier. Rather than waiting until the vehicle reaches the end of its life, owners are selling sooner to preserve resale value and avoid regulatory uncertainty," says Shivanshu Makkar, chief

financial officer (India), Cars24.

The demand is largely coming from beyond India's biggest cities. Cars24 says 62% of demand on its platform now comes from Tier-II and Tier-III cities, where older vehicles continue to find buyers despite tightening restrictions elsewhere.

Spinny has also reported a similar trend. "Many owners still compare the value of scrappage incentives with alternatives such as selling the vehicle in Tier-3 and Tier-4 markets or renewing its fitness certificate," says Niraj Singh, founder and chief executive officer of Spinny.

That creates a paradox. An ageing diesel vehicle removed from Delhi's roads may improve the capital's air quality. But if it is sold and continues operating elsewhere, the environmental gains are diluted.

"Scrapping only counts if the vehicle is destroyed rather than moved across a state boundary," says Karkun. "Otherwise, the problem is simply relocated."

NITI Aayog has identified inadequate financial incentives, limited public awareness, insufficient testing and scrappage infrastructure, and weak enforcement as the principal reasons for the low adoption of authorised scrappage. It has also argued that bringing the informal sector into the formal ecosystem, rather than trying to replace it entirely, could improve recovery rates while ensuring environmentally safer recycling practices.

The greener choice

India is not the first country to confront the environmental challenge of retiring millions of ageing vehicles. But as vehicle ownership continues to rise, many countries are shifting their focus from simply scrapping cars to designing a circular economy around them.

The European Union requires that 85% of every vehicle by weight be recycled and 95% recovered. In June, it adopted the Vehicle Circularity Regulation, which introduces recycled-content requirements and encourages manufacturers to design vehicles that are easier to dismantle and recycle. Japan has taken a different route, financing recycling through a fee collected when a vehicle is purchased rather than when it is scrapped, ensuring funds are available to recover materials that are expensive but environmentally important.

For Arunesh Karkun, these examples highlight an important lesson for India. "I'm not going to name a single best system, but Japan and the Netherlands are the usual references, and both fund recycling through a fee collected when the vehicle is bought rather than an incentive paid when it is replaced. That works better because it pays for the unprofitable end of the process. Japan is now moving further, paying dismantlers for the plastic, glass and aluminium they recover. The EU adopted a new Vehicle Circularity Regulation in June 2026 with recycled-content requirements and design-for-dismantling rules."

He believes India could adapt some of these ideas rather than replicate them outright. "For India that points to collecting a recycling fee at first registration rather than or alongside paying an incentive at replacement, crediting producer obligations on total material recovered, and targeting enforcement at vehicles measured to be high emitters rather than at vehicles that are simply old."

The government has already begun moving in that direction through the End-of-Life Vehicles Rules, 2025, which brought automobile manufacturers under Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR), making them accountable for environmentally sound recycling. But experts say regulation alone will not be enough.

"Authorities should narrow the price gap between the secondary markets and formal scrappage through incentives and financing models. Enforcement of vehicle de-registration and end-of-life regulations should be strengthened. Success will depend on addressing infrastructure constraints, particularly by rapidly expanding authorised vehicle scrapping and recycling facilities in regions such as Delhi-NCR, where large-scale fleet replacement is expected," says Dr Himani Jain of CEEW.

The evidence gathered so far points to a more nuanced conclusion. Scrapping a vehicle does create emissions. Recycling consumes energy, while manufacturing a replacement vehicle carries a significant carbon footprint. But continuing to operate an ageing, high-emitting vehicle also comes at an environmental cost. The greener choice, as per experts, depends on the balance between those two.

Well Being

SUNDAY, SEPTEMBER 13, 2026

SREYA DEB

WITH GENERIC AND far cheaper versions of glucagon-like peptide-1 (GLP-1) agonists breaking into the market, health experts anticipate a growing adoption of the weight-loss drugs in the near future. With it, they add, the market for dietary protein products is also set to expand. This is because adequate protein intake is essential during GLP-1 therapy to help prevent lean muscle loss, maintain metabolism, and support steady energy levels amid a loss of appetite.

This also assumes significance in a country like India, where protein intake is already lower than normal. According to experts, the ideal protein intake for a person is 0.8-1 gm per kg of body weight daily, at a minimum. A recent study by the think tank Council for Energy, Environment and Water (CEEW), however, found that the average protein intake of an Indian adult is 55.6 gm.

According to Dr Tarun Mittal, vice-chairperson, laparoscopic and robotic bariatric surgeon, Sir Ganga Ram Hospital, New Delhi, protein supplements in pill or medicine form are very likely to appear in the market in a few years, if not months. "With GLP-1 drugs reducing appetite and meal volume, the supplement market may move beyond bars and shakes to include medicalised protein formats - chewables, compact protein tablets, protein shots, amino-acid sachets, collagen/peptide formulations, and fortified multivitamin-like packs," he says. However, Dr Mittal says that the low dosage in pills may pose an issue. "An adult often needs 60-90 gm protein per day, and this cannot be practically delivered through a few tablets," he says.

Dr Richa Chaturvedi, senior consultant, endocrinology, Indraprastha Apollo Hospital, in New Delhi seconds this. "Protein is required in relatively larger quantities compared to vitamins; so a true 'pill format' may remain limited in its ability to deliver meaningful amounts," she says. Nevertheless, she expects the category to grow. "The category is likely to evolve toward more convenient, portion-controlled formats such as concentrated liquids, gels, or sachets that align with changing consumption patterns and preferences," she adds.

Speaking about the possible cons of protein pills or tablets, Dr Jasjeet Wasir, director, endocrinology and diabetology, at Medanta Medicity, says many patients on these drugs already were under-consuming protein. "Due to their reduced food intake, their protein intake may further go down to precipitously unhealthy levels, despite substantial weight loss," he warns. Experts recommend higher protein intake for people on GLP-1, "typically in the range of 1.0-1.6 gm per kg of body weight per day to help preserve muscle mass during weight loss", as per Dr Wasir.

The Carbamide Forte protein chewable, which can be purchased from Amazon, priced at a little over ₹2,000, contains 12 gm of whey isolate protein per scoop and 18 amino acids. However, pharmaceutical companies like Zydus LifeSciences, Alkem, and Dr Reddy's, all of whom launched their own versions of semaglutide, are currently not looking at launching any such pills or tablets in the near future.

Evolving category

Meanwhile, protein supplements in dietary formulations are already seeing a growing demand on e-commerce platforms. "Sports nutrition on Amazon India has grown 35% YoY, but what's more interesting is how the category is evolving. It's moved from being fitness-focused to becoming a mainstream wellness and nutrition category," says Nishant Raman, director, everyday essentials, Amazon India.

Seshu Kumar Tirumala, chief operating officer of Bigbasket, agrees: "The pro-



PRIORITISING PROTEIN IN GLP-1 THERAPY

Amid an anticipated rise in adoption of weight-loss drugs, will the market for protein products — an essential nutrient to offset the impact on appetite & help prevent muscle loss — also see expansion?

NON-DIETARY PROTEIN SUPPLEMENTS

EAA (ESSENTIAL AMINO ACID) CAPSULES

Very low volume; support muscle protein synthesis without full meal feeling

BCAA (BRANCHED-CHAIN AMINO ACID) CAPSULES

Widely available in India; not a complete protein but can complement intake with minimal volume

UNFLAVOURED WHEY PROTEIN ISOLATE: Can be mixed into small amounts of liquid or food, delivering substantial protein in a compact serving

PROTEIN MICROSHOTS

Small volume liquids (often 30-60 ml) with 15-25 gm protein, common in some Western markets; beginning to appear in the Indian market

CLINICAL AMINO ACID FORMULATIONS

Used in hospital settings for patients who cannot eat normally; prescription only; these are not sold over the counter

with GLP-1-based therapy." Dr Chaturvedi echoes this opinion, saying, "For the overall population, the impact is expected to be gradual and limited in the near term, mainly because access is still evolving."

Doctors say GLP-1 induced appetite suppression can be particularly risky for certain demographics. "Nutritional needs differ across groups," says Dr Chaturvedi. "Older adults, women, and physically active individuals generally have higher or more specific protein requirements, so they may need to be slightly more mindful about maintaining adequate intake as eating patterns change." Dr Wasir elaborates, "Older adults aged 60 years and above have a higher baseline risk of muscle loss and sarcopenia, and a reduced appetite can accelerate declines in strength and function; for women, especially postmenopausal, lower protein and micronutrient intake can worsen osteoporosis and frailty risk; appetite suppression makes it harder to achieve adequate quantity and amino acid balance for vegetarians and vegans; and low income groups who have lesser access to nutrition sources." According to the report by CEEW, Indians from low income groups consume 1.5 times less protein than those in high incomes groups or residing in urban areas.

Supplements in use

Some low-bulk protein supplement products are already available, which do not give the full meal feeling, but that their "availability in India is patchy", as per Dr Wasir. Essential amino acid or EEA tablets are also available. But they are low volume, and support muscle protein synthesis without a full meal feeling. Branched-chain amino acid or BCAA tablets are also there, which are more easily available in India, which again "is not a complete protein but can complement intake with minimal volume."

Meanwhile, protein microshots, which are small volume liquids (often 30-60 ml) with 15-25 gm protein, and common in some Western markets, are beginning to appear in India, Dr Wasir adds.

Dr Chaturvedi adds, "There are already lighter-format options available, such as protein waters, hydrolysed protein supplements, and amino acid-based products which are designed to be less heavy and easier to consume, offering more flexibility."

HEALTH CAPSULES



Mothers' anaemia risk to babies' brains

Over a third of pregnant women globally have anaemia - a condition typically caused by iron deficiency in which the number of red blood cells in the body is lower than normal. On average, the total brain volume of babies born to anaemic mothers was 4% lower than that of babies born to non-anaemic mothers.



Hot drinks may increase cancer risk

Regularly drinking beverages like tea and coffee at very hot temperatures increases the risk of cancer of the food pipe or gullet, known as oesophageal cancer, UK research suggests. Although chances are low, people who had their drinks "very hot" had around a three times higher risk of the cancer than "warm" drinkers.



444 mn Indians at risk from passive smoking

A new study published in *The Lancet Public Health* estimates that 2.71 billion people worldwide were exposed to second-hand smoke in 2023. Deaths attributable to second-hand smoke in India have risen by nearly 50% since 1990. The study estimated that 444 million in India were at risk from passive smoking.



Surgery may improve irregular periods

Researchers found that at 12 and 24 months post-surgery, the average weight loss of women was more than 30 kgs. Post-surgery the number of women who had polycystic ovaries, which is known to affect fertility, was significantly reduced and persisted in only 10% of women with the condition after 24 months.



Dr Rajesh Koppikar

FE FEATURES

MORE THAN DENTAL hygiene, there is increased focus on dental aesthetics and many toothpastes claim whitening powers. Can pastes actually whiten teeth? Dr Rajesh Koppikar, consultant, dental surgery, Kokilaben Dhirubhai Ambani Hospital, Mumbai, says: "Whitening toothpastes do make teeth look brighter, but there is a limit to what they can do. What they are removing is surface staining from things like coffee, tea, tobacco, and certain foods, using mild polishing ingredients that work during regular brushing. Nowadays we also have a purple toothpaste in the market which works as optical brightener and these can instantly colour-correct the yellow tones of teeth. These

White teeth done right

Home remedies, toothpaste or dental cleaning — which works best

toothpastes are gentle enough for everyday use. However, deeper stains which are within the tooth are beyond what these products can reach. Anyone looking for results that go further than that would need to speak to a dentist about peroxide-based options."

Do home remedies work, like salt, baking powder-vinegar etc, and are they safe?

Home remedies for teeth whitening are popular, but not all of them are as harmless as they seem. Baking soda-based toothpaste can do something useful for surface stains, though a proper dental product is always the more reliable choice over anything homemade. Vinegar and acidic ingredients are ones to stay away from, as regular contact with

teeth gradually wears the enamel down. Salt and rough scrubs can cause damage too if someone goes at it too hard. Natural does not automatically mean safe for dental use.

How often is dental cleaning recommended for plaque control?

Most people visit the dentist every six months without giving it much thought, but that interval is not backed by strong evidence as the ideal for everyone. The right frequency really depends on the person, how fast plaque and tartar accumulate, and how prone they are to gum disease. What holds true for just about everyone, regardless of how often they see a dentist, is brushing twice a day and cleaning between teeth to stay on top of plaque.

Is dental cleaning safe for enamel?

Dental cleaning done by a qualified professional is safe, and it does something brushing at home simply cannot, which is removing the hardened tartar that builds up over time. A lot of people worry that scaling wears the enamel down or thins the teeth, but that is not how it works. The instruments used are designed to clear deposits off the surface without damaging it. Some sensitivity after a cleaning session is possible, especially for those who already have gum recession or exposed roots, but it tends to settle.

Is plaque harmful or merely an aesthetic concern?

Plaque is something that forms on teeth constantly, and it is far more than



just a cosmetic concern. The bacteria in that sticky film are what lead to tooth decay and gum trouble over time, causing the kind of redness and bleeding that people often dismiss as normal. When plaque is not cleared away regularly it

hardens into tartar, and at that point brushing is no longer enough to deal with it. That is where the risk of gum disease starts to grow, which is exactly why daily brushing and cleaning between teeth matter as much as they do.



Leisure

SUNDAY, SEPTEMBER 13, 2026

ICE CREAM

gets its own space...



Much like alcohol, tea or coffee, dedicated outlets for ice creams are changing the way people enjoy the frozen dessert

VAISHALI DAR

FOR DECADES, ICE CREAM in India was picked up from a neighbourhood freezer, consumed on the way home or ordered alongside a meal. Today, that habit is changing. More people are choosing where to have it, what flavour to try and how much of an experience they want around the scoop as they sit and relax in the neighbourhood 'ice cream bar'.

Such ice cream bars, along with artisanal gelaterias and destination-led parlours, are turning an impulse-driven category into an experience. The evolution is visible across the segment, from established names to newer concepts.

Jaatre, for instance, integrates the dessert into an outlet-cum-restaurant experience. The ice-cream brand, which claims to be homemade and 100% vegan, is served at Carnatic Cafe outlets across Delhi-NCR. As a separate stand-alone setup in addition to being served inside Carnatic Cafe, Jaatre revolves around the 'farm-to-scoop' concept, with its products served in upcycled, scraped coconut shells with wooden spoons, while larger take-home orders are packed in biodegradable terracotta tubs that help naturally retain the cold temperature.

At the premium end, Scoop Room is attempting to portray ice cream in a new light. "We've become curious consumers in almost every category," says founder Pallavi Gupta, adding: "People want to understand how their coffee is roasted or how chocolate is sourced. But very few people have ever been encouraged to think about ice cream in the same way."

Opened in Bengaluru's Indiranagar in August, with plans for two more outlets this year and a pan-India expansion by 2028, Scoop Room has 24 flavours, such as cookie dough hour, paan-tastic, pick

me avo and nutty basil. Its waffle cones and sauces are made in-house.

That curiosity is also reshaping what consumers expect from an ice cream outlet. Scoop Room is designed as a youthful neighbourhood destination with accents of neon green, pink, yellow and silver, while vintage telephones and dedicated scoop corners are part of the physical space. It also features a pet-friendly outdoor area, encouraging people to enjoy a scoop with family and friends.

Flavours & formats

At Zimero, Chef De Cuisine Sumant Bhargava identifies three trends shaping India's new ice-cream bars: bold flavours and formats, cleaner ingredients, and the way the product is served.

"Indian consumers are seeking experiences over products," says Bhargava, adding: "Whether it's flavours or formats like cake slices, cookies and gelatos, consumers want something different. Then there are clean ingredients like real chocolate, no added colours or flavours, and finally, how the ice cream is served. Cones, cookie cones, bubble cones, toppings, even gold leaf, anything that gives joy."

Zimero's offerings reflect that appetite for experimentation. With stores in Connaught Place and Gurugram, and 22 dark stores across Delhi-NCR and other key cities, the brand offers formats including sundaes, cakes and cookie cones, alongside flavours such as wild cherry, goat cheese and blueberry, south Indian filter coffee and dark

chocolate pistachio. Sugar-free and lower-calorie options are gaining traction too, although Bhargava sees them as serving a different need from the indulgent ice cream bar experience.

"Q-commerce is growing exponentially and addresses impulse and low-value consumption. Ice cream bars, on the other hand, offer experience and significantly premium products," he says.

Ice cream bars are not confined to emerging premium brands. Large established players are also expanding the role of the physical outlet. Naturals Ice Cream, the homegrown brand, started with one store in Juhu in 1984 and has today grown to 170 outlets across the country. While classics like sitaphal, tender coconut and alphonso mango continue to be customer favourites, the brand has

also been experimenting with newer formats through Naturals NOW, its experiential offshoot launched in 2019. It serves not only their speciality scoops of natural ice cream flavours but also sundaes and milkshakes, including freshly churned daily flavours such as tadgola (ice apple) and sitaphal sundaes, mudslide, baklava sundaes, premium shakes and more.

Meanwhile, Baskin-Robbins India says consumers increasingly want to spend time with the product rather than simply take it away. "It's no longer just about a quick takeaway, but an experience they want to sit back and savour," says Mohit Khattar, CEO, Graviss Foods, the master franchisee for Baskin-Robbins in India. The company operates more than 1,100 standalone parlours across over 300 cities in India and the SAARC region, and adds around 100-120 stores annually. Its parlours are becoming broader dessert destinations, extending beyond its signature 31 flavours to sundaes, shakes, cheesecakes, brownies, muffins, ice cream cakes and seasonal specials.

Immersive engagement

Specialist players see potential in the dedicated premium ice cream format. "Ice cream in India is moving beyond being an impulse purchase or a seasonal dessert. Consumers are looking for experiential food formats, and exclusive ice cream outlets are creating an opportunity for brands to engage with consumers in a much more immersive way," says Suhas B Shetty, founder and CEO of Iceberg Organic Ice Creams, which currently has nine outlets across Hyderabad, Bengaluru and Vijayawada.

Shetty says the company plans to add six stores in south India by the end of the current financial year, while entering q-comm and modern trade. It also plans to take the brand beyond south India into Mumbai, Delhi and Pune soon.

Meanwhile, Walko Food Company, which operates NIC Ice Creams, Grameen Kulfi and Mimo Ice Creams, and manages popular frozen dessert and ice cream brands across India, is continuously scaling its retail. It has expanded into over 21 stores and a few to be launched soon. Shamika Erande, AGM, marketing, Walko Food Company, says, "Since parlours are a capex investment heavy channel, with investments depending on the size, location and operation type like a standalone parlour or experience centre, we are looking to expand our reach in tier 1-2 cities and highway mall locations which have high traffic of audience with disposable income looking for upgraded lifestyle experiences. We also plan to expand the premium brand's positioning (NIC Honestly Crafted Ice Creams) and attract innovative ice cream (with Mimo Ice Creams) to a more accessible, wider and value seeking consumer base."



A COOL RECORD

In Chennai, 4,008 students got together in January to break the record for the 'longest chain of people licking ice cream'. Participants had to consume ice cream continuously for 1 minute while holding hands and offering ice cream to the person on their right



(Above) Artiste uses honey and jaggery in place of refined sugar; (bottom) Yura Artisanal Scoops brings a distinctly chef-led approach to frozen desserts

... With a premium, artisanal touch

Take your pick from handcrafted gelatos to seasonal fruit scoops and vegan sorbets

SREYA DEB

NOT TOO LONG AGO, choosing an ice cream just meant deciding between flavours, whether it's vanilla, chocolate, strawberry or butterscotch. Today, dessert lovers are spoilt for choice, with options ranging from small-batch gelatos to seasonal fruit scoops, vegan sorbets to sugar-free indulgences, proving that ice creams can be as much about innovation as they are about indulgence.

Catering to this demand is a slew of brands that are turning artisanal ice creams into one of the most exciting segments of India's food landscape. At ITC Grand Chola, Chennai, for instance, Yura Artisanal Scoops brings a distinctly chef-led approach to frozen desserts. Inspired by European techniques while incorporating Indian ingredients, Yura focuses on handcrafted gelatos and ice creams with sophisticated flavour profiles, premium ingredients, and innovative presentation. The products reflect the growing crossover between fine dining and artisanal desserts, with flavours such as filter coffee sundae and aam papad gelato, and tres leches and tiramisu flavoured melted ice cream dishes on offer.

Shaarik Akhtar, GM, ITC Grand Chola, says the concept attracted guests across age groups and nationalities. "Several guests who are world travellers have mentioned that our offerings at Yura beat international quality," he says.

Shmoozies is another brand that's combining premium ingredients with imaginative flavours and visually appealing creations. It caters to younger consumers seeking desserts that are as Instagram-worthy as they are delicious. Located in Chennai, Shmoozies offers seasonal flavours including avocado and lime, mango cheesecake, chilli guava, sitaphal and

strawberry zapota, among others, offering ice cream sorbets, ice cream crumble pies, ice cream tacos, and cakes, along with its regular offering of popsicles and scoops.

"Chennai has a fairly vibrant dessert culture," says Gauri, product manager at Shmoozies' main outlet in Anna Nagar, adding: "People are open to newer establishments, more so than before. Many stores have been around for years. The only difference is that the range of flavours is steadily expanding now as well."

According to the product manager, while earlier the most 'artisanal' item on ice cream parlour menus used to be items like banana split, now the offerings are far more innovative and varied.

Meanwhile, artisanal ice cream brands are also focusing on all-natural ingredients. Artiste Handcrafted Ice Cream, a handcrafted ice cream brand, for instance, uses honey and jaggery in place of refined sugar in several recipes, while offering flavours such as mango avocado, banana caramel with chia seeds, coconut malai, and tulsiginger. Its founder Madhvi Parikh says consumers' interest has grown significantly. "Today's consumers want their ice cream to be delicious and indulgent, while also being conscious of health, ingredients, and quality. They increasingly ask, 'What exactly am I eating?'—seeking the perfect balance of great taste and ingredients they can trust," she adds.

Many artisanal ice cream brands are making themselves available on quick commerce platforms as well. Health-conscious consumers are embracing Mumbai-based Go Zero, whose zero-added-sugar ice creams have emerged as a favourite among fitness enthusiasts and families alike. Ahmedabad's Hocco combines traditional recipes with modern branding and nationwide expansion, and the company is helping bridge the gap between artisanal quality and large-scale accessibility.

EARLIER, THE MOST 'ARTISANAL' ITEM USED TO BE THE BANANA SPLIT. THE OFFERINGS ARE NOW FAR MORE VARIED



SCREEN TIME

Your entertainment bucket list for this week



STRANGER THINGS
Netflix
Releases: **September 17**

STRANGER THINGS: Tales From '85 returns for a second animated adventure in Hawkins, where Valentine's Day brings more than romance. Ghostly apparitions and a destructive swarm of hate sprites begin terrorising the seemingly quiet town, drawing the Hawkins Investigators Club into another supernatural mystery. Eleven, Mike, Dustin, Lucas, Will, Max and their friends must uncover who — or what — is behind the disturbances before a new gate to the Upside Down tears open.



DAAYRA
Theatres
Releases: **September 18**

INSPIRED BY TRUE EVENTS, *Daayra* follows DCP Raman Kumar (Prithviraj Sukumaran) and DCP Ajooni Kohli (Kareena Kapoor Khan), two police officers divided by a disturbing criminal case. When Raman's pursuit of swift justice culminates in a controversial encounter, Ajooni begins investigating his actions and the public narrative surrounding them. Their confrontation exposes the uneasy line between law and vigilantism, while raising questions about accountability, due process and collective outrage.



LUST STORIES 3
Netflix
Releases: **September 18**

RETURNING FOR A THIRD instalment, *Lust Stories 3* brings together four intimate tales about love, longing, repressed desire and the messy realities of modern relationships. Directors Vikramaditya Motwane, Kiran Rao, Shakun Batra and Vishal Bhardwaj create distinct cinematic worlds in which attraction collides with vulnerability, silence and unexpected choices. The anthology features Radhika Apte, Konkona Sen Sharma, Aditi Rao Hydari, Radhika Madan, Sana Thampi, Siddharth, Ali Fazal, Vijay Varma, Abhishek Banerjee and Gurfateh Pirzada.



LOVE LOTTERY
Theatres
Releases: **September 18**

LOVE LOTTERY FOLLOWS corporate professional Kartik Saxena (Akshay Oberoi), whose troubled marriage becomes the centre of a murder investigation when his wife, Bharani Verma (Heli Daruwala), is found dead under mysterious circumstances. Arrested as the prime suspect, Kartik insists he is innocent and enters a courtroom battle to clear his name. As witnesses take the stand, conflicting statements, concealed relationships and long-buried secrets turn an apparently straightforward case into a maze of suspicion.



RESIDENT EVIL
Theatres
Releases: **September 18**

RESIDENT EVIL REINVENTS Capcom's survival-horror franchise through an original story unfolding amid the Raccoon City outbreak. Bryan (Austin Abrams), a medical courier, is sent to make a delivery at Raccoon City General Hospital when a deadly infection turns a night into a relentless fight for survival. Trapped as chaos spreads and monstrous creatures close in, he must navigate the city with limited resources and no easy escape.

— COMPILED BY MITALI

Opinion

SUNDAY, SEPTEMBER 13, 2026

MEASUREMENT OF GDP, ESPECIALLY THE RATE OF GROWTH OF GDP, IS CRUCIAL TO GAUGE THE HEALTH OF THE ECONOMY

Holding a mirror to GDP numbers

ACROSS THE AISLE

P Chidambaram



AS SOMEONE SAID, tongue in cheek, people don't eat GDP numbers. People eat food, wear clothes and footwear, send their children to school, buy medicines, use mobile phones, watch television, scroll social media, and want to be safe and happy — measured as Consumption. The aggregate of *Consumption (C)*, *Investment (I)*, *Government spending (G)* and *net Exports (X - M)* — after factoring for taxes and subsidies— is Gross Domestic Product (GDP). Measurement of GDP, especially the *rate of growth* of GDP, is crucial to gauge the health of the economy.

Healthier debate

The MoSPI has released the GDP numbers for Q1 of 2026-27: the rate of growth is 10.3% in nominal (current) prices and 7.8% in constant prices compared to Q1 2025-26. The government and the *sarkari* economists are pleased. The sceptics have raised questions. There is a raging debate on the credibility of the GDP numbers. Rather

	OLD BASE YEAR (2011-12) GDP		New base year (2022-23) GDP	
	Nominal Real		Nominal Real	
	Current prices	Constant prices	Current prices	Constant prices
2022-23	268.90	161.65	261.77	261.77
2023-24	301.23	176.51	290.73	280.94
2024-25	330.68	187.97	317.99	301.15
2025-26	357.14	201.90	345.37	324.70
CAGR	9.92%	7.69%	9.68%	7.45%
GDP in Q1 of 2026-27			88.26	81.36
Growth over Q1 of 2025-26			10.33%	7.82%

GDP IN ₹ LAKH CRORE

than debating the desirability of 'one nation, one election' (which will undermine federal parliamentary democracy), it is better to debate the GDP numbers and whether the benefits of growth are percolating to the people. I do not wish to add to the noise. Let's assume that MoSPI's numbers are correct. My calculations of the compounded annual growth rate (CAGR) of nominal and real GDP on two different base years are (*see Table*): Notably, on the old base year and the new base year, the CAGR beginning 2022-23 is *more or less the same*. The growth rate in Q1 of 2026-27 is only margin-



ally higher. Conclusion: the economy has *not* shifted gears in 2026-27; nor is it in overdrive. Therefore, no boast is warranted.

Pertinent questions

Let's hold a mirror to the latest GDP numbers. The nagging question is, under the old base year, the GDP in constant prices is very depressed compared to the GDP in current prices but it is not so under the new base year. Why? Be that as it may, the growth rate ought to

be reflected in the measurable parameters of the economy such as jobs, wages, consumption, trade, investment, etc. Here are some pertinent questions:

■ Why is the unemployment rate among youth of 15-29 years at a high of 16.2%? CMIE has reported that the unemployment rate for graduates aged 29-34 years often touches 40-45%; why? According to NITI Aayog, 8.7 crore youth aged 15-29 are 'Not in Employment, Education or Training' (NEET); why?

■ Why are *real* wages growing at dismal rates of (-) 5.5, 1.7 and 3.3%, respectively, among casual, salaried and self-employed workers? (*source: PLFS*). Twenty per cent of the workforce is casual labour and will they not be further impoverished by the negative wage growth?

■ Why is *net* FDI so low? FCNR (B) mobilisation which carried interest rates of 6-7% came in truckloads, but why is foreign capital not coming as direct investment?

■ When forex reserves have touched an all-time high of \$740 billion, why has the rupee not appreciated? Since January 2026, the rupee has depreciated nearly 5% against the US dollar and is reportedly the worst performing Asian currency; why?

■ Exports are rising, but imports are rising too. At current prices, imports are rising faster. Merchandise trade deficit touched \$150 billion in April-August 2026. The trade deficit with China alone in April-July was \$44 billion. Is the trade deficit not a drag on the economy? Why are Make-in-India, PLI, ASPIRE, NMCP and other schemes not resulting in manufacture of the goods that India imports from China?

■ In the sectoral composition of nominal GVA, why is 'manufacturing' stagnant at 13%? In fact, the share of the secondary sector in nominal GVA, over many quarters, has been bound

between 24 and 26%. Why have the schemes not pushed up the needle?

■ Why is capital investment, as measured by Gross Fixed Capital Formation (GFCF), stuck at roughly 33.5% of GDP? Of this, *private* corporate capital expenditure has remained unchanged at about 12%. Despite cajolery, admonishments and threats, why are corporate investors not willing to make capital investment?

■ Why has the growth number not resulted in more public goods such as better schools, better hospitals, better roads, better water supply, better policing, etc.? If one takes a straw poll, the overwhelming proportion of citizens will give a thumbs down on each of these areas.

Unedifying mirror image

There is no surprise that Gen Z is protesting against the marked deterioration all around them. We may be growing at 7.8% *statistically*, but most citizens do not *feel* or *believe* so. Because they know that their lives are not better or easier.

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Putting India on the golf tourism map

FAIRWAY FILES

Rahil Gangjee



THERE IS SOMETHING wonderfully strange about golfers. We will happily travel 3,000 kilometres to play a course we have never seen, spend a small fortune on a hotel, eat whatever is put in front of us, wake up at an ungodly hour and then spend four hours walking around looking for a little white ball that we ourselves hit into trouble. And at the end of it all, we will say, "What a fantastic holiday!"

That, in a nutshell, is golf tourism. For a golfer, a holiday is rarely just a holiday. Give us a decent golf course, good weather, a comfortable bed and something interesting to eat afterwards and we are sold. Add a beautiful landscape and a little history and culture, and you might have to physically drag us home. India has all of these things. What it hasn't always had is the confidence to sell itself as a golfing destination. That could be changing.

The Ministry of Tourism has once again identified golf tourism as an important niche segment, while the Indian Golf Premier League has announced an ambitious plan to mobilise \$2 billion towards golf-tourism infrastructure. The idea is to combine golf with hospitality, travel, MICE and destination development and, importantly, take the game beyond the traditional big-city markets. And honestly, it makes sense. India is almost tailor-made for golf tourism. We have mountains, beaches, deserts, forests, heritage cities and enough different cuisines to keep a golfer happy for several lifetimes. More importantly, we have golf courses in some extraordinary locations.

Take Kashmir. I have always felt that if you could combine golf and scenery, somebody forgot to tell the rest of the world about Srinagar. Royal Springs, with the mountains as a backdrop, is the sort of place where you can spend more time looking around than looking at your scorecard. Gulmarg and Pahalgam offer an entirely different experience. You could quite easily build a golf holiday around the Valley and have a story to tell when you return home.

Then there is Bengaluru. The city has quietly become an important golf destination, with courses such as the Karnataka Golf Association and the newer resort-style facilities around the city. And the great thing about Bengaluru is that you can play golf in the morning, have lunch, attend a meeting, complain about the traffic and still somehow convince yourself you had a relaxing day.

That is a skill only Bengaluru can teach you. Goa is another obvious opportunity. Most people think beaches, nightlife and seafood when they hear Goa. Golfers think, "Where is the nearest tee?" Imagine packaging golf with a few days by the beach, some good food and a little sightseeing. The non-golfer in the family gets a holiday and the golfer gets his rounds. Every- one wins.

That last part is important because golf tourism is not just about golfers. The golfer may travel for the course, but the family travels for everything else. That means hotels, restaurants, transport, sightseeing, shopping, wellness and entertainment all become part of the package. A golf holiday can therefore generate much more economic activity than simply collecting a green fee. And golfers are particularly attractive tourists because we tend to stay longer. We don't fly across the world to play nine holes and catch the next flight home.



Gulmarg and Pahalgam offer an entirely different experience. You could easily build a golf holiday around the valley and have a story to tell when you return home

If we are travelling with three or four clubs and a pair of shoes that cost more than our first car, we are going to make the trip worthwhile.

There is another big opportunity here: tournaments. I have played enough professional golf to know that a tournament can change the personality of a place. During an event, hotels fill up, restaurants get busy, taxis have more passengers and suddenly people who normally wouldn't know a three-wood from a rail- way sleeper are discussing golf. India already has professional tournaments that can become tourism products in their own right. Why should a golf tournament only be marketed to golf fans? Package it with local experiences and suddenly you have a destination event.

The same thinking can work with amateur events, corporate golf and international golf groups. Bring 50 or 100 golfers into a city, give them three or four courses to play, throw in some sightseeing and food, and you have created a small travelling economy.

The biggest challenge, of course, is infrastructure and consistency. Golfers are a demanding lot. We will forgive a bad lie. We will forgive a bad score. We will even forgive our playing partner for giving us unsolicited swing advice. But we will not forgive a golf course that promises one thing and delivers another.

Course maintenance, caddies, transport, booking systems, accommodation and accessibility all matter. International golfers need to know what they are getting before they board a flight. A beautiful photograph on Instagram is not enough when you are standing on the first tee with a trolley, 18 holes ahead of you and a handicap to protect.

India also needs better golf-tourism circuits. Instead of selling one golf course, sell an experience. Delhi-Jaipur. Bengaluru-Mysuru. Goa. Kashmir. Pune and the western Maharashtra circuit. Rajasthan. Even newer destinations can be built around golf if the infra-

structure is planned properly.

And this is where I think the next few years could get really interesting.

India doesn't have to copy Scotland, Spain or Thailand. We don't need to become somebody else's golf destination. We can create our own version.

Imagine a week where you play three or four very different courses, eat incredible food, see a bit of India, stay in good hotels and finish the trip with a tournament or a friendly game. And if your score is terrible, nobody needs to know. You can always blame the jet lag.

The numbers suggest there is a genuine opportunity. One recent market estimate puts India's golf-tourism market at around \$459 million in 2026 and projects it to more than double by 2033.

But numbers are only part of the story. Golf tourism is really about selling an experience.

The game takes you places. Sometimes literally. I've played golf in enough parts of the world to know that some of my best memories have had very little to do with my score. They have been about the people, the food, the scenery, the ridiculous bets, the stories afterwards and occasionally the miracle of making a birdie when you had absolutely no business doing so.

India has millions of stories waiting to be attached to golf. We just need to start telling them.

And perhaps, for once, we should stop worrying about whether India can become a golf-tourism destination and start asking a more interesting question:

Why shouldn't it? After all, we already have the courses, the culture, the food, the scenery and, most importantly, enough golfers who are willing to travel anywhere in the world just to lose a few balls in a different postcode.

Rahil Gangjee is a professional golfer, sharing through this column what life on a golf course is like

Golfers are a demanding lot. We will forgive a bad lie. We will forgive a bad score. But we will not forgive a golf course that promises one thing and delivers another

Who are the real patriots?

FIFTH COLUMN

TAVLEEN SINGH



THERE APPEARS TO be a fifth columnist in the Prime Minister's inner circle. This thought came to me when I saw him jubilantly striding across that college stage in Vadodra last week. The event seemed part of his Gen-Z seduction crusade, and what he strode, smiled and waved to was the tune of *We Will Rock You*. Luckily, it was only the tune that played. Had he been aware of the words, Modi may have fainted. Here is a line: 'You got mud on your face, big disgrace. Somebody better put you back into your place.'

See what I mean about a fifth columnist working in the innards of the PMO? Also, the song is from 1977 when people of my generation were young and rebellious, and the cockroaches who have now got so badly under Modi's skin were not even specks on the horizon. More seriously — who was the idiot who advised the Prime Minister to attend this joyous event at a time when a PG (paying guest) hostel had just crumbled in Delhi University's south campus, killing young students and their dreams? Among the dead was eighteen-year-old Arpit Jai, whose taxi driver father worked overtime to send his son to college and struggled to pay the exorbitant rent for his PG hovel. I heard Arpit's story in Barkha Dutt's *Mojo Story*. It brought tears to my eyes.

We in the mainstream media have mostly ignored the stories of the seven dead students. Perhaps because they would all be as heartbreaking. Instead, almost every news channel reported every moment of the Prime Minister's trip to Gujarat as if it was the most important news of the day. If they had stayed with the building collapse in Satya Niketan, there may have been some hope of coercing the 'triple-engine' government in Delhi to stem the corruption that led to the horror of students being killed for just trying to get a college degree.

While the Chief Minister's cohort surveyed the debris of the illegally built PG (paying guest) hostel from high above, a handful of real journalists dug deeper into the crashed building and showed pictures of the horrendous conditions in which students live. The Cockroach Janta Party leader who said that students are being forced to live like cockroaches is correct. The building that crumbled is among others in which students live in cells built one upon the other, and that can only be reached through dangerously narrow alleys darkened by clumps of hanging wires. I must here add that the best reporting I saw came from a digital

platform called PEEKTV.

When I saw their pictures of those dismal alleyways and dreary rooms, I found myself hoping that the Prime Minister was also watching so he could understand why he needs to forget about our 'demographic dividend'. Young students who are forced to live and study in such horrible conditions will never learn to think, dream or learn. How will they be able to compete with students who, in other colleges in other countries, have already learned how to deal with the technological revolution that AI brings?

This one building collapse has brought to the surface many other things, like the abysmal state of governance in Delhi. It has revealed corruption so evil that it boggles the mind. Everyone is involved in creating the smokescreen that allows builders to disobey the rules of safe planning. The PG mafia that extorts inexplicably high rents from desperate students is controlled by politicians and high officials who always seem to get away with their evil deeds.

The only thing that happens after every disaster of the kind we saw in Satya Niketan is that some lowly officials get publicly yelled at by higher officials like the Chief Minister and then some committee is appointed to (supposedly) go into causes and solutions. These committees never amount to much, as we can see from the one appointed after the building collapse in Delhi's Malviya Nagar some months ago. Corrupt officials and politicians collude to make Delhi non-functional except when there is a big conference of the BRICS kind. And then things only appear to work because visiting dignitaries are only allowed to see restricted sections of India's capital city.

This is the way things are. It is the way things have always been. But the cockroaches and their young cheerleaders are ensuring this is not how they will always be in the future. It is the one thing that gives me some hope that a day will come when officials and politicians who have created the mess that we see today pay for their crimes. One idea from me is that the officials who allowed that PG hostel to be built should be charged with manslaughter, and that this be done every time a building collapses and kills people. No more committees. No more inquiry commissions. When people die because of the criminal negligence of officials, those officials should be charged with manslaughter, if not murder. Meanwhile, the Prime Minister needs to find out who the fifth columnist is in his inner circle and punish him for sending him off to college events where he blames what is wrong with India on 'dimagi naxals'. He seems quite proud of this new label, without noticing that the people he is charging with sedition could be the very patriots that we need today.

SUNDAY, SEPTEMBER 13, 2026

SONAM RAINA

While carbon dioxide is the most talked-about greenhouse gas, methane is significantly more potent. To understand why, imagine greenhouse gases as blankets covering the Earth. Carbon dioxide adds many thin blankets, while methane adds only a few but much thicker ones. Even in small amounts, methane traps far more heat. Despite being less abundant in the atmosphere, methane has caused nearly one-third of all warming since the Industrial Revolution. But what if this climate offender could become a resource? That's the question driving String Bio, a Bengaluru-based startup co-founded by Ezhil Subbian and Vinod ML Kumar, which is turning methane into food, feed and sustainable materials.

consume methane as their energy source. After 12 years of development, String Bio now produces a gamut of products – a range of bio-nutrients designed to sup-

Is this the world's unlikeliest **PROTEIN SOURCE?**

Despite the promise, the road to commercialisation is steep. "The single-cell protein market is growing," says Pratyoosh Shukla of the School of Biotechnol-

Voices from the field

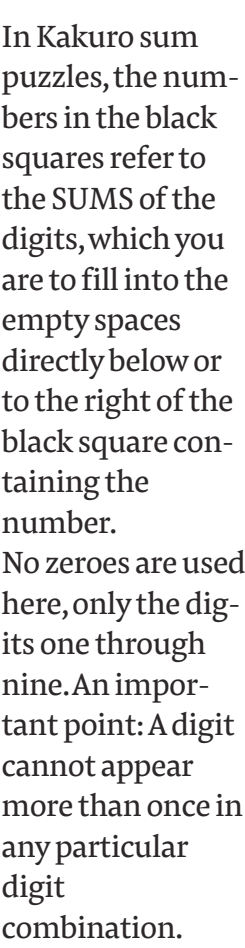
StringBio's agricultural products CleanRise and PRO-DG have been tested

Shukla emphasises the need for economic proof. In India, the most compelling evidence would be field-level economic modelling comparing SCP production with traditional protein sources like soy or fishmeal, along with pilot successes using locally isolated methanotroph strains. "If any industry is funding it, more opportunities are towards commercialisation," he says.

The climate solutions non-profit Project Drawdown counts curbing methane emissions among the high-impact climate solutions the world needs right now to stay on a below 2 degrees global heating trajectory. About 40% of existing methane comes from natural

The piece is published in
arrangement with Climate Action Live
<https://www.climateaction.live>

LEXICON

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(6)
26 Plan your holidays with __ Mahindra (4)
27 __ Fertilisers Ltd.: COFE, in short (10)
30 Something to paint red in celebrations (4)
31 __ tracking: research method to determine what part of the advertisement a consumer looks at (3)
32 Insanity (6)
DOWN
1 "W" in WAN, the computer jargon (4)
2 Transport Service Data Unit, abbr. (4)
3 __ rate notes: FRN, in short (8)
4 A statement of recent transactions and the resulting balance (7)
5 Barrister or solicitor

(6)
6 A publicist of sorts
 (5,5)
7 Tennis legend ____
 Nadal (6)
14 Unit Trust of India,
 acronym (3)
15 "UB" in UBI the
 financial institution
 (6,4)
19 Super diesel from
 Indian Oil - no distance
 too long (4,4)
20 ____ in :agreement
 to work together
 between two compa-
 nies on one project (3)
21 Took the first step?
 (7)
23 "F" in FRCP? (6)
24 Go beyond, over-
 shoot (6)
28 Tata Motors model
 that launched at ₹1
 lakh (4)
29 Every one taken sep-
 arately (4)

Discussion: As you would have perceived by now, EW has at best a 130 in a diamond part score. South could have avoided the debacle by simply jumping to 2H at his first opportunity. 2D by west over 1H overall suggested 10 +, that south did not heed. When you are OUT-GUNNED, it is better to retire from bidding at the earliest opportunity. Even granting 3H is acceptable, the 4H bid, all by himself, was a complete waste of time.

A fair number of these campaigns were never real to begin with. They're shams — or sham-paigns, if you will — designed to snag some free press during the slow months and elevate the would-be candidate's profile.

—Ryan Teague Beckwith, "Time to pop the sham-paign' bubble," *Lowell Sun*, August 20, 2013

Discussion: As you would have perceived by now, EW has at best a 130 in a diamond part score. South could have avoided the debacle by simply jumping to 2H at his first opportunity. 2D by west over 1H overall suggested 10 +, that south did not heed. When you are OUT-GUNNED, it is better to retire from bidding at the earliest opportunity. Even granting 3H is acceptable, the 4H bid, all by himself, was a complete waste of time.



INDIA SHELTER FINANCE CORPORATION LTD.

POSSESSION NOTICE FOR IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

Corporate Office: 6th Floor, Plot No 15, Institutional Area, Sector 44 Gurugram-122003 Haryana Tel: 1800- 532-4444, **BRANCH :** Maharashtra

Whereas, The Undersigned Being The Authorised Officer Of The India Shelter Finance And Corporation Ltd, Under The Securitisation And Reconstruction Of Financial Assets And Enforcement (security) Interest Act,2002 And In Exercise Of Power Conferred Under Section 13(12) Read With Rule 3 Of The Security Interest (enforcement) Rules,2002,issued A Demand Notice On The Date Noted Against The Account As Mentioned Hereinafter, Calling Upon The Borrower And Also The Owner Of The Property/surety To Repay The Amount Within 60 Days From The Date Of The Said Notice. Whereas The Owner Of The Property And The Other Having Failed To Repay The Amount, Notice Is Hereby Given To The Under Noted Borrowers And The Public In General That The Undersigned Has Taken Possession Of The Property/ies Described Herein Below In Exercise Of The Powers Conferred On Him/her Under Section 13(4) Of The Said Act Read With Rules 8 & 9 Of The Said Rules On The Dates Mentioned Against Each Account. The Borrower Attention Is Invited To Provisions Of Sub Section (8) Of Section 13 Of The Act, In Respect Of Time Available, to Redeem The Secured Assets. Now, The Borrower In Particular And The Public In General Is Hereby Cautioned Not To Deal With The Property/ies And Any Dealing With The Property/ies Will Be Subject To The Charge Of India Shelter Finance Corporation Ltd For An Amount Mentioned As Below And Interest Thereon, Costs, Etc.

NAME OF THE BORROWER/GUARANTOR (OWNER OF THE PROPERTY) & LOAN ACCOUNT NUMBER	DESCRIPTION OF THE CHARGED /MORTGAGED PROPERTY (ALL THE PART & PARCEL OF THE PROPERTY CONSISTING OF)	DT. OF DEMAND NOTICE, AMOUNT DUE AS ON DATE OF DEMAND NOTICE	DATE OF POSSESSION
Anuradha Pramod Mohite, Pramod Mohite & Parashram Vishnu Mohite RESIDE AT: Milkat No.434, Bhavani Chowk,At Savarde, Tal Tasgaon Dist Sangli-416408 Maharashtra LOAN ACCOUNT NO. LA11VVLONS000005115649	All Piece And Parcel Of Bearing Milkat No.434, Anukramank No.430, And Its land Area 1500 Sq Ft. Simple construction 1500 Sq Ft. Situated At Savarde Tq Tasgaon Dist Sangli Boundary:- East-Property Of Rajaram Vishnu Mohite,West-Property Of Bhagwan Shankar Mane,North-Road, South-Road	DEMAND NOTICE 10-Oct-2025 Rs. 2131058/- (Rupees Twenty One Lakh Thirty One Thousand Five Eight Only) Due As On 10.10.2025 Together With Interest Applicable From 11.10.2025 And Other Charges And Cost Till The Date Of The Payment.	11.09.2026 Physical
KANTABAI JOTIRAM GUND, GAURAV JOTIRAM GUND & JOTIRAM YOGIRAJ GUND RESIDE AT: Gat No.307/2/C, Near Airtel Tower, Neware Omware Road, Gund Wasti, At Neware Taluka - Malshiras, District - Solapur - 413112 Maharashtra. oundary:- East- Gat No. 307/2/K Out of Plot No.2, South-Land Of Kiran Nilin Asbe, West- Nevre to Umbare Road, North- Internal Road	All Piece And Parcel Of Gat No.307/2/K, having an area of 30.25 R Sq. Mtrs, out of that non agricultural land, Plot No. 1 ADM 5.00 R Sq. Mtrs (5000.00 Sq.Ft) At Neware, Taluka - Malshiras, District - Solapur - 413112 Maharashtra. oundary:- East- Gat No. 307/2/K Out of Plot No.2, South-Land Of Kiran Nilin Asbe, West- Nevre to Umbare Road, North- Internal Road	DEMAND NOTICE 12-Jan-2026 Rs. 1667959/- (Rupees Sixteen Lakh Sixty Seven Thousand Nine Hundred Fifty Nine Only) Due As On 10.01.2026 Together With Interest Applicable From 11.01.2026 And Other Charges And Cost Till The Date Of The Payment.	11/09/2026 Physical
PRABHAVATI SANJAY PAWAR, SANJAY JAGANNATH PAWAR & SATISH JAGANNATH PAWAR RESIDE AT: Milkat no. 51, At Post Gopalpur Taluka Pandharpur, Dist Solapur 413304 Maharashtra LOAN ACCOUNT NO. LAPNVLLONS000005150799	All Piece And Parcel Of Milkat no. 51 West Side Part, Admeasuring Area - 435.50 Sq. Mtrs, (i.e 4686.00 Sq. Ft) With Built-up Area- 130.11 Sq. Mtrs, (i.e 1400.00 Sq. Ft), At Post Gopalpur Taluka Pandharpur, Dist Solapur 413304 Maharashtra Boundary:- East- House of Pandurang Yashwant Metkari, West -Road And House of Bhambai Manik Asbe, South -Property of Bhamabai Asbe, North -Property of Mahadev Baliram Asbe	DEMAND NOTICE 11-May-2026 Rs. 1173300/- (Rupees Eleven Lakh Seventy Three Thousand Three Hundred Only) Due As On 10.05.2026 Together With Interest Applicable From 11.05.2026 And Other Charges And Cost Till The Date Of The Payment.	11.09.2026

FOR ANY QUERY PLEASE CONTACT MR. TUSHAR HURDE (+91 7350002453),
MR. PRAKASH TANDULKAR (+91 7447426676)

PLACE: Madhya Pradesh
DATE: 13.09.2026

(AUTHORIZED OFFICER)
INDIA SHELTER FINANCE CORPORATION LTD

SVATANTRA MICRO HOUSING FINANCE CORPORATION LTD.

Office no. 5 & 6, 11th Floor, E Wing, Times Square, Andheri-Kurla Road, Marol, Andheri (E), Mumbai 400059. TEL- 8001234427 + 91 22 69609000/100 Email : collections@smfcoindia.com



AUCTION-CUM-TENDER SALE NOTICE TO GENERAL PUBLIC

Whereas under section 13(2) of the 'Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002, the Authorized Officer has issued demand notices as mentioned below in table for the recovery as mentioned from the borrowers/guarantors/mortgagors (herein referred to as borrowers). Further, In exercise of powers contained in the 'Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002, the Authorized Officer has taken the possessions of the under mentioned secured assets which are held as securities in respect of Loan/credit facilities granted to them. Whereas sale of the secured asset/s is to be made through Public auction cum Tender, for recovery of the secured debt due to **Svatantra Micro Housing Finance Corporation Ltd., (SMHFC)**. The General Public is invited to bid either personally or by a duly authorised agent.

Details of borrowers/amount outstanding/Properties/Reserve Price/EMD Amount, Date & Time of Deposit of EMD/Date & Time of Inspection/Date & Time of Auction:

Name & Address of Borrower/Guarantors/ Mortgagors	Date of Demand Notice Amount outstanding Possession Date	Description of properties along with name of mortgagors (Owner of the property)	Reserve Price & Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)
Mr. Shivaji Babar Mr. Amol Babar	09/04/2026 Rs.3,00,445/- (Rs Three Lakh Four Hundred Forty-Five Only) Possession Date: 13/08/2026	Milkat No 371, Taluka Kagal, Karanjivane, Kolhapur, Maharashtra, 416219	Rs.5.70 Lacs Rs.57,000/-
Mr. Sandip Patil Mr. Vishnu Patil Mrs. Vimal Patil	14/05/2026 Rs.1,87,278/- (Rs One Lakh Eighty-Seven Thousand Two Hundred Seventy-Eight Only) Possession Date: 13/08/2026	Grampanchayat Property No.61, Taluka- Gaganavada, Kherivade, Kolhapur, Maharashtra, 416205	Rs.5.70 Lacs Rs.57,000/-
Mr. Mayur Dayanand More Mr. Dayanand Babasaheb More Mrs. Sarika Dayanand More	14/05/2026 Rs. 19,07,950/- (Rupees Nineteen Lakh Seven Thousand Nine Hundred Fifty Only) Possession Date: 12/08/2026	Plot No.06, Survey No.482/2, Dudhalwasti, Ghatagewadi Road, at Jath, Sangli, Maharashtra, 416404	Rs.23.00 Lacs Rs.2,30,000 /-
Mrs. Baanu Mainoddin Chanda Mr. Ilyas Mainoddin Chanda	14/05/2026 Rs. 2,01,794/- (Rupees Two Lakh One Thousand Seven Hundred Ninety-Four Only) Possession Date: 11/08/2026	Flat/Unit No. 311, Floor No. 2, Flat Type- 1 BHK of Building called Gat No. 979/1 Plot No. 1 Building No. 20 in the Project Ray Nagar Housing Project situated at Gat No. 722/2/F723, 697, 707, 726, 724, 725, 764, 721, 845, 728, 710, 755, 729/1, 978/3, 979/1, 963/1, 963/2, 963/3, 977/1, 981/1, 982/1, 982/2 At Kumbhari, Solapur-South, Solapur, 413006	Rs.4.00 Lacs Rs.40,000/-
Mr. Najir Mehabub Shaikh Mrs. Shamim Najir Shaikh	08/06/2026 Rs. 14,04,773/- (Rupees Fourteen Lakh Four Thousand Seven Hundred Seventy-Three Only) Possession Date: 31/08/2026	Flat/Unit No. G-2, Floor No. 0, Flat Type- 1 BHK of Building called B in the Project Om Shanti Nagar situated at Survey No. 167/1A/1/1A (Old Gat No. 187), CTS No. 2690, at Daund, Near Swami Samarth Mandir, Shalimar Chowk, Taluka-Daund, District- Pune - 413801	Rs. 8.95 Lacs Rs.89,500/-
Mr. Ravi Anil Telangi Mrs. Laxmi Anil Telangi	08/06/2026 Rs. 9,36,115/- (Rupees Nine Lakh Thirty-Six Thousand One Hundred Fifteen Only) Possession Date: 29/08/2026	Plot No.7A out of Survey No.692/3(New Survey No.302/3), Bamni Road, at Miraj, Taluka- Miraj, Sangli, Maharashtra, 416410	Rs.10.85 Lacs Rs.1,08,500/-
Mr. Namadev Ashok Dhumal Mr. Ashok Namdev Dhumal Mrs. Triveni Namdev Dhumal Mrs. Changuana Ashok Dhumal	08/06/2026 Rs. 18,49,674/- (Rupees Eighteen Lakh Forty-Nine Thousand Six Hundred Seventy-Four Only) Possession Date: 29/08/2026	Plot No.31 out of survey No.31/1 (Old Survey No.36/1), Ayodhya Nagar, at Miraj, Taluka-Miraj, Sangli, Maharashtra, 416410	Rs.21.70 Lacs Rs.2,17,000/-
Mr. Swarup Sudhir Pachange Mr. Sudhir D Pachange Mrs. Gauri Jaydeep Chavan Mrs. Sushma S Pachange	08/06/2026 Rs. 24,12,427/- (Rupees Twenty-Four Lakh Twelve Thousand Four Hundred Twenty-Seven Only) Possession Date: 01/09/2026	Flat/Unit No. 7, Floor No. 1, Flat Type - 1 BHK of Building called Laxmi Kamal Vishwa in the Project Laxmi Kamal Vishwa Chsl situated at Survey No.180 (Old Survey No.152), Hissa No. 5A and Hissa No. 16A, At Fursungi, Taluka: Haveli, District: Pune 412308	Rs. 18.00 Lacs Rs.1,80,000/-

◆ Date and Time of Inspection:- 10-10-2026 - 11.00 AM to 1.00 PM ◆ Last date & time of deposit of EMD: 12-10-2026 up to 5.00 PM ◆ Date and Time of Auction : 14-10-2026 - 11.00 AM to 12.00 PM

TERMS AND CONDITIONS OF E-AUCTION SALE: The sale shall be subject to the Terms & Conditions prescribed in the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002 and to the following further conditions:
i. The properties are being sold on 'AS IS WHEREAS' BASIS.
ii. The particulars of Secured Assets specified in the Schedule herein above have been stated to the best of the information of the Authorised Officer, but the Authorised Officer shall not be answerable for any error, misstatement or omission in this proclamation.
iii. The secured assets will not be sold below the reserve price.
iv. The auction sale will be "through Auction-Cum-Tender".
v. The bidders are also advised for detailed terms and conditions The interested bidders shall deposit the EMD by way of Demand Draft favoring "SMHFC LTD" or through NEFT/RTGS A/c No. **00608940000020** IFSC Code: **HDFC0002838** " as per above mentioned account numbers The draft should not be of a Cooperative-Bank. vi. Bidder is to submit these documents through e-mail to the Authorised Officer at e-mail address and also to submit self-attested hard copies of these documents (Demand Draft in original) to the Authorised Officer, at the Branch address mentioned herein above in the envelope super scribing as 'Bid in the A/C (mention the account Name)
vii. Others detailed Terms and Conditions available on website www.svatantramhfc.com. Further enquiries may be clarified with the Authorized Officer, SMHFC (+91 8657949180), Mr.Dattatray Rajguru (+91 8291297005), Mr. Anil Aher (+918657582030), Mr. Prasann Chauhkhande (+91 8668275765), Mr. Anil Patil (+91 9167220728) & Mr. Sharik Saudagar (+91 887966943) or 022-26101076-79 Email-sharik.saudagar@svatantramhfc.com.

Authorised Officer
Svatantra Micro Housing Finance Corporation Ltd (SMHFC)
(Secured Creditor)

Place : Maharashtra
Date : 13-09-2026

Annexure 13 Form No. 22
[See Regulation 37(1)] By All Permissible Mode

**OFFICE OF THE RECOVERY OFFICER
DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL PUNE**
Unit No. 307 to 310, 3rd Floor, Kakade Biz Icon Building, Shivaji Nagar, Pune-411005.

Date : 04/09/2026
Date of Auction Sale : 23/10/2026

RC. No. 1/2021

Proclamation of Sale: Immovable Property

Proclamation of Sale Under Rules 37, 38, AND 52, 53 of Second Schedule to the Income Tax Act, 1961 Read with the Recovery of Debts Due Debts Due To Banks and Financial Institutions (RDBB) Act, 1993
Indian Overseas Bank
Versus
Millenium Mobility Pvt. Ltd. & Ors.

Whereas Recovery Certificate No. RC/1/2021 in OA No.397/2014 drawn up by the Hon'ble Presiding Officer, **DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL PUNE** for the recovery of the sum of **Rs. 18,54,97,562.00 (Rupees Eighteen Crores Fifty Four Lakhs Ninety Seven Thousands Five Hundred Sixty Two Only)**, along with pendent life and future interest @ 13.50% w.e.f. 14/02/2019 till realization with costs of **Rs.1,75,255 (Rupees One Lakh Seventy five Thousand Two Hundred Fifty Five Only)** from the CDs and you, the CDs, failed to repay the dues of the Certificate Holder Bank(S)/Financial Institution(s).

And whereas the undersigned has ordered the sale of the Mortgaged/Attached properties as mentioned in the Schedule hereunder towards satisfaction of the said Recovery Certificate. Notice is hereby given that in absence of any order of postponement, the said property(s) shall be sold on **23/10/2026 between 11:00 AM to 01:00 PM** by e-auction and bidding shall take place through **'Online Electronic Bidding'** through the website: **assets.matexnetauctions.com**

The intending bidders are advised to refer to the detailed terms and conditions displayed at the site of the property, on the Notice Board of the Recovery Officer, on the website **http://drt.gov.in** and in the website of the e-auction service provider **assets.matexnetauctions.com**. For any other clarification, the undersigned may be contacted either in person or over the phone OR contact the Authorised Bank Officer/ Auction Service provider, whose details are as follows:

Name of the CH Branch	Indian Overseas Bank
Name of the Nodal Branch & Address	2nd Floor, 272, Shaniwar Peth, Opposite Omkareshwar Temple, Pune-411030.
Branch Phone No.	LANDLINE : 020-25660210 /25660134
Bank official Designated and Mobile No.	Mr. Nitesh Kumar, Chief Manager, Mobile - 8925952584
Name of Empanelled Agency for E Auction	M/s. Matex Technologies Private Limited
Address	37/22, Chamiers Towers, 6th Floor, Chamiers Road, Teynampet, Chennai-600018.
Phone No.	Ms. Induja K. - 9150757333, Mr. Dhanush - 9500173312.
E-mail Address	solutions@matexnet.com
Website address	assets.matexauction.com
Contact Person	Ms. Induja K. - 9150757333, Mr. Dhanush - 9500173312.

The sale will be of the properties of defendants/ CDs above named, as mentioned in the schedule below & the liabilities and claims attaching to the said properties, so far as they have been ascertained, are those specified in the schedule

The property will be put up for sale in the lot specified in the schedule. If the amount to be realized is satisfied by the sale of portion of the property, the sale shall be immediately stopped with respect to the remainder. The sale will also be stopped if, before any lot is knocked down the arrears mentioned in the said certificate+ interest+costs (including cost of sale) are tendered to the officer conducting the sale or proof is given to his satisfaction that the amount of such certificate, interest and costs has been paid to the undersigned.

At the sale, the public generally are invited to bid either personally or by duly Authorised agent. No officer or other person, having any duty to perform in connection with this sale shall, however, either directly or indirectly, bid for, acquire attempt to acquire any interest in the properties sold.

The sale shall be subject to conditions prescribed in the second schedule to the Income Tax Act, 1961 and the rules made thereunder and to the following further conditions

I) The particulars specified in the annexed schedule below have been stated to the best of the information of the undersigned, but the undersigned shall not be answerable for any error, misstatement or omission in the proclamation.

II) The Reserve Price (DISTRESS VALUE) below mentioned which the property shall not be sold.

III) The amount by which the bidding is to be increased, shall be Rs. 50,000/- (Rs. Fifty Thousand Only) In the event of any dispute arising as to the amount bid or as to the bidder the lot shall at once be again put up for auction or may be cancelled. If there is only one bidder the e auction will commence with one increment over and above the Reserve price.

IV) The highest bidder shall be declared to be the purchaser of any lot provided always that he/she/they are legally qualified to bid and provided further the amount bid by him/her/they is not less than the reserve price. It shall be in the discretion of the undersigned to decline acceptance of the highest bid when the price offered appears so clearly inadequate as to make it inadvisable to do so.

V) Each intending bidders shall be required to deposit Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) & all required documents before 19-10-2026 upto 05.00 pm. EMD to be deposited by way of Demand Draft in favour of RECOVERY OFFICER, DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL PUNE and submit details / required document R.O. DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL PUNE as under :
A) Online Auction Bid Form (Duly Signed). B) Declaration by Bidder/s (Duly Signed). C) Details of the Property, D) Copy of PAN Card, E) Address Proof and Identity Proof, F) E-mail ID, Mobile No. G) In case of the company - any other document, confirming representation / attorney of the company, H) DD/Pay Order / Receipt / Counter foil and Statement of Account by which such amount remitted to the Account of Recovery Officer, DRT, Pune.
Note : EMD & all required documents deposited after the required timeline shall not be considered eligible for participation in the auction.)

VII) Last date for receipt of EMD and all required documents is **19/10/2026 till 05.00 pm**. EMD/required documents, received after due date & time shall be rejected & the amount paid towards the EMD shall be returned to them by way of cheque/option given by them in the E-Auction Form. Required documents/correspondence can be submitted online at **ro-drtpunegov.in** or physically in the RO office - DRT Pune in the required timeline. Demand Drafts to be deposited in the RO-Office, DRT Pune.

V) Any person desirous of participating in the bidding process is required to have a valid digital signature certificate issued by the competent authority. It is the sole responsibility of the bidder to obtain the said digital signature certificate, active-email id and a computer terminal/system with internet connection to enable him/her to participate in the bidding.

VII) Any issue with regard to digital signature certificate and connectivity during the course of online bidding shall be the sole responsibility of the bidder and no claims in this regard shall be entertained.

VIII) If the bid is increased within the last 5 minutes of the given time of auction, the auction time is further extended by additional time of 5 minutes to enable the other bidders to increment their bids & the auction process commences to an end if no further increment(s) is/are made within the extended time of 5 minutes. In case of movable/immovable property the price of each lot shall be paid at the time of sale or as soon after as the officer holding the sale directs, and in default of payment, the property shall forthwith be again put up for auction for resale.

VIII) The successful bidder shall have to pay 25% of the sale proceeds after adjustment of EMD on being knocked down by next day through Demand draft/ Banker Cheque /Pay order etc or by online through RTGS into the Account No. 60583099502 in the name of "Recovery Officer - DRT, Pune - held with the BANK OF MAHARASHTRA IFSC Code No. MAHB0000750. If the next day is Holiday or Sunday, then on next first office day. The purchaser shall deposit the balance 75% of the sale proceeds on or before 15th day from the date of sale of the property, exclusive of such day, or if the 15th day be Sunday or other Holiday, then on the first office day after the 15th day by prescribed mode as stated above. In addition to the above the purchaser shall also deposit Pledge fee with Recovery Officer, DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL PUNE @ 2% upto Rs.1,000/- and @ 1% of the excess of the said amount of Rs. 1,000/- In the recovery Officer account mentioned above.

IX) In case of default of payment within the prescribed period, the deposit, after defraying the expenses of the sale, may, if the undersigned thinks fit, shall be forfeited to the Government and the defaulting purchaser shall forfeit all claims to the property or to any part of the sum for which it may subsequently be sold. The property shall be resold after the issue of fresh proclamation of sale. Highest bidder shall not have any right/title over the property until the sale is confirmed by the Recovery Officer, DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL PUNE

X) The amount of EMD deposited by the unsuccessful bidders in the form of DD, the same will be returned by hand. Original ID proof of the photocopy sent with the E-Auction EMD Form has to be brought. No interest shall be paid on EMD amount

XI) Request for inclusion/substitution in the sale certificate of names of any person(s) other than those mentioned in the E-Auction EMD Form shall not be entertained.

XII) In case of more than one items of property brought for sale, the sale of such properties will be as per the convenience and it is not obligatory to go serially as mentioned in the sale notice.

XIII)NRI Bidders must necessarily enclose a copy of photo page of their passport route their bid duly endorsed by Indian Mission (Embassy)

XIV) The movable /immovable property is being sold on **"As is where is and as is what is"** basis and is subject to Publication charges, revenue and other Encumbrances as per rules. The undersigned reserves the right to accept or reject any or all bids, if found unreasonable or may postpone the auction at any time without assigning any reason.

Details of this Proclamation of sale can be viewed at the website www.drt.gov.in/assets.matexnetauctions.com

The Earnest money Deposit (EMD), Reserve Price and Bid Increase, be fixed as follows :

Lot No.	Details of Property	EMD Amount (In Rs.)	Reserve Price (In Rs.) Market Value	Bid Increase in the multiple of (In Rs.)
1)	Lot 1 - All that piece and parcel of the land bearing Gat No. 144/B ad measuring 1H 90 R situate at village Theur, Taluka Haveli, District Pune within the registration sub district of Pune.	37,24,000/-	3,72,40,000/-	50,000/-
	All that piece and parcel of the land admeasuring 85 R out of an area admeasuring 06 H 10 R along with Potkharaba situated at Old S.No. 75 and New Gat No. 144 A village Theur Tal. Haveli, Dist. Pune and within the jurisdiction of Sub Registrar, Haveli No VI (As per the latest revenue record, the No. 144A & 144B have been amalgamated and have been allotted Gat No. 144).	16,66,000/-	1,66,60,000/-	50,000/-
	Lot 2 - All that piece and parcel of the land bearing Gat No. 328/2 admeasuring about 81 R out of total area 3H 91 R, situated at village Theur, Tal Haveli, Dist. Pune and within the locale limits of Grampanchayat Theur.	17,01,000/-	1,70,10,000/-	50,000/-
	Lot 3 - All that piece and parcel of the land bearing Gat No. 146, admeasuring about 2H 03 R situated at village Theur Pune, Tal. Haveli, Dist. Pune and within the local limits of Grampanchayat Theur and the said land is Bounded as under - On or towards East — By Gat No. 147. On or towards South- By Gat No. 144. On or towards West — By Gat No. 145, On or towards North — By Gat No. 161.	39,78,800/-	3,97,88,000/-	50,000/-
Lot 4 :	a) All that piece and parcel of the land bearing Gat No. 161, admeasuring about 91 R including well out of the total land admeasuring 3 H 02 R situated at village Theur, Pune, Tal. Haveli, Dist. Pune.	35,57,200/-	3,56,72,000/-	50,000/-
	b) All that piece and parcel of the land bearing Gat No. 161, admeasuring about 31 R out of the total land ad measuring 3 H 02 R situated at village T heur, Pu ne Tal. Haveli, Dist. Pu ne.			
	c) All that piece and parcel of the land bearing Gat No. 161, admeasuring about 60 R out of the total land ad measuring 3 H 02 R situated at village Theur, Pune, Tal. Haveli, Dist. Pune. And within the local limits Grampanchayat Theur.	67,89,700/-	6,78,97,000/-	50,000/-
	LOT 5 : All that piece and parcel of the land admeasuring 3 H 23.32 R alongwith Potkharaba situated at Gat No. 328 B at Village T heur Taluka Haveli, Dist. Pune and within the jurisdiction of Sub Registrar Haveli No. VI. All that part & parcel of the land bearing gat No. 328/1 admeasuring 3 Hector 02 R situated at Theur Village, Tal. Haveli, Dist. Pune. (As per the latest revenue record, Gat No. 328 and 328/1 have been amalgamated and have been allotted Gat No. 328)	63,42,000/-	6,34,20,000/-	50,000/-

Schedule of Property :

Lot No.	Description of property to be Sold	Revenue assessed upon the property or part thereof	Details of any encumbrances to which the property is liable	Claim if any which have been put forward to the property and any other known bearing on its nature and value
Lot 1 - All that piece and parcel of the land bearing Gat No. 144/B ad measuring 1H 90 R situate at village Theur, Taluka Haveli, District Pu ne within the registration sub-district of Pune. All that piece and parcel of the land admeasuring 85 R out of an area admeasuring 06 H 10 R along with Potkharaba situated at Old S.No. 75 and New Gat No. 144 A village Theur Tal. Haveli, Dist. Pune and within the jurisdiction of Sub Registrar, Haveli No VI (As per the latest revenue record, the No. 144A & 144B have been amalgamated and have been allotted Gat No. 144). Lot 2 - All that piece and parcel of the land bearing Gat No. 328/2 ad measuring about 81 R out of total area 3H 91 R, situated at village Theur, Tal Haveli, Dist. Pune and within the locale limits of Grampanchayat Theur. Lot 3 - All that piece and parcel of the land bearing Gat No. 146, admeasuring about 2H 03 R situated at village Theur Pune, Tal. Haveli, Dist. Pune and within the local limits of Grampanchayat Theur and the said land is Bounded as under - On or towards East — By Gat No. 147 On or towards South- By Gat No. 144 On or towards West — By Gat No. 145, On or towards North — By Gat No. 161. Lot 4 : a) All that piece and parcel of the land bearing Gat No. 161, admeasuring about 91 R including well out of the total land admeasuring 3 H 02 R situated at village Theur, Pune, Tal. Haveli, Dist. Pune. b) All that piece and parcel of the land bearing Gat No. 161, admeasuring about 31 R out of the total land ad measuring 3 H 02 R situated at village Theur, Pu ne Tal. Haveli, Dist. Pu ne. c) All that piece and parcel of the land bearing Gat No. 161, admeasuring about 60 R out of the total land admeasuring 3 H 02 R situated at village Theur, Pune, Tal. Haveli, Dist. Pune. And within the local limits Grampanchayat Theur. LOT 5 : All that piece and parcel of the land ADMEASURING 3 H 23.32 R alongwith Potkharaba situated at Gat No. 328 B at Village Theur Taluka Haveli, Dist. Pu ne and within the jurisdiction of Sub Registrar Haveli No. VI. All that part & parcel of the land bearing gat No. 328/1 admeasuring 3 Hector 02 R situated at Theur Village, Tal. Haveli, Dist. Pune. (As per the latest revenue record, the Gat No. 328 & 328/1 have been amalgamated and have been allotted Gat No. 328.)	Not Known	Not Known	Not Known	

1) Bidders are advised to go through the website for detailed terms and conditions of auction sale before submitting their bids and taking part in the E-auction sale proceedings. Other terms and conditions are also available with Recovery Officer, DRT, Pune and Branch Manager of CH bank, 3) The above conditions are in addition to the Terms & Conditions contained in the auction bid format and website. 4) Prospective bidders are advised to peruse the copies of title deeds, if any, available with the bank and also carry out their own inquiries to satisfy themselves regarding encumbrances, if any, over the property, 5) The Properties can be inspected on **09/10/2026 & 16/10/2026 between 11:00 AM to 05:00 P.M.** for inspection please contact **Mr. Nitesh Kumar, Chief Manager, Mobile - 8925952584**. Recovery Officer has the absolute right to accept or reject any bid or bids or to postpone or cancel the sale without assigning any reason. 6) The sale shall be subject to confirmation by Recovery Officer, Given under my hand and seal on this date **04/09/2026**.



(Ravikant Vinayak Yadav)
Recovery Officer-I
Debts Recovery Tribunal, Pune

ENERGY PRICES COULD GO UP

Saudi Arabia shuts down key oil pipeline after Iraq drone attack

Houthi tighten their grip on Red Sea shipping

REUTERS
Aden/Dubai, September 12

SAUDI ARABIA HAS shut down its East-West pipeline, after the vital oil conduit came under aerial attack in the widening Middle East war, threatening to send energy prices even higher.

The world's largest crude oil exporter said it temporarily closed the pipeline as a precaution after a drone attack that both Baghdad and Riyadh said had originated in Iraq, where Iranian-backed militias operate. Attacks were launched from Iraqi territory, said Iraq's government Saturday, pledging to probe further.

US President Donald Trump appeared to blame Iraq for the attack that halted the pipeline. Iraq closed two key border crossings with Iran, halting all passenger and commercial traffic until further notice, Iran's state-run media reported Saturday.

The 1,200-km (745-mile) pipeline running across the Arabian Peninsula has served as the

MORE TENSION

■ Baghdad dismisses military commander after confirming pipeline attack originated from Iraq

■ Saudis reported to ask Trump for military help to combat Houthi advance

■ Iran would be attending a meeting with Gulf Arab states in Oman on Monday

■ Monday talks not expected to result in Hormuz deal



Satellite image shows damage to the East-West pipeline facility in the Hejaz Region, Saudi Arabia

REUTERS

main route out for global supplies of Middle East oil for the past six months while the Strait of Hormuz has been largely shut by war. It has been moving 4 million to 5 million barrels per day, amounting to 4% to 5% of global supply, sparing Saudi Arabia the brunt of the disruption that has crippled other Gulf oil and gas exporters. Satellite images showed black smoke rising from an area of the pipeline south of Medina. The attack resulted in some injuries and damage that was being assessed, the Saudi Foreign Ministry said without detailing the

impact on exports.

Oil prices shot up over the past week and the retail price of diesel in the US surged past a record \$6 a gallon, as the United States and Iran both fired on tankers and the Iran-aligned Houthis in Yemen advanced along the Red Sea, potentially extending disruption to another major oil route.

Washington now faces a dilemma over whether to help the Saudis fight the Houthis, risking further expansion of the war. Saudi Arabia's de facto ruler, Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman, phoned Trump and

asked for US military help fighting the Houthis, three sources told *Reuters*.

They said the prince was told that Washington would not intervene directly for now but would help with intelligence. Trump confirmed on Saturday that he had spoken to the crown prince, and said the Houthis had also phoned his administration and asked Washington not to become directly involved in the conflict.

Four Yemeni government sources told *Reuters* that the Houthis had seized the strategic island of Perim on Friday in the

middle of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait — the "Gate of Tears" at the mouth of the Red Sea.

In a post on X on Saturday, Ebrahim Azizi, head of the Iranian parliament's national security committee, said: "As long as the American side does not accept all of Iran's conditions, dialogue and negotiation are of no use." Iran's foreign ministry announced on Friday that Iran would be attending a meeting with Gulf Arab states in Oman on Monday, at which the future of the Strait of Hormuz would be discussed. But a senior Iranian official, speaking to *Reuters* on condition of anonymity on Saturday, played down the chances of a breakthrough, saying the meeting, called at Oman's initiative, was intended to discuss issues including the strait but was not expected to yield a signed agreement.

Oman has not officially announced the meeting, and other Gulf countries have remained silent. Bahrain said on Saturday it would not attend meetings with Iran.

Iran wants its control of the Strait of Hormuz to be recognised, allowing it to collect fees from ships that use it, which Washington rejects.

US-Canada trade deal likely soon, says Trump

REUTERS
Dublin, September 12

PRESIDENT DONALD TRUMP said on Saturday that Canada was keen to reach a trade deal with the United States and that an agreement could come "fairly soon", while repeating complaints that Canada had treated US farmers unfairly and should remove tariffs. "Canada wants to make a deal very badly," Trump said while answering questions from media after a meeting with Irish Prime Minister Micheal Martin in Dublin.

Trump: Would 'love' to see united Ireland

REUTERS
Dublin, September 12

US PRESIDENT DONALD TRUMP said on Saturday he would "love" to see Ireland unify with British-run Northern Ireland, remarks made during a visit to Dublin that will be unwelcome in London and among unionists in Northern Ireland.

Trump's comments come weeks after new British Prime Minister Andy Burnham said a referendum on Northern Ireland leaving the United Kingdom was "off the table".

"Well, I don't want to cause any problems, but I will tell you, I'd love to see it unified," Trump told reporters sitting next to Irish Prime Minister Micheal Martin after the pair met in Dublin. "It's going to happen eventually... I think it would be a fantastic thing."

"Now the UK will have something to say about it... but I think it would be a great thing," he added. Under the terms of the 1998 Good Friday Agreement, a referendum on leaving the UK can be held only at the discretion of the British government. The accord ended three decades of violence between Irish nationalists seeking a united Ireland and unionists who wanted Northern Ireland to remain part

UK PM office: Position on Irish unity unchanged

BRITISH PRIME MINISTER Andy Burnham's position on Irish unification remains unchanged, a spokesperson for his office said on Saturday, following comments by US President that he would "love" to see a united Ireland.

Responding to questions from lawmakers in parliament about a possible border poll in Northern Ireland, Burnham said: "I am not aware that there is

majority public support for another referendum, and until that changes, there will not be one." A spokesperson for Burnham's office said on Saturday the prime minister's remarks still stood after Trump told reporters after a meeting with Irish Prime Minister Micheal Martin in Dublin that unification would happen eventually.

REUTERS

of the UK.

While polls show a comfortable majority in Northern Ireland favour remaining in the UK, the gap has narrowed slightly since Britain's departure from the European Union pushed unity higher up the political agenda.

Trump is making the 48-hour trip as his Republican Party campaigns to retain its majority in both chambers of the US Congress. Trump also met Irish President Catherine Connolly, who was elected head of state last year. When Trump last vis-

ited Ireland as president in 2019, Connolly, an outspoken politician with far-left foreign policy views, protested outside Shannon Airport in western Ireland. Some supporters had urged her to speak out against US military actions around the world and defend Ireland's neutrality. Anti-war and anti-Trump protests are planned in Dublin later on Saturday and in western Ireland near the Trump International Golf Links in Doonbeg. One protester held a Palestine flag over a fence near the Irish president's residence.

Anthropic CEO urges AI firms to slow model development



Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei says technology brings serious risks, including loss of control over AI systems, cyberattacks

REUTERS
September 12

ANTHROPIC CEO DARIO Amodei called on AI companies to moderate the rate at which they advance model capabilities amid mounting fears of misuse of artificial intelligence, outlining a three-step framework intended to pace development and create more time to manage its risks.

"We must slow the pace at which we improve the capabilities of AI models. Progress will still seem fast, and we must make use of the time we gain," Amodei said in an essay shared on X. His essay

comes after Anthropic released a threat intelligence report on Thursday detailing how several actors had used its Claude AI models for activities ranging from weapons development and cyber operations to surveillance and fraud. Alarm about the potential harm from AI grew this week when Anthropic researcher Jacob Coxon resigned, stating that the "people building AI earnestly believe that it could kill us all by the end of the decade."

Amodei clarified that he was not calling for halting model training or technical progress, but ensuring that companies take adequate time to align and

safeguard their models, and for third-party evaluators to confirm these steps. As part of his proposed three-step framework, Amodei said Anthropic would install permanent third-party reviewers inside frontier AI companies, with access to relevant tools and internal risk-assessment processes.

Amodei said AI companies should voluntarily work together to set standards as growing numbers of US lawmakers are calling for new rules to govern AI systems.

OpenAI's Sam Altman and Tesla's Elon Musk endorsed Amodei's suggestion to slow pace of AI development.

Nvidia in talks to invest \$10 bn in Anthropic's IPO

REUTERS
September 12

ANTHROPIC IS IN talks to bring Nvidia as an anchor investor into what could be the largest IPO in history, two people familiar with the matter told *Reuters*. Anthropic is seeking to raise as much as \$100 billion that could value the artificial intelligence startup at around \$2 trillion, the people said. Nvidia is considering investing up to \$10 billion in the IPO, one of the sources added.

The plans remain under discussion and could change, they cautioned, requesting

anonymity because the discussions are confidential.

Nvidia's potential involvement in the IPO, which has not previously been reported, would give Anthropic an early strategic backer for the out-sized offering, while further deepening ties between the chipmaker and one of its major customers. Bringing a deep-pocketed anchor investor like Nvidia onboard could boost investor confidence in the listing, which is shaping up to be a major test of public-market appetite for the enormous valuations and capital requirements of frontier AI labs.

AGASTYA ENERGY AND INFRASTRUCTURE LIMITED
(formerly known as Sanginita Chemicals Limited)
CIN: L35105GJ2005PLC047292
Regd. Office-301, 3RD FLOOR, SHAUN COMPLEX, SECTOR, GUJARAT-382011, Gujarat, India
Email id: sanginitachemicals@yahoo.com, Website: www.sanginitachemicals.co.in, Mobile: 8796102401

NOTICE

Dear Members,

1. Notice is hereby given that the (03/2026-27) Extra-Ordinary General Meeting ("EGM") of members of the AGASTYA ENERGY AND INFRASTRUCTURE LIMITED (formerly known as Sanginita Chemicals Limited) ("Company") will be convened on Wednesday, the 07th day of October, 2026 at 03:00 P.M. (IST) through Video Conferencing ("VC"/ Other Audio Visual Means ("OAVM") without the physical presence of the members in compliance with all applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 ("the Act") and the Rules made thereunder. The General Meeting shall be held at Unit No. 9, Ground Floor, Shiv Shakti Ind. Estt. J. R. Boricha Marg, Lower Parel East, Shastri Nagar, Andrah Nagar, Worli, Mumbai, Maharashtra 400011 and email at support@punvashare.com.

2. In accordance with the said MCA circulars and SEBI Circulars, the Notice of EGM will be sent only through electronic mode to those Members whose email addresses are registered with the Company/Registrar and Share Transfer Agent ("RTA") or with Depository Participant ("DP") Depository.

3. Members who have not registered their email addresses with the Company/RTA or DP/Depository may please follow below instructions to register your email address for obtaining Notice of EGM:

Physical Holding: Send a request to RTA of the Company i.e. Punva Sharegistry India Pvt Ltd at Unit No. 9, Ground Floor, Shiv Shakti Ind. Estt. J. R. Boricha Marg, Lower Parel East, Shastri Nagar, Andrah Nagar, Worli, Mumbai, Maharashtra 400011 and email at support@punvashare.com.

Demat Holding: Please contact your DP and register your email address and bank account details as per the process advised by DP.

4. Manner of casting vote(s) through e-voting: The Company will provide its members with a facility for remote e-voting through electronic voting services arranged by CDSL. Electronic voting shall also be made available for the members participating in the EGM. Details regarding the same will be provided in the Notice of the EGM and will also be made available on the Company's website viz. www.sanginitachemicals.co.in. The Members may generate login credentials by following instructions given in the Notes to Notice of the EGM for remote e-voting and e-voting at EGM. The same login credentials may also be used for attending the EGM through VCOAVM. The Notice will also be available on the website of the Company at www.sanginitachemicals.co.in, on website of the Stock exchange i.e. National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.nseindia.com and also on the website of Central Depository Services Limited at https://www.evotingindia.com/.

Please write to the Secretarial Department of the Company at Agastya Energy And Infrastructure Limited (formerly known as Sanginita Chemicals Limited), Email: sanginitachemicals@yahoo.com and/or to Registrar & Share Transfer Agent of Company at Punva Sharegistry India Pvt Ltd, Email: support@punvashare.com for any assistance. Members are required to quote their folio number/DP-ID- Client ID in all correspondence with the Company/Registrar & Share Transfer Agent of the Company.

For Agastya Energy And Infrastructure Limited (formerly known as Sanginita Chemicals Limited) Sd/-
Gaurav Kumar Tripathi
Whole-time Director
DIN : 06372272

Date : 13.09.2026
Place : Noida

RMC SWITCHGEARS LIMITED
Registered Office: Khasra No.-163, 164, Village-Badodiy, Tehsil-Kotkhawda, Jaipur, Rajasthan, India, 303908
Corporate Office: B-11 (B&C) Malviya Industrial Area, Jaipur-302017
E Mail ID: info@rmcindia.in, cs@rmcindia.in, CIN: L25111RJ1994PLC008698
Website: www.rmcindia.in, Contact No: 0141-4031516

NOTICE OF POSTAL BALLOT AND REMOTE E-VOTING INFORMATION

Dear Members,

NOTICE is hereby given that pursuant to the provisions of Section 108, 110 and other applicable provisions, if any, of the Companies Act, 2013, ("Act") read with Rules 20 and 22 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014, Regulation 44 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 ("Listing Regulations"), Secretarial Standard on General Meetings ("SS-2") issued by the Institute of Company Secretaries of India, General Circulars No. 03/2025 dated September 22, 2025 and earlier circulars issued in this regard by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs ("MCA Circulars") and other applicable rules/regulations/guidelines/circulars/notifications, RMC Switchgears Limited ("The Company") is seeking consent of the members of the Company, through Postal Ballot, only by way of remote electronic voting ("e-voting") on special business as mentioned in the Postal Ballot Notice dated September 12, 2026.

In compliance of MCA Circulars, the Postal Ballot Notice together with explanatory statement and instructions for e-voting has been sent on Saturday, September 12, 2026 by e-mail to all the members whose e-mail IDs are registered with the Company/Depository Participant(s)/Registrar and Transfer Agent (MUFG Intime India Private Limited) (Formerly known as Link Intime India Private Limited).

The Postal Ballot Notice is available on the Company's website (<https://www.rmcindia.in/>) and on the website of CDSL (<https://www.cdslindia.com/>). These details are also available on the website of stock exchange where the equity shares of the Company are listed viz. BSE Limited (<https://www.bseindia.com/>) and NSE Limited (<https://www.nseindia.com/>).

In compliance with the provisions of Sections 108 and 110 of the Act and Rules 20 and 22 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014 and Regulation 44 of the Listing Regulations, the Company is pleased to provide voting by electronic means ("remote e-voting") facility to the members holding shares as on Friday, September 4, 2026 to enable them to cast their votes using e-voting, for which the Company has engaged the services of CDSL as e-voting agency.

E-voting will commence from 09:00 A.M (IST) on Sunday, September 13, 2026 and will end on 05:00 P.M (IST) on Monday, October 12, 2026 during this period, Members holding shares as on Friday, September 4, 2026 ("Cut-off Date"), may cast their vote electronically. The remote e-voting module shall be disabled by CDSL for voting thereafter and shall not be allowed beyond the said date and time. Once the vote on a resolution is cast by a member, the member shall not be allowed to change it subsequently or cast the vote again. The voting rights of members shall be in proportion to their shares in the paid-up equity share capital of the Company as on Cut-off date. Members whose e-mail IDs are not registered with the depositories may also cast their vote by following the e-voting process given in the Postal Ballot Notice.

In case of any queries: send an email to helpdesk.evoting@cdslindia.com. Members may also write to the Company Secretary at the email address: cs@rmcindia.in.

The Board of Directors has appointed CS Megha Khandelwal (FCS: 10237), Practicing Company Secretary, as Scrutinizer for conducting the postal ballot voting process in a fair and transparent manner.

The results of the remote e-voting will be declared on or before Wednesday, October 14, 2026. The results declared, along with the Scrutinizer's Report, shall be placed on the Company's website (www.rmcindia.in) and on the website of CDSL (<https://www.cdslindia.com/>) and on the website of stock exchange where Company's shares are listed viz. BSE Limited (<https://www.bseindia.com/>) and NSE Limited (<https://www.nseindia.com/>) for information of the Members.

Members who have not received the Postal Ballot Notice may write to the Company at its registered office or to the Registrar and Transfer Agent to obtain the Company's circular or download the same from the Company's website www.rmcindia.in or from the website of CDSL (<https://www.cdslindia.com/>). All communications/queries in this respect should be addressed to our RTA, MUFG Intime India Private Limited) (Formerly known as Link Intime India Private Limited) to its email address at ml.helpdesk@in.mpmis.mufg.com

By Order of Board of Directors
For RMC Switchgears Limited
CS Shivani Balarathi
Compliance Officer & Company Secretary
Membership No.: A42636

Date: 12 September, 2026
Place: Jaipur

M/S. KALLAM BROTHERS COTTONS PRIVATE LIMITED IN LIQUIDATION
CIN : U17111AP2003PTC040726 | Registered address : D, No.160B, Dhulipalla Village, Sattenapalli, Andhra Pradesh, India, 522 414

PUBLIC ANNOUNCEMENT - INVITATION FOR SUBMISSION OF SCHEME OF COMPROMISE OR ARRANGEMENT

Under Section 230 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with Regulation 2B of the IBBI (Liquidation Process) Regulations, 2016

I, Mr. Immaneni Eswara Rao (IBBI Reg. No. IBBI/IPA-001/IP-P01224/2018-19/11943), acting as Liquidator of M/s. Kallam Brothers Cottons Private Limited (in Liquidation), appointed by the Hon'ble NCLT, Amaravati Bench vide order dated 31.07.2026 (Order uploaded on NCLT portal on 03.08.2026), do hereby issue this Public Announcement inviting proposals for a Scheme of Compromise or Arrangement under Section 230 of the Companies Act, 2013.

Interested Creditor / class of Creditors / members / class of members of the Corporate Debtor / any other eligible person can approach the office of Liquidator at kbc.cirp@gmail.com for any details of the corporate debtor & process document or in case of any queries required. Last Date for submission of final scheme shall be 21.09.2026.

Disclaimer : The CoC or the Liquidator reserves the right to accept or reject any / all proposals without assigning reasons. This Announcement does not constitute any commitment by the CoC or the Liquidator or the NCLT to sanction any Scheme. All costs incurred by interested parties shall be borne by them.

Sd/-
Immaneni Eswara Rao - Liquidator
M/s. Kallam Brothers Cottons Private Limited (in Liquidation)
IBBI Regn. No. IBBI/IPA-001/IP-P01224/2018-19/11943

Date : 13.09.2026 Address : 40-26-22, Mohiddin Street, Chandramouliapuram, Opp. BSNL Exchange, MG Road,
Place: Vijayawada Vijayawada, NTR District, Andhra Pradesh-520010, E-mail ID : kbc.cirp@gmail.com;

SALE NOTICE UNDER IBC, 2016
M/s. BILPOWER LIMITED (in Liquidation)
Liquidator's address: 7-1-285, Flat No. 103, Sri Sai Swagna sampada Apartments, Balakampal, Sanjeev Reddy Nagar, Hyderabad, Telangana, 500038

The following Assets and Properties of M/s.BILPOWER LIMITED (in Liquidation) having CIN L51420MH1989PLC053772 forming part of Liquidation Estate are for sale by the Liquidator through e-auction on "AS IS WHERE IS", "AS IS WHAT IS" and "WHATEVER THERE IS BASIS" as per details mentioned in the table below:

Details of Asset	Reserve Price (Rs.)	EMD (Rs.)	E Auction timings on 29 th September 2026
Sale of the following Shares of the Company held by Corporate Debtor: 1. 39,94,000 Equity Shares of Tarapur Transformers Limited 2. 5,00,000 Equity shares of Niskani Engineering Company Limited 3. 4,000 Equity shares of The Greater Bombay Co-operative Bank Limited 4. 1,10,000 Equity shares of Shri Taddo Deenan Pvt.Ltd 5. 2063 Equity shares of Marsons Ltd 6. 100 Equity shares of Rattan India Power Ltd	7,91,94,023	79,19,403	11 a.m to 12 noon

Particulars	Last date
Last Date for Submission of EOI with all bid documents as per the e-auction process document	27-09-2026
Last date for Depositing EMD	27-09-2026

1. Prospective bidders shall submit the requisite documents, including a declaration of eligibility under Section 29A of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code through the electronic auction platform.

2. Prospective bidders shall deposit the Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) through the Banknet auction platform.

3. The Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) of the highest bidder shall be forfeited if found ineligible during the process.

4. Interested applicants may refer to the COMPLETE E- AUCTION PROCESS INFORMATION DOCUMENT containing details of terms and conditions of online E-Auction, E-Auction Bid form, Eligibility Criteria, Declaration by Bidders, EMD requirement etc., available at eBxRay Platform on IBBI portal, at the website <https://banknet.com>. Interested bidders shall register, upload their eligibility documents; bid and receive confirmation of their bid by electronic means. The requisition of additional information, if any, be sent to E Mail : cirppl@gmail.com (process specific).

5. The Liquidator have right to accept or cancel or extend or modify, etc any terms and conditions of E-Auction at any time. He has right to reject any of the bid without giving any reasons. He has right to cancel E-Auction at any time.

6. E-Auction platform: <https://banknet.com> Interested bidders are requested to visit the mentioned websites and submit a bid.

7. It is to be noted that the bidders cannot place a bid for the value below the reserve price and incremental amount for company.

8. E-Auction platform: <https://banknet.com>. Interested bidders are requested to visit the above-mentioned websites and submit a bid and upload the documents.

Sd/-
Madhusudhan Rao Gonnugunta, Liquidator
IBBI Reg No. : IBBI/IPA-001/IP-P00181/2017-18/10360
AFA Valid till 31st Dec 2026
cirppl@gmail.com (Process Specific)
Cell No. 9177715558 & 8074633502
For support contact Mr. Sudhir: 8919507219
Date: 13.09.2026

ESDS SOFTWARE SOLUTION LIMITED
Registered Office : Plot No. B-24 & 25, NICE Area, M.I.D.C. Satpur, Nasik 422007
Tel.: 0253-7112244; CIN: U72200MH2005PLC155433
Website : www.esds.co.in; e-mail : secretarial@esds.co.in

NOTICE

Notice is hereby given that pursuant to and in compliance with the provisions of Sections 108, 110 of Companies Act, 2013 ("the Act") and Rules 20 and 22 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014 read with the Circulars issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs, Reg.44 of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 and such other applicable laws and regulations, Secretarial Standards, the approval of the Members of ESDS Software Solution Limited ("the Company") is being sought for the resolutions as set out in the Notice of Postal Ballot dated September 12, 2026 through remote e-voting process.

Members are hereby informed that the Notice of Postal Ballot dated September 12, 2026 has been sent through electronic mode on September 12, 2026, to those members whose e-mail addresses are registered with the Company or with the Depositories as on the Cut-off date i.e. Thursday, September 10, 2026. Further, in accordance with aforementioned Circulars, physical copy of Postal Ballot Notice along with Postal Ballot Form and pre-paid business reply envelope has not been sent to the Members. Hence, the Members are requested to communicate their assent or dissent only through the remote e-voting system. Those Members, whose e-mail addresses are not registered, are requested to refer to the procedure mentioned in the Notes to the Postal Ballot Notice available on the below mentioned websites, to cast their votes electronically.

The Company is providing facility for voting through electronic mode (e-voting) through MUFG Intime India Pvt. Ltd. (formerly Link Intime India Pvt. Ltd.) ("MUFG") e-voting platform viz. Instavote. The procedure of e-voting is given in the notes to the Notice of Postal Ballot.

Members are informed that the remote e-voting period would commence on Sunday, September 13, 2026 from 9.00 a.m. (IST) and end on Monday, October 12, 2026 at 5.00 p.m. (IST) (both days inclusive). The remote e-voting module shall be disabled by MUFG for e-voting thereafter and Voting by Electronic means shall not be allowed beyond the said date & time.

In case of any queries regarding e-voting you may also refer to the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) for shareholders and e-voting user manual for shareholders available at the "Downloads" section of www.in.mpmis.mufg.com or may be addressed to Mr. Prasad Deokar, Company Secretary at Email id: secretarial@esds.co.in.

The Board of Directors of the Company has appointed Mr. Sagar Kulkarni (Membership No. F11770/ C. P. No.18046) of M/s. S.V. Kulkarni & Associates, Company Secretaries, Nashik, as the Scrutinizer ("Scrutinizer") for conducting the remote e-voting process in a fair and transparent manner. The results of the Postal Ballot shall be declared on or before Wednesday, October 14, 2026 by placing the same on the websites of the Company and MUFG.

The Notice of the Postal Ballot along with the Explanatory Statement and other annexures is hosted on the website of the Company at www.esds.co.in, websites of the Stock Exchanges where the equity shares of the Company are listed i.e. BSE Limited at www.bseindia.com and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.nseindia.com and on the website of the MIPL at www.in.mpmis.mufg.com

For ESDS Software Solution Limited Sd/-
Prasad Deokar
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer
ICSI M. No.: ACS-34350

Place: Nashik
Date: Sept 12, 2026